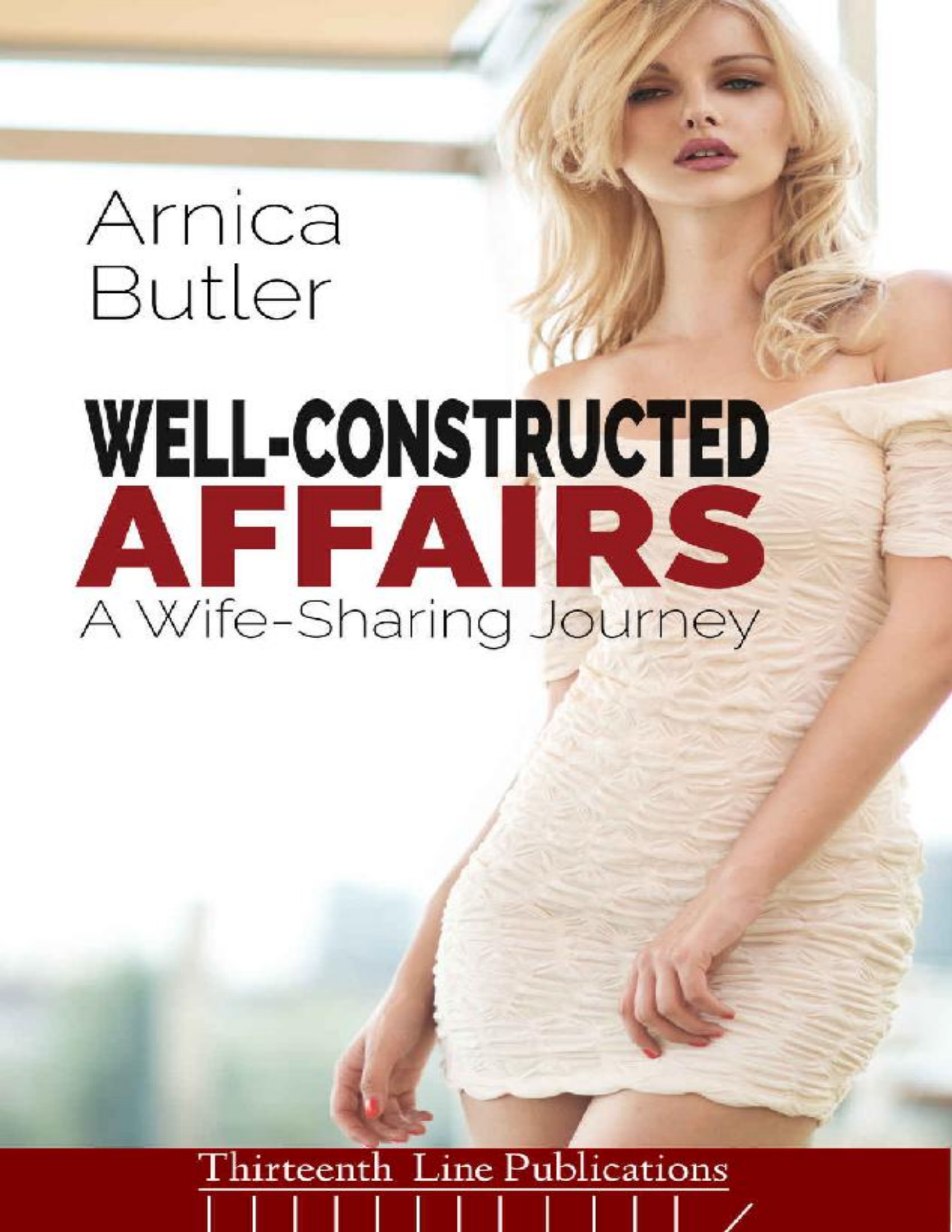


A blonde woman with wavy hair, wearing a white, short-sleeved, ruffled dress, stands in front of a large window. She is looking slightly to the side with a soft expression. The background shows a blurred view of a city or landscape.

Arnica
Butler

**WELL-CONSTRUCTED
AFFAIRS**

A Wife-Sharing Journey

Thirteenth Line Publications



WELL-CONSTRUCTED AFFAIRS

A Wife-Sharing Journey

By Arnica Butler

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1 LUNCH

“You gotta get that heap outta the way, man!”

John Querte rolled his window down. The scent of damp cement and dust and the intense summer heat filled the interior of his air-conditioned car. He leaned his head out of the window, with a slight timidity that made him cringe inwardly. John realized that Jack was just fucking with him as soon as he saw the project manager's face. The heavily muscled man, who seemed to be at every job site in the city, was already laughing and shaking his head.

John ducked back into his car and rolled up the window, giving Jack a wave and a forced grin in appreciation of his humor. Jack pointed directly above his own head; he already knew what had brought John to “the trenches” from the air-conditioned office where John spent most of his time.

A few other hard-hat capped heads turned to follow the direction of Jack's pointing finger. John leaned against the steering wheel to get a look.

Oh for fuck's sake.

He turned off the ignition and sighed. He gave a leer to the men who were smiling upward, enjoying their view. Then he got out of his car and walked over to Jack.

John looked up once he was standing next to him.

“Adria!” he called, and then suddenly wished he hadn't. His wife turned, and moved closer to the railed edge of the half-constructed building.

Normally Adria, as a construction engineer, wore Carhartts, or a pant suit if she was required to have on professional attire.

Today, for some inexplicable reason, she was wearing a skirt.

A young guy, standing about five feet from John, whistled.

Adria's middle finger was quickly drawn. “Can it, Ferguson.”

The exchange was playful and friendly; a talent of Adria's and one of the main reasons she could hack it as construction engineer in spite of being a woman, and an attractive one at that.

John sucked in his breath and bit down on his reactions to the scene in front of him, which played out often enough. Adria had things under control and he had nothing to worry about. Even if the whole crew on the ground was still looking up at Adria, she had chosen her skirt well. There was really nothing to actually *see*. The skirt came to Adria's knees in a body-hugging line, and while it was pleasant to imagine that they could all see further into the small shadow of opportunity just above her neat, well-sculpted calf – they couldn't.

And even if they could have, they wouldn't have whistled. Adria didn't actually put up with that kind of shit, and this job site was essentially hers.

“Be right down honey,” she said cheerfully to John.

Ferguson, as he was apparently called, leaned on a shovel and squinted at John. There was a mild menace in his eyes. “Where you takin' Mrs. Querte off too? Little bit of lunch?”

John did his best to look cool. He hung his hands on his back pockets. “Something like that.”

“Tuna salad?”

“Shut the hell up Ferguson, before you get your ass fired,” Jack said, and John didn't want to admit he was thankful but he was. He hated the job-site banter, which was the main reason he stayed tucked away in an architectural firm. Crude jokes, lame macho camaraderie.

But Adria somehow managed it. John couldn't help feeling a little sting of embarrassment that his wife managed male testosterone with more skill than he did.

Jack smashed a huge hand down on John's back, and John did his best to stiffen up and not wince. The man was exceptionally large, and his hand came down like a dropped anvil in a cartoon. “Where are you takin' her, though, John? And why the hell you never invite *me* to lunch? I like sushi. I like shit like that. No one ever thinks to ask Jack if he wants some sushi.”

John smiled at Jack. He liked the man's personality, which largely consisted of being terrifying in appearance, surprisingly adept at diplomatic relationships between people like John and people like Ferguson, and making jokes about how no one ever thought to get him sushi or teddy bears or flowers.

"I like sushi," Ferguson. offered. His sneer was more pronounced now.

"Don't you have a damn thing to do, Ferguson?" Jack hollered.

But Ferguson never answered because the light, feminine click of heels had begun to echo behind him, and like every other man on the job site, his attention had been stolen away by an alluring job site oddity: an attractive woman.

John's wife.

Five feet and eleven inches of almost mathematically perfect proportions. A medium build, but all of it lean, and a much-welcomed sight in the male-dominated world of commercial construction. Her breasts were average-sized but pert and precisely curved, like a mannequin's. She had a full ass, firm and well-formed, full, toned thighs.

Her blonde hair was pulled back into a severe braid, so that she could place her hard hat on with little fuss. Her pretty features were organized with a Midwestern tidiness on her face, the only hint of disorganization being a very faint smattering of freckles on her otherwise flawless milk-colored skin.

Adria was one of those women who was strangely stunning, though there was no one particular thing about her that could be described that way. Something about her strict appearance, particularly when she came to work at a site and pulled her hair back so severely, made John's cock twitch every time he saw her, and he wondered if it did the same for everyone else.

"You should have a hard hat on," she told John, and hooked a thumb at the sign in front of the car which declared the same. Her tone was one of professional courtesy, and she wasn't joking.

"I just got out of the car -" John began.

At that moment, a white hard hat hit him in the gut, and he clasped it just in time to avoid making an utter fool of himself. As he guessed, it had been hurled by Ferguson.

John put it on, knowing full well that he would be taking it off in ten seconds, which grated on his nerves. But nothing could be done.

"I'm headed over to Bridge Street after lunch, Bose." John cringed as Jack's surname, which sounded infinitely more affectionate than "Jack," left his wife's lips with an additional dusting of sweetness that she reserved for Jack Bose and Jack Bose alone. John assured himself that the two just worked together often, and made a great comedic team: the hot blonde woman and the huge black tough guy, running construction projects all over town.

Jack nodded, and held out his hand to take John's hard hat. John slapped it into his palm, and tipped his fingers at Jack in mock salute. Then he opened his wife's door for her.

"Hey boss!" someone yelled, leaning over the railing of the floor she had just descended from. Two full minutes of site banter ensued between the three of them: Jack, Adria, and the man above. Adria made them all laugh with a wisecrack about girders that was completely over John's head, in spite of the fact that he was himself an engineer. Then she slid into the car.

She removed her hat and her braid as they backed out of the lot. She shook her hair out and leaned over to kiss John on the cheek. "Hi sweetie. Where are you taking me?" She didn't wait for an answer. "God, what a day." She pulled down the mirror and produced some light makeup from nowhere.

"Wearing a skirt today, huh?" John said.

Adria shook her hair a little and pressed her lips together. Then she threw herself back against the seat of the car and sighed. "Oh god. I have meetings all over the place. I don't have a second to change."

"I bet the guys really appreciate it," John said. He wasn't entirely sure why he said things like this. Naturally, he knew why he thought things like this: he was a guy, with a hot wife, and she worked most days on a construction site. Jealousy and insecurity burned through him daily.

Adria, who was accustomed to all the stupid things men said on a daily basis, dug into her purse, ignoring the comment with the worst of all possible tactics: she seemed to literally have not even heard it. This was where Adria's talents really lay, and it was the reason she could work in a male-dominated environment like a job site with no problem. She didn't ruffle, or ripple inside, or flush or blush or get riled up in any way. When men talked shit to her, she just kept talking like she was deaf.

It was cool. But it was also uniquely infuriating. John felt his chest constrict with the familiar, but confusing feeling of being both jealous and turned on and aggravated by his wife.

"Shit," she said plainly, and dropped the purse. She offered no follow-up.

"You look good," John tried again, hopefully, to provoke his unflappable wife. "Your skirt, I mean. They should pay you extra to dress like that."

"Do you have any gum?" Adria asked, digging into the storage console in the armrest. "That dust is killing me."

"Glovebox," John said with resignation. Adria popped it open and began digging through the contents. "Thai okay?" he asked.

"It's perfect," she said.

"You do look really nice," he told her.

Adria grinned. "I do, don't I?" She crossed her legs and batted her eyes at him.

"And I bet all the guys *are* really happy."

"Those guys are happy," she said, popping the gum into her mouth, "if I wear a Hazmat suit. Is this place very far? And you can drop me at Bridge and Tenth, right?"

John wanted, almost desperately, to talk more about what the men at Adria's work thought of her skirt and just how happy they were if she wore a Hazmat suit. He wasn't entirely sure why he enjoyed it so much, but he did. It made him feel insecure, it made him jealous, it drove him crazy, but he wanted her to keep talking about it.

But he knew he should stop.

2 BILLY

After lunch, Adria asked to be dropped off at Bridge and Twelfth, and John felt a slight pang at her request but he complied. He sometimes harbored the secret fantasy that his wife was embarrassed to be seen with an office rat like himself, or with her husband. Or perhaps she had some affair going on here, and she needed the time to walk down Twelfth and slide her wedding ring off, slip it into her purse, and continue on her way to meet a man who was more like what she wanted.

He knew that this was new site though, and he also knew that Adria liked to approach it from a few blocks down. She liked to get the sense of how the place was when she dropped by unexpectedly.

Or at least that's what she said.

Adria cursed her heels, which were low but still bothered her. She was too tall to wear very high heels: John was six-two, but that didn't leave a lot of wiggle room for her. She liked the way heels elongated her calves and made her feel sexy. But on job sites they were a nightmare. Even at only an inch, her current shoes were pissing her off. So was her suit, which was a pretty worsted twine-colored skirt that flattered her figure but was cooking her from the inside out. Sweat was forming on her inner thighs, and the last thing she needed was someone on her crew watching a droplet of sweat run down her leg from above her hemline.

A chorus of whistles rained down on her from above when she reached Eleventh.

Adria was used to this sort of thing (any attractive woman in a city would be), and normally she didn't even pause for it. The truth, which she wouldn't have admitted to anyone – not even John – for any amount of money, was that she sort of liked the attention she got from men. She had been kind of an ugly duckling all through high school, and a nerd on top of it. Somewhere in the middle of university she had really come together, and discovered, working out in the field, that there were a lot of men (outside

the College of Engineering) who weren't afraid to talk to her. They didn't scurry away when they saw her: they headed right for her.

She didn't really want anything to do with these guys, she always thought. They were so different from the cool intellectuals she worked with, and anyway, she was married to one of those guys and she loved him. She loved that he was incredibly smart, and he was very good-looking. These men were good-looking, too, but in a sort of dirtier, more sexual way...

Adria stopped herself from letting her thoughts go too far.

But she also stopped in response to the whistle.

She looked up, expecting to find familiar faces. Instead, a quick scan of the men looking down at her revealed that she didn't know any of them.

“Lookin' good baby,” one of them said, and two of them smiled. Another whistle came from somewhere.

Adria smiled venomously, and then clicked down the street. Another lewd whistle followed her.

She secretly liked it. But she was going to have to get this under control.

When she went through gate to the site, she was pleased to see Ken Foreman (the joke was lost on no one) standing outside the trailer. He was hollering at someone, but when he caught sight of Adria he raised his eyebrows and dropped off mid-sentence. Adria held up her finger to silence him.

“You got some new crew,” she said, giving a nod of greeting to the workers Ken had been talking to. She knew them from a couple jobs ago, and even if she barely recognized them, she knew they remembered *her*. The best tactic she could take was to make it look like she knew who everyone was. She knew it smoothed a lot of things over.

“You know these guys,” Ken protested. “What are you doing in this get-up?” Ken liked to carry on two conversations at once, for the sake of efficiency.

“Meetings. Not those guys, the ones up on the deck.”

Ken rolled his eyes. “*Those* guys,” he said. “Sent them over from BantaCorp. 'Fuck shit up.’”

No further explanation was needed. Ken ran a tight ship and Banta didn't.

“You Mike's replacement?” he continued.

Adria nodded, and decided the answer was good enough for everything Ken had just said. If there was one thing she'd learned about these guys (and maybe men in general) it was that they didn't like to chit-chat.

Then she smiled. “Let's go have some fun with those guys,” she said. She flashed her eyes up to the floor where the whistling Banta guys had been standing, and saw one of them watching the scene from above. “Take me into the office,” she told Ken. “Act like I'm really angry.”

Ken looked confused, but he turned and opened the door for her. Adria affected an angry demeanor as she stepped through the door. When she was out of sight, she spun around and told Ken her plan, which made him laugh.

“I want to know what you four yokels were hollering at this woman!” Ken screamed.

The four looked fairly un-contrite, Adria noticed, as she stood with her arms crossed in front of her, looking severe. Inside of herself, though, she was feeling the familiar betrayal of her sensible side. Giving into to a more carnal side of herself.

A new, dirty occupant of her mind.

She ran her eyes quickly over the four men. One of them in particular caught her attention, and though she managed to keep her exterior cool and collected, she felt a ripple of heat pass through her, twisting up in her stomach and pooling in her pelvis. The man had his arms folded and looked amused. His face was covered in a day-old shadow of black stubble, and the sight of it made her involuntarily think of his jaw scraping across her cheek. His eyes were piercing blue, hovering over his set jaw, and a face that was at once youthful and hardened. A streak of dirt was rubbed on his forehead.

But it was more his physique that had her thinking. His forearms were enormous and criss-crossed by wiry strength and veins, and beneath his white shirt she could see that firm muscles composed his torso as well. His skin was tanned from work in the sun, and he had the kind of hard-work, ground-in dirt covering him that she had recently started to find...distracting. She stared at the scrapes on his knuckles. *A man who works with his hands*, she thought, and her mind wandered away to what it might feel like to have hands like that on her skin. Under her shirt, moving up to where her satin bra kept her breasts enclosed...

She blinked, and snapped herself back to reality.

"This woman is from the city," Ken continued, his tone angry. "She's an *attorney*. You have really picked the wrong woman to whistle at -"

Adria cleared her throat, joining the ruse. "Excuse me, Mr..."

"Foreman," Foreman snapped. Adria had to suppress a smile to keep from laughing. He was really getting into the part. He looked as genuinely pissed off as he would have if he actually had an attorney from the city in his office.

"Mr. Foreman. I think it's crucial to note, here, that this is not a case of these men having whistled at the wrong woman, is it? It's inappropriate, particularly on a job site where the contractors are being paid in city funds, for *any woman* to be subjected to this sort of harassment. Whether she is an attorney or not." Adria was also impressed by her own acting skills. It was rather fun acting bitchy.

The four men lowered their eyes, but they still seemed fairly unimpressed.

"Tell me what the hell you idiots said!" Ken screamed.

He was really getting into his role now. Adria stifled a laugh.

The man Adria had been checking out gave his hard hat a spin between his hands. He looked right at her. "Look, we're sorry, miss..."

"*Mrs.*," Adria snapped. For lack of planning, she used her maiden name: "Greenmore." She was very close to losing her false composure at this point.

She thought she saw a flicker of amusement at the corner of the guy's mouth. He was looking right at her, and she felt like something was transpiring between them. She could feel her chest getting cool, and something convulsed inside of her.

She hadn't felt this feeling for a long time. Of course, when she met John, she had been attracted to him, and she had a few flutters in her stomach for the first few months they dated. But this was different. This was a feeling that had very little to do with anything but wanting to have a man grind up against her body while he filled her with his hot, hard -

She stepped down hard on her daydream, and shook her hair, pressing her lips together and looking at the other three men to take her mind off the good-looking one. She shifted from one foot to the other, and she could feel that the guy – this total stranger – had gotten her worked up enough that her underwear were actually going to be damp.

It was so...*vulgar*.

“We're really sorry if we offended you,” the guy said. He looked minimally sorry. He looked like he knew exactly how he had made Adria feel, like he knew that she was throbbing between her legs and her underwear were soaking through.

Adria couldn't understand why he was making her feel like this. He was a real jackass, this guy. She hated when some guy like this stirred up this kind of attraction in her. Every bone in her body told her he was the typical arrogant jerk who got by on his good looks alone with the women.

It had been a problem lately.

Feeling like *this* about guys like *that*.

Adria was staring at him. Ken cleared his throat. It was her turn to speak, and she had completely forgotten what she was doing.

She looked at Ken. “*Sorry*,” she began, remembering the act she was putting on, “does not quite cover it, I'm afraid, gentlemen.” She opened her mouth to say more, but Ken was boiling over again, as though he were really in a rage, and she lost control of herself. She let out a snort as she tried to stifle the laugh that built up inside of her.

The men looked confused. Ken looked briefly disappointed. Adria held up a hand and gave him a loose hug. “I’m sorry, Ken. I just can’t keep it up,” she said, laughing.

She pulled her hard hat out of her bag and placed it on her head as both she and Ken tuned to the four men in the office. The three looked surprised, and the ringleader-type who had spoken looked disbelieving but amused.

Ken put his hands on his hips. “We’re just fuckin’ with you,” he said. “This is Adria Querte. She’s replacing Mike.”

Adria cast her glance along the row of guys. Her reputation, she knew, preceded her, and she had very little to do to win these guys over: she was good at her job and she knew it, and so did almost everyone in the business. When linked to the fact that men found it surprising that a female manager on a construction site was usually better than any other, the fact that she was “hot” made word about Adria Querte spread quickly. She could see the signs of recognition on their faces already. “No hard feelings?” she said sweetly.

Two of them shook their heads. The smartass smiled, and she felt a sliver of pleasure inside, thinking that he seemed impressed with the joke. It quickly faded to guilt, and she gently reminded herself – as she had been a lot lately – that she was married.

“Great,” she said. “Let’s get up there and you can fill me in on what’s going wrong in Structural.”

They looked at Ken. He shrugged. Adria did things her way, and it was one of the reasons she was so well-liked: she listened to what the dregs had to say.

She turned, and she knew that when she did, everyone’s eyes went for her ass. She realized that she hoped the blue eyes went there, and felt another stab of guilt. She held up her hand with her middle finger extended. “Ken don’t say another word about his fucking dress.”

“It’s nice,” he said. Adria knew that behind her the five of them were probably exchanging looks. That the looks were lewd, that she should find them offensive. She told herself all the time that she was just taking the path

of least resistance, drawing the line only where it was absolutely necessary, letting some things go because it paved the way for her.

But the truth was different, and there was no lying to herself about that. Especially if one of those sets of eyes belonged to the steel-blue-eyed man with the stubble. And the hard, thick biceps...

“I have meetings,” she said, and her voice was snappier than she meant for it to be. She was impatient with herself. She tried to soften it to a joking tone: “Let's get this show on the road.”

3 DANGEROUS THOUGHTS

Sometimes Adria felt a little guilty, like a betrayer of the sisterhood, that she was so good at handling men, and that she used her sexuality as a piece of the formula, and that she enjoyed it so much.

Of course, she'd never tell John that. She'd never admit it to another living soul. The party line was that she had to work hard to be taken seriously in spite of being an attractive woman, and she didn't enjoy a minute of it.

Just like she wouldn't admit to a soul that she found men like Billy Stone, which turned out to be the name of the arrogant, smiling bastard from the office, attractive. She wouldn't admit it half of the time even to herself.

After all, she loved John. She really, really loved John. He was everything she wanted in a man. He was smarter than her, which wasn't easy for her to find. He was athletic and good-looking. He was responsible, sensible, not ruled by his emotions, kind, and he would make a great father. He was a sensitive lover and they had some pretty good times in bed. Not always great, but after five years of marriage and almost eight years together that was normal, right? He was everything she wanted.

Most of the time.

She didn't want some guy like Billy Stone in her life on any permanent basis. Some scruffy, scratchy, rough-skinned man with sandpaper hands and oil streaked across his face, and dirty sweat on him like a sheen on a wild horse, lifting her up and slamming her against a wall, pressing his heady skin against hers, his muscles hard beneath it like steel.

William Stone, who went so obnoxiously by Billy, had taken her through the concrete fiascoes that had plagued the site and gotten Mike Sternum transferred off the job.

Billy had gone from smartass to cool professional, and it was clear he was pretty smart. He had the alpha-male gait, with his crew tagging along behind him and deferring to his good judgment. Adria had kept her cool but she found herself unnerved by him.

In the car she tried to direct her thoughts away from him, tune into the radio, but it was all in vain. He was under her skin. She found herself imagining scenarios between him and her, anyway, despite her attempts to submerge them.

Her feet crunched on the sand and rubble of the concrete floors. It was late in the evening; things were winding down at the site. She had returned for something (she cringed at the cliché in her own fantasy, as she imagined herself bending over to pick up a blueprint.)

“You're here awfully late.”

She heard Billy's voice and it sent a chill through her. A delicious chill, a combination of fear and excitement. She froze, letting the cold-hot excitement slide through her, heating her thighs and her abdomen, turning her limbs to ice.

She turned to face him. His shirt was off. His chest was solid and smooth, streaked with dirt, slightly damp with sweat. Defined muscles undulated over his upper body, their shape heating her in her core. But her eyes moved to his jeans, to the place between his legs where she knew – she hoped – his cock was getting hard.

She pushed her hair from her face. “I...just had to get these...” she babbled. She made a move for the stairs, flushed with excitement but longing to be a virtuous wife. Billy moved to lean against the wall at the top of the flight, blocking her. She was close to him now, and she told him she had to go in a low, breathless whisper. She had to go, but her body was attracted to his like a magnet and he must know that she only half-meant it.

Billy Stone just shook his head, his steely eyes locked on hers. “Not yet,” he told her.

His hand was already moving along her ribcage, slowly and delicately, up and up until he passed his fingers over the outer swell of her breast. Then in ward, over her nipple, up to her collarbone, along the ridge

of it. His fingers were rough at the tips, and they sent a delicious shiver through her.

And then, with his eyes on hers, he placed his hand over her mouth. Not violently, but with just enough force to communicate to her that he was going to get what he wanted. "Don't make a sound," he said, and he pressed his hand against her lips as roughly pulled her skirt up, yanked her underwear down, and with his one, large, muscled arm, placed his hand and his rough fingers on her ass and lifted her.

Then, before she had any time to stop him or escape, he was inside of her. His cock filled her, stretching her so completely that she had to bite into the flesh of his palm for the first few thrusts. He pressed his body against her, releasing her mouth: she didn't cry out because it was too late to stop the inevitable, and the only sound she could make was a gasp of pleasure each time he plunged deep inside of her. His sweat soaked through her blouse, her back scraped against the cold concrete, and she could hear the sounds of his thighs slapping against her skin as he ground deeper and harder into her.

Adria felt a pang of guilt as she exited the freeway and stopped at the light. An old woman in the lane next to her looked at her, and it seemed that she could read Adria's dirty thoughts. She frowned. Adria turned the air conditioning up higher.

She needed to get control of herself.

She could feel that her fantasy had made her so excited that her underwear were damp.

Try as she might, she couldn't shake the ideas from her head. She made it as far as a block down Centennial Drive, before her mind began wandering again to the hard body of Billy Stone, his smug face, his rough hands, his big, filling cock, and the way he would push her up against a wall and take what he wanted...

There were darker thoughts in this haze of lurid fantasy, too. Sometimes Billy Stone would slide his rough hand up her shirt, under the fabric, over her breasts, until his palm reached her throat, and as she closed her eyes and her body stiffened with the rush of an oncoming orgasm, his fingers would close slowly around her throat...

Or even darker:

Billy would push her to the ground, so that she was on her knees, her bare skin cold and scraping against the cement floor. Maybe he didn't even need to press on her shoulders; his gaze alone would send her to her knees. He would lift her chin with his fingertips, and make her look into his eyes, submitting fully, as he unthreaded his belt and wrapped it around her neck. As he threaded it through the buckles and pulled until it squeezed her: not too much, just enough to let her know who the boss was, who had control. And then, with a gentle tug forward, he would guide her open, hungry mouth toward his cock, and tell her to suck him...

Adria pulled into the driveway. Her pussy was actually throbbing. She had really wound herself up. She looked at the garage door as it opened.

Inside, she knew John was there. He'd be open to having sex, if he was a little surprised.

And it would be good.

It was always *good*. John was a considerate lover. He was generous, not bad at working her to a climax with his tongue, and he was a decently-endowed man. They had tender, intimate lovemaking and occasionally, after too much wine, something a little more carnal.

She wiped her hair away from her face impatiently. It was good.

But one thing John couldn't do, and she knew this, was fuck her the way she imagined Billy Stone would. Slamming her up against a wall, maybe giving her a good spanking, choking her as he slammed his cock deep inside of her.

She sighed. What the hell did she want that sort of thing for, anyway?

Just thinking about it, though, had made her even wetter. She could feel it slipping against her thighs as she entered the house.

"Jesus," she whispered to herself.

4 THINKING OF ANOTHER

“You're home late,” John said, opening the fridge to retrieve Adria a cold beer.

When he had met her, she had been a wine kind of girl. But years of trying to fit in with the guys at construction sites, he supposed, had gotten to her and now she preferred a nice beer. Still in the bottle. And usually something cheap.

His wife seemed to shiver. “Am I?”

John indulged for a moment in his own perverse fantasy. Maybe Adria had gone out with the guys. They all liked her, after all. He could see her letting her hair down at the bar, having a few beers, getting a little tipsy, while her crew circled her like wild dogs, each vying for the chance to get at her. He could picture her thumb twisting her wedding ring over her finger. Or maybe it was one of those days she removed it because she was doing something with electrical. Maybe she “forgot” to put it back on, sending out a signal to the whole gang...

John sat down next to her on a barstool. She took a big swig of her beer.

Adria also wasn't the type to come home and complain about work. She indulged in a little bit of bitching, but, maybe because it was a job with so many men around, she didn't have a lot of stories about the power struggles that took place in the typical office setting (he-said, she-said, email angst). She admitted this herself: guys seemed to have a big fight about something on the job site (sometimes an *actual* fight) and then get over it.

She surprised him by setting her half-finished beer down with a thud, and turning to him in what seemed to be a very...sexual way. His cock responded immediately, but he wanted to be sure he was reading her right. There was nothing like getting excited, moving in, and then getting shot down.

“So,” she said. “How was *your* day?”

John blinked. Her voice definitely *sounded* inviting.

She put her hands on his knees, and he looked down at her slender fingers in bewilderment. She was moving her thumb slowly along his inner thigh, sliding it closer to his cock with each stroke. He felt his cock pulse as her fingers curled inward and raked through his jeans just above where his hard dick was pressing against the fabric. “I, uh..normal, I guess.” He gave her a smile.

She edged toward the end of her stool, and the sight of her squirming at to the edge of the chair made him even more excited. Her skirt slid up her thighs a little as she did, slowly exposing a few more inches of her pretty legs.

Then she slid completely off the stool, and moved close to him, squeezing herself in between his legs. She put her hands on his shoulders, drawing her own face in to his. John was still a little stunned by how forward she was being: it wasn't really like Adria at all. He stared, pulse racing and cock throbbing, a nanosecond behind his own wife in getting his own body moving.

Her mouth came close to him, and she brushed her lips tantalizingly close to his. He recovered from his shock, and moved his hands down to her thighs. He tugged at the material of her skirt and bunched it in his hands to get at the smooth flesh of her upper lg as he did.

Adria squeezed his shoulder, sort of hard, and looked down at his pants. She seemed impatient as she took his belt off and released his cock. She grabbed his hands, which he had been gently stroking her thighs with, and placed them on her ass, slapping them to her buttocks firmly. Then she hopped up onto his lap, giving him no choice but to lift her. She pressed her mouth against his, hard and demanding.

He moved his fingers between her legs, and began to stroke her through the fabric of her underwear, trying to tease her a little before plunging his fingers into her. He was surprised to find that she was already very wet. Unusually wet. She grasped his hand by the wrist with an uncharacteristic impatience, and shoved his fingers beneath the fabric of her panties. He was immediately engulfed to the knuckles by her juices and her

hot flesh. She ground her body against him, and he was hesitant but there seemed to be no choice except to let his fingers sink inside of her.

She threw her head back, with her eyes closed. Her pretty white teeth nibbled at her shapely lower lip.

He leaned in to her chest, and breathed in the scent of her white blouse. He nuzzled her, trying to get the fabric away from her skin.

She sighed again, and it was the same impatient-sounding sigh. Then she ripped at her blouse, and popped a button as she tore it open. At the same time, she seemed to lose patience with the slow strokes he was using to pleasure her below. She leaned backward on the end of his knees, almost toppling them both, and grasped her panties. She pulled them to the side of her gash. John saw a brief and beautiful flash of her neatly trimmed bush, with her soft, white-blond hair, slicked down by her mounting excitement. Then she pulled on his shoulder and sheathed his cock with a violent thrust of her own body.

He felt her squeeze his shoulder again, and she began to grind against him. The features of her face had a wildly impatient look about them. It was odd: John figured maybe she wanted to take control. He released his grip on her and let her take over.

He thought he saw frustration spread across her face, but she disappeared quickly and began to ride him. Her superheated wet flesh slid up and down his shaft in quick, hungry strokes. She began to pant, and small beads of sweat formed between her breasts and on her forehead. John breathed in the scent of her as it rose up between them. He was close to coming and fought the urge, until he felt her pussy tightening around his shaft and her pace quickening. He grasped her ass and began to help her to move her more body more violently up and down.

He felt her muscles hardening around him, squeezing him, and he was ready to let himself go at that moment as well. Unexpectedly, at that precise moment, she reached for his hand and tried to guide it somewhere – maybe to her neck, to her lips, to her shoulders – who knew? But they never found out because she upset their precarious balance on the stool and they started to fall off.

John felt the slap of nearly reaching orgasm but being cut off, and then the stunned, ringing sensation that followed. Adria stood up, and then she wasted no time. She pulled him down to the floor with her, her fingers digging into his flesh, and she spread her legs for him to enter her again.

They recovered from the interruption easily, and they were back close to the edge in almost no time at all.

Adria grabbed his ass, digging her fingers into his flesh. The same look of impatience or frustration took over her face again.

He thought, but could not be 100% sure, that he heard her say: “Fuck me harder,” just before he came. She closed her eyes as he pounded himself into her. At last, as he really dove into her with his cock, she seemed satisfied. With her eyes closed and her face in a distant expression, she finally shuddered to her own climax, her pussy bursting into hot liquid around his cock.

He collapsed on top of her for a moment, and they panted together on the floor. He rolled off and they lay there a moment on the tile.

John wasn't the kind of guy to have sex on the kitchen floor, and so he reflected on the fact that this might have been a first in their relationship. It was exciting, but it also nagged a little at his sense of order and propriety. He smiled, trying to have fun with the situation, which he knew he should just relax and enjoy – and indeed, he had – without letting his compulsive nature eat away at his pleasure.

He turned to Adria.

She was staring at the ceiling, with a faraway look in her eyes.

“That was...unexpected,” John said.

She smiled, but it seemed to him at the time, and even more so when he thought about it later, that it was the kind of smile you give to a child you aren't really listening to. A smile of appeasement, or complacency, but not a real smile. Something about his wife was not entirely in the room with him at that moment, of this he could be sure.

This lasted only a bit, and then she sat up. Her mood seemed abruptly changed, and she complained of being hot and needing a shower.

She cast another smile at him, and then she stood up. John had a nice view along her inner thighs and up to her twisted, soaked underwear, deep in the shadows of her skirt. She left, and the room, and his fingers, still smelled of her very wet, very sweet pussy.

John lay on the bed. He allowed himself to sink into his dark fantasy for only a few minutes: that was his rule for himself. It felt like floating slowly toward the bottom of a very deep lake, darker and colder with each passing second.

Fantasies. He wasn't even sure he could call them that. Was it a fantasy if you wanted to imagine that when your wife shuddered with an orgasm, it was because she was thinking of someone else? Was it a fantasy to think about another man defiling her, filling her up with his dirty seed, kneading her breasts and slapping her ass and making her scream? Was it a fantasy to think your own wife was unsatisfied with you?

His chest was tingling with the cold sensation that as an adolescent he would have called lovesickness. It twisted in his chest, and reached its hot-cold tentacles down to his crotch. The awful images of Adria, on her hands and knees and moaning in pleasure as another man hammered her with his gigantic cock, would not clear his head. They pressed down on him, pushing him deeper and deeper into his dark, cold lake of pain.

But the curious thing was this:

His cock was rock solid again.

He tore himself away from his thoughts, and marched down the hallway. He was unsure of his destination. The treadmill, to try and sweat his thoughts away. Or the study, where he could pour himself a Scotch and numb his mind.

5 VERY DISCREET

Lily Sanchez Gutt punched hard, repeatedly. Her toned arms moved with a fluid and vicious grace, directing her gloved hands into the soft red material of the punching bag in such rapid succession that a whole host of people had paused to watch her, whether they were walking by or practicing themselves.

Adria saw them, and it always gave her a kick that Lily gained such an audience, but Adria kept at her own workout. She had very little time in her week, and kickboxing with Lily on Wednesdays was very nearly the only indulgence in her life. She could see why people paused: Lily was a small and feisty half-Mexican girl with an extremely pretty face, and she was fucking this bag *up*.

Adria punched at her own bag with equal vehemence, but few people paid as much attention to her because, well, she was large. At five-eleven, and with the appearance of an Iowan farm girl completely bared by her workout clothes, no one seemed to think much of Adria punching the crap out of a bag.

Today she had a lot on her mind. The workout was helping her release some of it, but she was only halfway to the point she reached with intense exercise, of spacing out so much she didn't have to think about the things that were bothering her. Billy Stone; her husband; her conflicting feelings; her craving for rough sex: all wandered around in her mind. The thoughts bumped into each other, and just as they would be awkward if they met in real life as people, they were awkward when they collided as thoughts. Wanting to feel Billy Stone's big cock inside of her would bump into a sweet thought about her husband; the strange allure of anal sex (something she had never even considered before) would bump into the frustration she had felt welling up inside of her last night while having sex with John. All these thoughts were uncomfortable together. And yet there they all were in her mind.

She felt a tremendous sense of guilt for her thoughts about John. She supposed this was just sort of the way it went with marriage and long-term relationships, but she really didn't want to admit that it had happened to them. Last night she had wanted him to really *fuck* her, and the desire felt so alien to her that just *feeling* that way caused her consternation. But on top of that strangeness, she also felt bad because she had actually felt angry with John, annoyed with him, impatient and frustrated that he wasn't giving her what she wanted. She had dug her fingernails into his ass out of impatience, silently willing him to just...well...(and whenever she had this thought she felt a stab of guilt and shame and tried hard to submerge it as quickly as possible)...to fuck like a man.

A man-man. A man like Billy Stone.

Adria punched her bag as hard as she could at the thought of that smug fucker. She hated that someone like that was invading her thoughts. Invading her marriage, really, if she thought about it like that.

She felt like a bad person.

She began to really lay into her workout. If she worked hard enough, she would get some of these thoughts out of her head. She punched and kicked, taking no breather, failing to pace herself.

Sweat was pouring from her temples and running down her back and along the curves of her breasts in her sports bra when she finally had to pause to breathe. She could feel her chest heaving.

Only then did she notice that a lot of people were staring at her. Lily was holding her punching bag, and she looked at Adria with raised eyebrows.

But she was this kind of friend, which is probably why Adria loved her so much. She said nothing, just cocked her head in the direction of the locker room. *You're out of control*, her look said. *So let's go talk*.

They didn't talk until they had showered. Lily told her to meet her in the sauna, which was her way of saying she wanted to discuss something.

Lily threw her weight against the tile in the sauna and exhaled loudly. "So what is this shit with Mike?" she said, with her eyes closed. She pushed

her wet hair out of her face and smiled. “I *liked* Mike.”

This wasn't the topic Lily really wanted to discuss, and Adria knew it. She appreciated that Lily had a diplomatic way of getting around to asking someone why they were furiously punching a bag in the gym until they looked like an unhinged banshee, as opposed to just asking that very question.

Adria raised her eyebrows. She knew it was a trick to get her relaxed and talking, but she didn't mind. It was a good tactic. She felt better the minute she started talking. “You *didn't*.” She closed her own eyes and let her mind picture the tall, ebony-skinned Mike. When Lily said she “liked” someone, it meant much more than that. “How do you even *know* Mike?”

Lily was married, and Adria had seen her husband in the flesh: a tall, sensual man of unidentified background. But he never seemed to be around, and Lily talked about him very little. One thing that Lily did (other than some kind of nondescript freelance work that made her disappear for weeks on end, or salsa dancing, which had the same vanishing effect), was flirt with a lot of men.

And, Adria suspected, with a slight twinge of equal parts admonishment and jealousy, Lily did quite a bit more than that.

Adria usually kept her questions to herself. She had been friends with Lily for years now, for obvious reasons: they were two of the ten girls in the College of Engineering back at school. They were a natural pair: two pretty, fun girls in a building full of dull, dorky men. But Lily had dropped out (out of extreme boredom, she claimed). Adria sometimes envied her deeply: she was carefree, she was unafraid to drop out of things in the name of fun, she was pretty and petite and did whatever she wanted with the men who suited her.

“You remember that party, the one you took me to for those fancy-pantsy clients, the ones with the...skyscraper thingy, the glass triangle-thing...” she lifted her hand and waved it limply in the air. Lily had a deep, grainy voice that ricocheted in her nasal cavity and exited as a sexy, breathy purr. The end of every sentence seemed to evaporate in a grated sigh. “He was there.”

Adria opened her eyes and looked at her friend. Then she thought about Mike. His dark, sensual allure. His muscled physique.

She had no idea why, but Adria suddenly felt quite bold. “Did you...?”

Lily's eyes snapped open, and a smile immediately took over her mouth. “Oh look at you! Finally curious, huh? You want to know if the legends are true?” She closed her eyes and moved her head as though she were settling into a pillow. She grinned. “They *are* true. The legends are completely true.”

“Lily!” Adria rasped. She closed her eyes, but she couldn't help smiling.

There was a pause for about thirty seconds, while Adria contemplated the exact dimensions of the truth Lily spoke about, all the while feeling a bit ashamed of herself and the detail in which she was imagining Mike's...package...when Lily's voice rattled pleasantly next to her. “You-want-to-know-how-true-they-ghar, don't you?” she sang, hamming up her accent. Lily had moved from Mexico when she was eighteen, but Spanish still rounded her vowels and drove her consonants deep into the back of her throat (something she used with predatory precision to attract men). Adria felt her fingers walking on her arm. She opened her eyes and saw Lily smiling and biting her lip.

“Oh,” Lily exclaimed. “You *do*.” She sat up and leaned forward on her knees.

Lily was genuinely excited about his. Adria watched her with what she would have loved to deem a morbid fascination. Adria liked to think of herself as above this kind of thing – after all, they were professional women. They were *women*. They weren't supposed to be obsessed with this sort of thing.

Lily had made a circle with her hands, touching her thumbs and pointer fingers to each other.

Adria laughed at her.

“I am serious. It was so big I could barely get it into my *mouth*,” she said. She smiled at Adria's reaction, which was to cover her mouth and blush. “I know. You're going to say, 'Lily *don* be so *bulghar*,' but you *know*

you want to hear about it.” She was now holding her hands apart to indicate the length – the absurd length – of Mike's cock.

Adria snorted and closed her eyes again. “There's no way it was that big.”

“It was,” Lily said.

Adria shook her head.

“I am telling you the truth. And before you say anything, let me tell you, I have, you know, a lot of practice, right? So I can deal with this kind of things.”

Adria opened her eyes. Lily was smiling shamelessly. She seemed completely unconcerned that she was a married woman, talking about how she could barely fit a black man's cock into her mouth.

She continued: “But you know that little girlfriend he had, the sticky one...I mean the twiggy one? I don't know what that poor girl does. How she is doing it, you know?”

Adria was scandalized. But she was also a little bit...fascinated.

“*You're* small,” she said.

Lily's eyes flicked open. “*I am*. But I am Latina.” She closed her eyes as if there were nothing more to say about the subject.

Adria couldn't help herself, Her curiosity was getting the better of her.

“So, you just...I mean, you had an affair with him, right? And what about...you know...?”

Lily was still smiling. “First *oball*, this was *not* an affair. Just sex. And second, well, *Esteven*, he knows about it.”

“What?!”

Lily shrugged. “More or less.” She adjusted her hair and her towel slipped down and exposed her full breasts, and her rail-thin frame.

“How does that work?” Adria said, breathlessly.

Lily opened her eyes. Her dark brown eyes scanned Adria's, and a look of knowledge came over her face. “Ah,” she said.

Adria stared at her.

“Listen,” Lily said, leaning forward on her knees. “I have some things I want to do, you know? So I get them.” She said it like she was talking about a preference for fruit.

Adria's mouth was open, coming together to voice a protest.

But she changed direction suddenly. “Like what?”

“Like what, what?” Lily said. Then she nodded. “You know, I like a big cock.” She shrugged again. But her eyes were lit up with her own curiosity. “So what is it that you like, Adria?”

Adria shook her head.

Lily wrapped her hands around Adria's arm, pulling her close to her, a little bit like a small child. “Oh please, please, please tell me. You dirty whore. It must be something good.”

“Stop it,” Adria said, but in truth she really appreciated that Lily was going to make a big show of extracting this information from her. She realized that she really *did* want to talk to someone about it. She just didn't have any close enough friends who might be...well, as liberal-minded as Lily.

“Tell me,” Lily whined, purring into Adria's arm.

Adria closed her eyes and put her hand to her forehead. “Okay,” she said. “Okay.”

Lily released her, and sat at attention, having taken the hint that this was a serious confession.

“So I have this...I dunno. Recurring desire to have...a certain *kind* of sex...”

“Like rough sex,” Lily said, stating it flatly and not asking it as a question. She nodded.

Adria looked at her, slightly astonished. “Yeah, I mean, not like...super rough -”

Lily held up her hand. “It's okay. I got it. Everybody wants this sex. So now what, you can't get it from John?” (She pronounced it “Yone.”).

Then she shook her head. “No,” she added solemnly, then smiled. “No, *Yone* is not this kinds of guy.” She smiled and leaned back against the wall. She seemed unsurprised about Adria's confession. She had a smile on her lips.

“Well,” she said, after a long pause. “You are probably thinking about his all the time with all those hot *obrerros* all around,” she shook her hand for emphasis. “*Ay*. You know, Mike is probably down for this kinds of thing.”

“Lily!” Adria said.

“What? Oh, I know, you can't break your marriage vows, but *ghoney*, you maybe should.” She smiled again. “I do it all the time and it's very good for my marriage.”

She chuckled.

Adria stared at her. On the one hand, she was impressed that a woman could be so open about her sexual needs and wants, and take things so casually, but on the other hand, she was horrified. Adria wouldn't have thought of actually going through with any of the things she was fantasizing about. She loved John. Their marriage was far more important to her than her sexual fantasies.

“Look,” Lily said, hitting her very lightly on the arm with the back of her hand. Lily shifted in her towel and more of her lithe figure seemed to pop out. “I know you have this thing, and you're thinking, oh, it's just something a think about. Whatever. But if you change your mind, I have this friend, okay? And she runs a...I'ma just goyn to call it 'business.' It started out for the single women, like professional women, they don' have time, they don' go to bars, they don' know how to dance the salsa, and they want something especific, you know? They're a little bit older, whatever. So then...my friend, she changes the business a little bit. Maybe some single women, maybe some married women...when they need something, they give her a call. It's all *very* discreet.”

Adria could think of nothing to say.

Lily smiled without opening her eyes. “And the *men*,” she murmured. Then she bit her lower lip and smiled wider. She sucked in her breath.

Her eyes snapped open, and she was suddenly very serious. She held up a finger.

“Ees not cheap,” she warned.

Lily closed her eyes again, while Adria stared, too shocked to reply.

“You call me if you want her number,” Lily said with a smile.

“I won't,” Adria said, shaking her head but smiling.

Lily really was something.

6 ARRANGEMENTS

John heard Adria come into the house from his office, a small room built off to the side of their pretty brick bungalow. He waited until she was in the bedroom, and, he hoped, undressing, to wander back and talk to her. He liked Wednesday nights, when she worked out, because he liked the salty taste of her sweat on her shoulder, and the scent of her body. He also liked that she talked away, usually about whatever crazy antics her friend Lily had been up to, while she took a long shower behind a glass door. It allowed him to watch her without appearing overly lecherous.

Additionally, Wednesday night often ended with sex.

Adria was in the bathroom, and she had already peeled off most of her clothes. Usually, she was clad in only her boy-short Lycra workout pants and top, and John knew there were no underwear beneath them. Today, though, she seemed to have showered and returned to her work clothes.

A haze of delicious thoughts rose up in his mind. Why would she do that? Maybe she had a lover at the gym. Maybe she had showered because the scent of his muscular body had dripped all over her.

He sat down on the edge of the bed and surreptitiously picked up her racer-back Lycra shirt from the bag on the floor. "How was it?" he said, holding the shirt to his face and inhaling the sweet scent of her sweat, while looking over the top of it at his wife's fit figure, as she shimmied her underwear down her thighs. She bent over slightly to get them down to her feet, giving him a nice view of her ass, and then she stepped out of them.

There was an unusually long pause. Adria turned on the water. He was about to ask again when she replied: "It was, uh...well, fine, I guess."

John set the shirt down. He sensed a disturbance in the force, which also meant a disturbance in his hopes for having sex. He stood up and approached the bathroom. He leaned against the counter.

Adria was leaning back into the shower, getting her hair wet for shampooing. Water streamed over her fair skin, dropping from the points of her nipples, sliding over her firm thighs. He let his gaze do the same. "What's up?" he said. "Sounds not very fine."

"Adria rubbed her eyes. "No, it's...fine," she said. "I just..." She put some shampoo into her hand. "I sort of had a...weird conversation."

John slid a magazine out from under a towel next to him. He flipped through the pages, but he kept his eyes on his wife. "With Lily?"

Adria sighed.

"What did she do now?" he asked, slightly amused.

Adria shook her head. "I mean...she's pretty crazy, you know?"

They all knew. Lily had quite a reputation.

"But I never really talked to her about it, like...in detail, you know? Before today."

John felt his cock twitch from its semi-hard state to rock hard in three quick pulses. The thought of his wife talking about "it" (which they could all safely assume was Lily's libertine sex life) was quite arousing. He waited.

"So?" he finally asked, impatiently.

Adria opened her mouth, and then closed it. "Well," she began. "Okay, I am telling you this in confidence, because you aren't...like you wouldn't run off and tell someone, would you?"

"Only my closest girlfriends."

It was a joke because John didn't really have a lot of – or want any – friends of either gender.

Adria smiled and rinsed her hair. "Let me finish this," she said.

John rose and went into the bathroom area.

John leaned against the counter, happily watching soap bubbles slide over her tits and snake between her thighs until she turned off the water. She leaned over with a towel to wrap up her hair. "Okay, so did *you* know? That she slept with Mike Sternum?"

Mike Sternum. John did his best to feign that he couldn't remember who Mike was: the tall, muscled, good-looking black man he had frequently imagined seducing his wife. He felt his stomach twist (it was as pleasant as it was unpleasant), and his pulse quickened as he lied: "Mike who?" He turned around to hide the flush that he could feel creeping across his cheeks.

"Sternum," Adria said, apparently not picking up on his false amnesia. "You know, Mike, I just took over for him at Bridge Street, he's a big guy. He's black. We've had this conversation a hundred times. You *know* Mike."

Oh John knew. John knew all of these things.

"No shit," he said. He felt like his voice was shaking.

"That's all you have to say?" Adria said, and he picked up on the renewed amusement in her voice. And something else. Something he wasn't quite sure how to identify. A loud splash ricocheted on the tile as Adria unwrapped the towel and combed more water from her hair. She was looking at him through the glass now. She rubbed a patch of steam away to see him better.

"She's married, you know," Adria said, her eyes meeting his in the mirror.

His stomach wrung something cold into his pelvis, and his heart felt gripped. His erection somehow ballooned even larger.

He grabbed a toothbrush and put it into his mouth without applying paste. "Maybe she just...needs something she can't get from her husband," he said, trying to make it sound casual.

Adria made a strange noise. It sounded either like she snorted or she sneered somehow. She finished drying herself off. "So that makes it okay?"

John felt his whole chest go cold.

He honestly hadn't expected a conversation like this one to come up anytime soon. Or maybe ever. He was a planner, and he was still in the process of preparing to plan to maybe broach the subject with Adria, and he had been for some time. Planning.

Now he had a window of opportunity, and he was paralyzed by fear.

“Well,” he said, and his voice was hoarse. “I mean, if...maybe they have some kind of...”

“Arrangement?” Adria said, and something about the way she said the word made his cock press against his pants with a thud. “I’m not sure they do. But still...” she pushed the glass door open and stepped out. “Don’t you think that’s pretty bad?”

John looked at Adria in the mirror.

He could have sworn that something was different on her face, different than he would have expected had he thought about this conversation beforehand. Normally a conversation about other people’s misdeeds or strange sex lives was very lighthearted. Adria usually ended them quickly, because she didn’t like to judge and she didn’t like to gossip. Not only that, she had usually made up her mind about how she felt about things.

Now she was looking at John as if he had the answer she was looking for, and she was really interested in what he was going to say about it.

He opened his mouth. He snapped it shut. “I...well...I mean...if they have an arrangement, then...”

Adria leaned on the counter. She looked into her own eyes for a moment, and John felt another stab of fearful confusion through his chest. She almost looked as if she were doing the sort of soul-searching he did himself, when he was alone in the bathroom. “Huh,” she said.

The next bit seemed to happen in slow motion.

She looked down at her feet, and stretched on out in front of her. Then she leaned to touch her own leg, running her hand over her smooth shinbone.

“So if *I* had an arrangement with you, you’d be okay with that?”

Another fist of lust punched through him. He felt like he might not be able to speak. His entire abdomen was seizing up on him now.

He found himself saying: “What kind of arrangement?” with a dry throat.

Adria looked a little shocked, and he was deeply embarrassed for a moment: from her face it seemed that she had meant it as a joke only.

But then she said: “The kind like that. Like if I could...you know...with whoever I wanted.” She turned back to the mirror. “That's the arrangement Lily has. I think.”

John's head was racing.

This was skirting around the issue – the deep secret – he had been keeping to himself for a long time now. It was a secret that woke him in the middle of the night, that made him question himself and his masculinity and his love for his wife. It made him feel perverted. It *plagued* him. And it plagued him all the more because it did all of these things, while at the same time it worked its fingers inside of him and around his cock, and turned him until he was dripping from the crown of his dick and his erection made it hurt to walk quietly into the bathroom, hiding from Adria, and relieve himself.

The secret, his fantasy: coming home in the afternoon to find Adria on the bed with her legs wide open and her pussy filled with a huge cock, just like Mike's. A desire to see Adria's head tossed back against the pillows, her mouth open in ecstasy, the kind she never achieved with him. The detailed images he created of his wife being manhandled by any one of her construction crew, grinding together on the dirty upper floor of a half-finished site, her screams echoing through the bare concrete structure.

“Forget it,” Adria said, shrugging and turning on the water to wash her hands. She smiled, and it was the smile of a joke. John felt the pain of a lost opportunity, and he moved his mouth, trying desperately to think of something to say that might get them back on the topic. Adria leaned in toward the mirror to examine her face.

John thought he saw the smile fade a little, and an expression of disappointment that closely matched his own, slide over her face.

It was brief, though, and then she turned to him.

Her eyes fell to his pants. He knew his erection was, by now, very obvious. A smile flickered on her mouth, and he felt a surge of hope. Hope that she would say next: *oh, I see, that turns you on. Let's talk about it some more.*

There was a moment, and it seemed to last too long, where they just stood there staring at each other.

John felt a surge inside of himself, of uncharacteristic bravery. “So if we had this arrangement,” he said bravely. “What kind of guy would you go after?”

Adria lifted her eyebrows. He saw her cheeks redden, and her eyes tore away for a moment. A brief moment: she brought them back to meet his eyes in a hurry.

But he had seen it: she *had* a thought.

“A guy like Mike?”

He thought he saw a ripple over her skin. A moment of truth that rearranged the features of her face; a fleeting second of fear, of being found out.

But then it was gone. She rolled her eyes. Her voice was dripping with sarcasm when she said:

“Oh yeah. A guy just like Mike. A big meathead who can't do his job, and only has one thing that women want.”

She leaned toward him. He knew she wasn't being serious, but she was turning him on anyway. He felt her hands grasp his cock through his pants, and she pulled him close to her.

“And what's that?” he said, trying to act as comical as she was, and sensing that he failed miserably.

“A nice,” she squeezed his balls, “big...” She squeezed a little harder. The liquid ecstasy that was pumping through him now surprised even himself. He was actually salivating for the next word.

“Dewalt cordless drill.”

She laughed.

John smiled, doing his best to join her mood. But he was disappointed. Inside he could feel an animal clawing for attention, wanting her to feed it, and the only thing that would satisfy it was if she would say something else.

“Oh yeah?” he said, and spun her around toward the bed. “Must be some drill.”

“It's the Cadillac of drills,” she said, her voice going from silly to sultry and making his cock throb again. He walked her back to the bed and she threw herself onto it. “All the girls want one.”

He unzipped his pants. He was no longer certain if Adria was playing at sexual innuendo or not, but she certainly seemed to be posing very sexually on the bed. As if to answer his question, she threw her towel open. Her freshly washed skin radiated a scent of lilies and some undertone of fruit. Her feathery bush glistened with water.

He shimmied out of his clothes, unable to believe his good luck. Whether Adria was on the same page as him with her dirty talk was hardly important: they never had sex this frequently anymore and he knew a good deal when got one.

And then the thought stabbed him, like an ice pick through his chest:

Maybe Adria was energized by all this talk of other men. Maybe that's what had her so turned on. Maybe he was just a poor substitute for what she really wanted.

The thought made his cock drip with precum, as much as it hurt in his chest.

He fell onto Adria, planning to warm her up with his fingers. But she pushed his fingers away from her cunt impatiently, and grabbed his cock. “I want your cock inside of me,” she said. She wrapped her legs around his hips and pulled herself by her legs up and onto his cock.

She was dripping wet, and her pussy was hot. John could feel himself nearing the edge in just a few short thrusts, and he made the mistake of trying to think about something else to keep himself from tipping over. But the thought that entered his mind was that his wife was so wet because she was thinking about Mike, seriously. Imagining Mike's huge black cock filling her up...

He squeezed his eyes shut but there was no stopping the racking orgasm that shook him from head to toe. He yelled as he came inside of

Adria, and he felt her grinding furiously, trying to get off before it was over. She tipped her head back and moaned as she, too, went over the edge.

Her eyes closed.

God only knows what dirty, unfaithful, thoughts were in her head. John's cock pulsed, and there was no way for her to know (though *he* did) that it was a pulse of coming back to life, not the last throes of his orgasm.

He lay on top of her briefly, and then he rolled over, almost as much to hide his perversion from himself as from her.

She put her hand to her head and brushed her hair from her face. "Man," she said. "I had no idea you liked Dewalt so much."

He laughed for her. She kissed him on the cheek, and returned to the shower. "Now I have to re-do everything," she said. "Story of my life."

Just a joke. A joke she made all the time.

The cloud of paranoia would not leave him, though. Partly, he supposed, because he held on to it so tightly.

In the shower, Adria turned around and around, not even realizing she was doing so. It was a nervous habit. She moved with her thoughts. And right now they were going round and round.

She had been surprised by John. It was a rare thing, to be surprised by him. Something she liked about John was that he was predictable, that he seemed to have no secrets.

The conversation had made such a strange turn, and it had frightened her as much as it exhilarated her. She had resorted to joking because she hadn't known what to do, or what to say: she had been expecting John to call Lily a crazy slut and agree with her wholeheartedly that a lifestyle like Lily and Steven's was crazy.

Instead, they had both edged toward something else.

It almost felt like a game of chicken.

Adria slipped, and braced herself against the shower wall. She had gotten thinking so much and spinning so hard she felt a little dizzy.

She wondered where this was going.

7 THE WAITER

“Let's go somewhere different,” Adria said, after about ten minutes of silence in the car.

They were driving to dinner, a Saturday night ritual, sort of a “date night” that they had never officially declared. Somehow, despite their mutual disdain for too much routine in their own lives and for people who had too much routine in theirs, they had ended up going to the same restaurant week after week.

It wasn't to say they didn't have a good time. It just felt...stale. A little inescapable.

John had wanted to suggest this very option – at least *trying* something new – for some time.

There was a new energy between them. It was palpable. Ever since their strange, and mostly unfinished conversation Wednesday, there seemed to be some kind of connection between them, one that wasn't there before. Even if it was unspoken, there was something electric flowing between them; even if they had never really *stated* the fantasy he had dreamed about so often, there had been a piece of it in the room with them. And it had been invigorating.

“Done,” John said, without fretting about it like he often did. It was Saturday night, most places needed a reservation or would have a long wait, and this was the kind of thing that would ordinarily drive him crazy. But he felt an urge to be different, and it was fueled by this new energy between him and his wife.

“How about here?” he said, zaniily. Surprised, in fact, by his own zaniess. He made a sharp right into the parking lot of the restaurant he had just pointed out, and the tires squealed as they pulled into the lot entirely too fast. He hit a bump and he heard the bottom of the car scrape a little, which is another thing that would ordinarily have grated him down to his last nerve.

Not today. Today it was no problem.

Adria's eyes were wide open, and she had put her hands on the ceiling of the car to steady herself. "Whoa," she said. Then she laughed.

Her eyes were lit up with excitement. Her skin was flushed. John took a moment to appreciate her baby-blue dress. The blue set off her eyes like icy jewels in her pale face. It was a little more risque than her usual attire: it hugged her figure, and dipped low across her chest, so that if she moved just right he could get a glimpse of the lovely dim valley between her breasts.

And so could anyone else. The thought made him jerk to life in his underwear.

"Don's Catfish House of Cajun," Adria read from the sign. She turned to him. "What does that even *mean*?"

John shrugged. He was liking his new, freewheeling personality. He felt like someone had breathed new life into him, but actually *breathed* it into him. "Who cares?"

Adria smiled. He could feel that she liked slightly-less-anal John, too. "Let's do it," she said.

John watched her get out of the car, and caught a nice glimpse of her sexy white underwear as she rose and smoothed her dress. They linked arms to walk bravely into Don's Catfish House of Cajun.

Whatever that meant.

John watched the waiter's eyes as they expertly dove into his wife's dress, lapping up a view of her tits while she wasn't looking and then snapping quickly back into place on her eyes when she looked up from the menu. John felt a shiver of pleasure. The guy was young, good-looking, probably a university student paying his way through school, destined to be something cool, if his hair was any indication.

Adria placed her fingers on her neck and fluttered them into a fan. She drew her fingers over her skin and looked up at the waiter brightly.

Flirting?

John felt his pulse quicken.

"I don't have any idea what to get," she said, in a throaty voice.

The waiter smiled, and moved to stand behind her, close to her, where he could see her menu.

And, John noted, he could look right over her tits and "at the menu."

The waiter slid his arm over Adria's to point at something on the menu. He leaned in even closer, and turned his head to smile at her as he explained her best option, a sampler. John stared, his cock getting harder under the table.

Adria touched her neck, and smiled prettily for the waiter. "I'll take it," she said.

Was it John's imagination, or did she giggle like a schoolgirl when she said this?

She certainly wasn't being herself.

He ordered the same thing, and leaned on the table after the waiter left. "Are you *flirting* with that guy?"

Adria gave John her "Dumb Look." It was an expression that did, in fact, make her look a little bit like a bimbo – highly unbelievable if you knew her at all, but very effective, she claimed, for getting out of problems by playing stupid. He hadn't seen it for ages. He snorted with laughter and Adria's "Dumb Look" cracked.

"Whatever do you mean?" she said.

Then he felt it.

Her foot. On his thigh. Her toes, sliding along his thigh. She found what she was looking for: confirmation that his cock was hard, and she smiled victoriously.

"So you really like that?" she said. She tossed her hair over her shoulder and pressed her lips together mischievously.

John wasn't sure what to say. After all, his cock was doing the talking for him. He smiled.

"Is this what you're talking about, 'an arrangement?'" she asked.

John's mouth fell open slightly. Was his wife actually saying this? Was she serious?

“Okay,” she said, looking over at the bar where the waiter was collecting their drinks. John let his imagination go, imagined she was looking at the guy's ass as she fluttered her eyes. She turned back to John. Her face was full of challenge, and with a plummeting pain in his abdomen, John realized it could be one of two kinds of challenge: either she wanted to fulfill his fantasy, or she wanted to prove a point. “Watch this,” she said.

She waited for the waiter to come back, and turned up the heat of her body language as soon as he did. It was slightly obscene, maybe even a little too far: she seemed to be practically lying on the table, stretching her arms out, leaning over the white cloth and playing with the centerpiece with her fingers – all to better show off her breasts in her low-cut dress.

She thanked him as he set a glass of wine in front of her. “Oh,” she said, in mock surprise, the sort that barely fooled strangers and certainly not John. “You don't let me taste it first?”

An innocent question. Except for the way she asked it, except for her bright, fluttering eyes; her coy, sexual grin; the way she coated the whole sentence in a sultry syrup.

The waiter laughed. Cool and confident. John could feel his flirtation burning through the air between the waiter and his wife, and he did it with such audacity. He ignored John completely and gave Adria a sexy smile. “I can let you taste it if you want.”

John felt a wave of humiliation wash over him, listening to the two of them engage in this not-so-innuendoed speech. He knew he should feel worse, or put a stop to it, but the feeling was also incredibly, painfully enjoyable. His cock was hard as stone under the table. He could feel his pulse in his neck; the blood pressure of the anger and the sexually aroused.

Adria smiled back at the waiter, teasing him with her inviting mouth. “Can I send it back if I don't like it?”

The guy smiled again. “You'll like it,” he said plainly.

Adria picked up the glass. She kept her eyes on the waiter as she lifted the drink to her mouth. John felt humiliation burning the back of his

neck: the two of them were acting like he wasn't even in the room.

“Mmm,” Adria said, her eyes closed. Her lips were stained with the plum-red wine, and she pressed them together. She fluttered her eyes open again and met the waiters'. “I like it,” she said.

He grinned. “Told ya'.”

There was another excruciating, awkward, erotic minute as the three of them just sat there, Adria playfully flirting with the waiter with her eyes. Finally, she set the glass down to break the silence. “I forgot to ask you your name,” she said.

“Pete,” he answered.

“Pete,” she purred. Another smile. “I'm Adria.”

Another burning silence, and John felt his stomach turning in pain.

“Well,” Adria said. “You had better go get our order in.”

Pete *winked*. And left.

Adria watched him go, and then swept her sultry eyes back at John.

He felt her foot sliding along his leg again. He shuddered when her toes scraped over the crown of his cock. “Like that?” she asked, but she sort of smirked when she felt his hard-on. “I see,” she said, smiling. She took another sip of wine. “Do you think this is the kind of 'arrangement' Lily and her husband have?”

John swallowed. His cock was still throbbing and the flush of excitement that had set his skin on fire just moments before was only just subsiding. Lily? He thought, aimlessly searching his mind for the name. But all was blank: the only thing he could think about, or remember, about the entire world, was how sexy his wife looked while she flirted with another man. On purpose. In front of him.

“I...don't...I don't really know...” he stammered, when Adria lowered her chin and blinked at him, obviously expecting an answer.

“Huh,” she said, and she leaned back in the booth, taking another sip of wine. It was only then that John noted she was having wine, which was unusual, and quite a bit, which was also unusual.

They sat in a silence that was both uncomfortable and not, smiling with their new secret whenever a waiter passed by the table.

Pete appeared and set a glass of wine on the table on Adria's side. "The bartender poured one too many," he said, leaning down to growl the explanation next to Adria's ear. "So this is on the house."

Adria stretched out an arm to pinch the stem of the wine glass between her fingers. She looked at John as she purred, "Why thank you. I hope it's not too much."

Pete cast a quick glance at John, and then smiled. "It isn't," he gave a quick, exhaled laugh and shook his head slightly at John, before tossing his circular tray with one hand and catching it. He sauntered away.

"Are you attracted to that kind of guy?" John asked Adria.

She looked at him for a moment. Then she leaned forward and looked down at her wine glass as she stroked it with her fingertips. "Hmm," she said. She let the comment linger in the air, challenging him again with here eyes.

But what kind of challenge? John still couldn't tell. He wasn't thinking straight. His cock was practically bursting through his pants.

Adria stroked the rim of the wine glass with the tip of her pointer finger. One long, languid swirl. Then she brought her finger to her mouth and sucked off the trace amount of wine she had collected on her finger with a loud pop. "He's kind of cute," she said.

John quivered. "Oh yeah?" he felt like his voice was shaking and wondered if Adria noticed. "Sort of young."

She shrugged. "I mean, we're just talking about physical attraction here, right?"

His voice felt small. "Right."

Adria gave a laugh, breaking her spellbinding vixen act. She pushed her hair from her face and leaned forward. "I don't get it," she said. "Is this actually...you know, turning you on?"

She had dropped her hands beneath the table and he felt her exploring his thighs, seeking out what she had felt with her foot. She had to lean

pretty drastically to get at him, and her tits tumbled onto the table, a perfect view from where he was. When she found his cock her mouth fell open in mock disbelief. She smiled again.

Then she withdrew. Pete appeared with their food.

“This wine is delicious,” Adria said. She looked up at Pete. “If your bartender happens to mis-pour another glass, please drop it off over here.”

Pete smirked. “I told you you'd want more,” he said.

Adria smiled provocatively.

When he left she took a huge gulp of her wine. “This is sort of fun,” she said.

“Are you having a little too much?” John asked her.

She cocked her head. “You're the one who wanted me to flirt with the waiter,” she said. Then she winked. “If he brings me another glass, I'll share with you,” she said. Then she turned her attention to her Udon Catfish. “This is fucking crazy,” she said.

Then she shrugged.

Then she dug in.

“I'm headed to the loo,” Adria announced suddenly. She tossed her napkin to the side and stood up. “Whoo,” she exclaimed. She was definitely tipsy. The wine had given her a nice flush on the cheeks, and she had the glassy-eyed look of a perfectly buzzed woman, having a nice time...open to suggestions, lacking in inhibitions...John shifted uncomfortably in his seat and considered going with her.

But she was already walking that way.

And on her way to the bathroom, Pete the waiter appeared like smoke from one of the rows of booths. They collided. John heard Adria's throaty laugh from across the restaurant. He watched with burning resentment and throbbing lust as Pete placed his waiter paws on Adria's arms. They paused there, with Adria tossing her hair and Pete's hand on her arm. Talking. Adria's mouth was open and smiling.

She stole a quick glance back at the table, where John was watching her, hot on the back of his neck again. He didn't bother changing his expression, and he didn't care what it was. He couldn't look away. Pete looked at him too, and smiled.

Adria leaned in and said something to Pete, and Pete's eyes were driven over to John again.

And then they parted.

Had they made some kind of plan? John wondered. Fear and delicious envy, hope and anger, jealousy and confusion writhed inside of him. Adria disappeared to the bathrooms.

And then she was gone a very long time.

Another thing about Adria was that she was an ultra-quick pee-er. She was in and out of a bathroom before most men. She prided herself on it.

The minutes ticked by. John stared at the hall where the doors disappeared until he thought the image might burn a hole in brain.

Maybe there was another entrance to the hallway. An entrance leading from the kitchen. Maybe Adria had whispered to Pete, her lips right next to his ear: *meet me in the ladies'*.

Maybe she was back there right now, smiling with her head tilted back against the metal dividers of the stalls, her tits bouncing in her dress as Pete the athletic, smug little shit of a waiter bounced her up and down on his hard cock. Maybe the hot insides of her pretty cunt were wrapped around his meat, and he was enjoying the tight, soft feel of her. Of *his* wife.

John's cock throbbed again. He was so hard he could barely stand it. It was almost making him sick. Trembling, and without taking his eyes off the hallway, he took a sip of ice water. The water was so cold in contrast to how he felt that it nearly shocked him as it slid down his throat.

Meanwhile his mind went on and on. Maybe she was on her knees, her hand wrapped around Pete's cock, guiding it to her mouth...

He swept his eyes around the restaurant. No Pete anywhere.

He tossed his napkin down. He wasn't even sure what he was doing as he stood up and crossed the room, headed for the hallway. He could feel

that his walk was fevered, angry, purposeful. It felt strange to him, like he was in another body.

When he turned the corner into the hallway, he saw there was no other way in. He scanned the dimly lit area, wondering what on earth he thought he was doing.

The womens' bathroom door opened. It was Adria, who looked surprised to see him there for a brief second. Then her eyes brightened. She gave him a coy smile, and paused in the door, propping it open with one hand. "You look a little wild," she said.

This expression on her face. It gutted him, as much as it ignited him.

She dropped her hand and let the door swing behind her as she stepped into the hallway. She was still giving him this wicked smile, and his mind was quickly filling up with all of the images he'd created sitting in the restaurant waiting for her. Maybe she had found a way to smuggle Pete in there. Maybe he was in there now. Maybe her mouth was salty with his cum. Maybe her pussy was full of it, and it was dripping down her leg...

His eyes dropped to her thighs, seeking out his imagined proof of her sin.

She moved close to him, and brushed by him. "Come on," she said. "Let's get dessert."

She made him turn, as though she were a magnet and he was metal. He felt hypnotized, but only for a moment. He walked behind her, and then his mind (and his cock) got the better of him. He pushed her into a bathroom marked for families.

A single bathroom with a lock.

She went willingly inside, and headed for the wall, as though she knew all along that he was going to push her in there. He was still wondering, and they moved into the cool, tiled room, is if he would find her panties as wet as before.

And wet with what, exactly?

Was she disappointed when she opened the door and found John?

Why had she waited so long in the bathroom? She peed and then she stood up, waiting. She washed her hands over and over. A woman came and went. She pretended to be fluffing her hair. She leaned against the counter.

What was she waiting for? She knew, as she waited, that she wanted *something* to happen. Someone to appear, come into the bathroom, claim her as his.

She hadn't felt like this for such a long time. Waiting for men to come after her. Hoping they would. Not knowing *which* guy she was really hoping for. Not really thinking things through, like what would happen, and what she would do, if Pete really did appear in the bathroom.

Would she smile at him? How far would she take it?

But neither of them appeared, and so she started to leave. Maybe she was even relieved. Relieved that she didn't have to misbehave, or feel disappointed, or make a decision.

And then there he was.

John was looking crazy. He was acting crazy. His hungry, twisted appearance sent a flutter of lust through her. She was glad when he placed his fingertips on her spine and they entered the bathroom.

What she wanted was for him to push her up against the wall, but John just wasn't that kind of guy, and he needed some coaxing. She placed her hands on the wall, her ass to him. She hoped he would reach above her, take her wrists in his hand, and then use his free hand to jerk her panties away and force his cock inside of her.

He started to slide the skirt of her dress up over her thighs, making circles on her skin.

Adria pushed against him, and reached behind her to grab his hand and hook his thumb on her panties. She had a sudden, better idea, and slid her own hand under the fabric of her panties, so that it was sort of bound by her underwear.

She knew what she wanted: she wanted him to pull on the fabric and twist it around her wrist, immobilizing her hand against her ass, and pulling the fabric taut against her pelvic bone, maybe against her clit. She wanted

him to tell her to stay put like that while he fucked her. Tell her not to move, not an inch, while he had his way with her.

But John just wasn't that kind of guy, she knew.

The waiter might be that kind of guy.

She felt a gush of her excitement at the thought of the waiter. The waiter doing this exact same thing to her, but doing it a little more...forcefully than John.

"Is this what you'd do with your waiter?" John breathed, almost as if he was reading her mind. The shock of it send a cold shudder through her, and she had to rationalize with herself to reassure herself he could not, in fact, read her thoughts.

She remembered that he had his own agenda, his own fantasy.

"I'd have him fuck me harder," she breathed. "I know he's the kind of guy who would do it, too. Tie me up, take me from behind."

She felt John's cock flop against her thighs after the sound of his zipper. His breathing was heavy now.

"Keep talking," he whispered.

"He'd get both of my hands tied up in my panties," she said.

He took her other hand, and slid it with her eager help beneath the strip of fabric at the crest of her underwear. "He'd pull on it," she breathed, "and wrap it around me."

Her head was against the wall now, the only thing holding her up besides John's grip on her hands. It was wildly uncomfortable and so erotic she could feel her juices slick between her legs, as wet as she had been in a long, long time.

She felt John tug on her panties, and twist them around her wrist.

Her waiter would have done it more violently, she thought. He would have used her a little more, bound her a little tighter, until the lace of her panties dug into her flesh. The flesh of her wrists and the flesh of her cunt.

She could only hold herself up now by pressing her head against the wall. She felt John's breath on her back, and the tip of his cock shimmying

into the flesh of her pussy. She urged him silently to *fuck her*, but he slid into her slowly. She urged him silently to pull her hair back, so that she could only look at the ceiling while he pummeled his seed into her.

They were both so wound up, and, she supposed, both so caught up in their own personal fantasies, that even though John fucked her too gently, they both rose to a shattering orgasm in no time. As always, his final thrusts were the kind she wanted: hard, and filling.

She twisted her hands from her panties and straightened them out while still facing the wall. Whatever had happened, it had left her tingling all over. “Whoa,” she said, to the dark brown tile.

She heard John pull up his zipper. He was still breathing hard.

She turned to face him and saw that he had a confused ecstasy on his face.

She liked that she had wound John up to this point. His jealousy made his “roughness” more real. More real than when he just pretended for the sake of pretending. Her teasing had excited him, she could see that. It had excited her, if only for having given her fuel for her fantasies, fantasies that seemed to be of other men. Not her husband.

Something must have clouded her expression, because John reached out and touched her cheek. “What's wrong?” he asked. Tenderly.

She shook her head and put on a smile for him. “Nothing. That was great,” she said. “Let's have dessert at home?”

8 THAT'S MARRIAGE

Once they were in the car, they fell into a strangely awkward silence.

This one didn't seem as friendly as the one they had on the way down here.

"You okay?" John said, looking over at her after a few minutes of quiet.

"Yeah, why?" she said, but her voice was distanced.

John shrugged.

Then he pulled over.

Adria turned to him. For a moment she blinked slowly, applying a layer of her "Dumb Face" and trying to act like she had no idea what was going on. But John kept looking at her, and she dropped it.

"Something's off," he said.

She rubbed her face. "Yeah."

"What is it?"

Adria bit her lip and looked at her lap.

This was it, John realized. This was the moment he had been trying desperately to avoid. He hadn't asked the question he was about to ask because he didn't want the answer, no matter what answer she gave him.

He already knew the answer, he realized. He just didn't want to hear her say "no," and have it be a lie, and he didn't want to hear her say "yes," and have it be made real..

"I want to ask you something," he said, and his voice was barely a whisper. He had to wring each word from his mouth, carefully, so that he had the courage to go on. Because he knew that now was the time, the time when Adria was going to answer honestly.

She shivered.

“Do you need something else from our sex life?”

She put her hands to her eyes. The answer was in that simple gesture.

John was surprised by his own reaction, Instead of feeling as though he were being crushed, he actually felt like a weight was being lifted.

“I don't...*need* anything,” she said, and her voice was quiet and shaky. She turned to him and he could see her eyes were wet. “I love you,” she said, and let the sentence linger in the air with an unspoken “*but...*”

“But do you *want* something else?”

Adria let out a sigh and pressed herself against the back of the seat, using her feet to push herself against it. She was nervous. She shook her head. “I don't...I don't know. I don't know what to say.”

John reached out and pushed her hair over her ear.

He was finding the path through this difficult topic to be completely different than he had expected. He had expected to feel tormented, ashamed, humiliated, by the confirmation from his wife that she needed something he couldn't deliver.

Instead, he found himself aroused.

Extremely aroused.

Adria exhaled and looked out the front window, her gaze rigidly on the street.

“Let's talk about it,” John said.

Adria blinked, and a tear rolled down her cheek. “I don't want to,” she said.

“Why not?”

She shook her head. “I just...I don't really want to.”

John withdrew his hand. “Look. It's all sort of out there anyway, right. I think I know what you're going to say. So why don't we just both say it, tell each other what's going on, and see where it takes us.”

Adria cracked a smile. "That's very sensible, John," she said, in a goofy voice. She wiped her nose and sniffed. "You go first."

"Nice one," he said, and let himself fall back into the seat.

There was a long silence.

"I could send you an email," she offered.

He laughed.

Then he found himself blurting out:

"I think I know you're going to say that you want me to be...I don't know, more...manly. Rougher. And it just doesn't work for you when I do it. Is that it?"

Adria turned to him, and her mouth was slightly open in surprise.

"And *I* think," he continued, before she could say anything, "that you secretly want to try something out, something new, something with another man -"

"No," Adria said quickly. "No, I wouldn't do that."

John was suddenly irritated. This was going the wrong way again, before he had a chance to say what he wanted to say.

"John, I take our marriage really seriously," she was saying. "This is just..a glitch, you know...everything is going to get back on track in no time...I don't really want to talk about it anymore."

Every time, he thought. This happened every time.

"God," he muttered. "This happens every time."

Adria looked at him. Now *she* was annoyed. "What does?"

"Just...you...I never get to say what I want to say."

"What's there to say? That's what I'm saying! It doesn't *matter* if I feel this way or that way -"

"I'm trying to talk here!" he practically shouted. Then he lowered his voice. "I'm trying to say...I have something I want to say, to explain to you. I want you to listen!"

Something about his tone must have been extraordinary, because Adria closed her mouth and turned in her seat. “I’m...I’m sorry. I didn’t realize.”

John rarely lost his temper, even in the mildest of ways. Adria could be volatile: she’d toned it down since she started working, but it had been a gradual process. She had thrown quite a few fits in her day. John, on the other hand, was nearly always calm and raised his voice so rarely that when he did, it was extremely effective at spooking everyone around him.

“I can tell you want something else. I can tell there’s no way I can give it to you-”

“This is what-”

He held a finger up to silence her, and she had to fight hard to be quiet. She folded her arms and bored a hole into the glove box with her fixed stare.

“And there’s no way I can give it to you, but I think you can also pick up on the fact that I have my own...well, thing. Right?”

She looked up now. She looked confused. “That you like me to flirt?” she asked, and it was a genuine request for confirmation.

John turned to look out the window. “Okay. Yeah. Sort of. I like you to flirt, but...”

He sighed.

Adria leaned forward. “But...?” she prompted.

John let go of the steering wheel. He had been gripping it so fiercely his hand was hurting.

“But...I think I could go for...I don’t know. A little more.”

Nothing.

Then:

“A little *more*?” Adria said. “A little more *what*?!”

He turned to her and raised his eyebrows, as if by explanation.

He watched her face. Scorn and disbelief alternated on her mouth.

Or did they? Maybe those weren't the feelings she was expressing at all.

What *was* Adria thinking? She was playing at being so innocent, such a virtuous wife – an appealing notion, to be sure – but she was acting as though she hadn't participated at all in this evening's escapades. As though she would *never!* even *dream!* of flirting with another man.

“Adria, you know what? Don't act like you didn't have fun tonight,” John said, finally. He was surprised by his own boldness, and also surprised by how annoyed he had just become.

She opened her mouth as if to say something, and he could see that she was a little shocked by how direct he had just been. She ended up saying nothing, just folding her arms over her chest and settling against the seatback with a huff.

“I just mean,” he said, more gently, “that you seemed to have fun playing this game, too. So...I don't know. It's okay if you want to tell me...or maybe you feel deep down inside, that you maybe are attracted to some guy...that's okay, is all I'm saying. I'm not trying to trap you here. I'm just being honest.”

Another silence.

“It seems...wrong,” Adria said finally. But her voice sounded odd. Unconvinced.

John looked out the windshield. “What, like 'morally' wrong?” His voice sounded more incredulous than he meant it to. It was a bad habit of his, one borne of the fact that he was, actually a great deal smarter than other people and had very little patience for a lot of things people said. Adria was as smart as him, and he hated to think, perhaps smarter in a few ways – this statement didn't irritate him for its stupidity, just for its uncharacteristic “morality.”

“You aren't seriously taking the moral high ground route here,” he said.

Adria looked over at him, and he instantly regretted what he had said. She looked hurt. “I'm just thinking about our marriage,” she said. And then,

as she often did in emotional matters, she went from injured to fierce: “Like what would happen to it if we started fucking around. You fucking ass.”

Adria's temper flared like this. John was used to it: it burnt like phosphorus and then settled to a nice workable light.

John looked out the windshield again.

“I don't know,” he said. “It seems like a lot of people are doing just fine. With their arrangements.”

Adria rolled the window down and propped a bare foot up on the door. “Oh right. A lot of people. Like Lily. You have anyone else?”

He didn't.

He could sense Adria rolling her eyes from the other side of the car.

And so that was where the conversation ended. Oddly enough. John was disappointed and a little perplexed about how an evening that had started so congenially could go so wrong.

But that was marriage, wasn't it?

9 ADRIA'S FANTASY

Adria retreated to her own office when they got home. She wasn't entirely sure how the conversation in the car had gone so wrong.

There wasn't really any reason for it.

Even as she had been staring out the window, convincing herself that she was mad at John, she knew that, underneath the facade, she wasn't really angry with John.

She couldn't entirely understand him. But she wasn't *mad* at him.

She certainly didn't feel the way she had acted in the car.

She sat in front of her computer and stared at the screen. Maybe she could just lose herself in the mindlessness of Facebook. She scrolled through her news feed.

But her mind never left the events of the evening.

What she had said in the car *was* true. She didn't want to screw up their marriage. And there was a part of her – a big part of her – that was convinced that extramarital relations were a sign of something terribly wrong in a marriage, and that they would lead to disaster. No matter how much everyone agreed to the activities and set down rules. No matter how happy Lily seemed, or confident about her choices, there was just a part of Adria that couldn't believe she really was.

And yet...

...it *was* tempting.

So very tempting.

She remembered how hard John's cock had been underneath her foot.

And: she remembered how excited she herself was, as excited as she had been in what seemed like forever, when she felt his hard cock and realized that it was because she was flirting with Pete the waiter.

Being even more honest: *she* had liked flirting with Pete the waiter.

She stared at a picture of bunnies in jars on her computer screen.

The question was this:

Would she ever take it any further?

Billy Stone popped into her head. Pete the waiter. What if someone else had been outside the bathroom door that evening?

She opened her Messenger and stared at Lily's name. She clicked on it. Their last conversation had been about a barbecue nearly a year ago. Lily had wanted to know if she could bring Mexican food. And if she would be the only one eating spicy sausages at the party.

Which meant precisely what it seemed like it meant.

Adria closed her eyes.

Did she really want to be asking for advice from Lily? About her sex life? And her marriage?

She already knew what Lily's answer would be, anyway.

I have her number. If you ghuant it, give me a call...

The thing of it was: it wasn't so much that she wanted to have an affair. It wasn't that she was tired of John. It wasn't even that John wasn't satisfying her.

Well, not exactly.

It was this goddam obsession that had overtaken her. This desire to have a different kind of sex. The kind of sex that John just...couldn't give her. Not just because he was John and he didn't do rough sex very well, but because he was...well, he was John.

He wasn't dangerous.

She knew him too well.

She rubbed her eyes again.

It was there, way below the surface, and she didn't really want to tap it. Her fantasy was a lot darker than all of that. She could barely bring herself to admit it, even in her own mind.

Hastily, she typed to Lily:

I need to talk to you. Meet up before Wednesday? Can you?

She stared at the screen. Lily didn't read the message. Fifteen minutes went by.

Adria went to the bathroom. A trickle of pee tinkled in the toilet: she was really there to see if John had gone to bed. Assured that he was at least in the bedroom with the light off, she went back to the office.

About a year ago, she had stumbled on to her own attraction to watching porn.

The website name she had gleaned from snippets of conversations on the job site. She wasn't even sure why she had gone there – curiosity more than anything, maybe. She had watched porn before, like anyone her age. She hadn't gotten all that much out of it. Turned on, but not obsessed the way guys seemed to get.

And then she found herself doing what she was doing now.

Searching for a very specific set of terms. One it took her a long time to figure out.

Rape, after all, didn't fly on mainstream porn sites.

She clicked on *forced*.

And she began to watch (what she would never admit to being) her favorite video.

The premise was, like all porn, utterly ridiculous. The star, a wispy girl with reddish hair and a tattoo on her lower back, big puffy lips and the fearful, doe eyes of all porn stars, was walking to what was apparently a parochial school. That part – and the silly three-inch long plaid skirt and cut off white blouse the girl was wearing, were not of any real interest to Adria.

It was the part where the girl was kidnapped, and through the magic of porn transported to a basement of some kind, where she was tied to a contraption made of PVC pipes. Her arms were pressed up against the pipes, and extension cords wrapped around the length of her forearms and

biceps, holding her immobile against the posts. The pipes joined at the top, forming a u-shape, and the height of the structure forced her to tilt her head back to rest her chin on the pipes.

She was blindfolded, and naked now, and for a few moments the camera simply circled her as she squirmed and asked to be let go. "Please," she sobbed.

But the kidnappers could not let her go.

She would do anything, she explained.

And now a man appeared on screen. He was a man of wiry, builder's strength. Tattoos covered his arms, and he had the set jaw, scruffy stubble, and hardened eyes of a man who got what he wanted. He ran his fingers through her hair, and guided his enormous cock to her lips.

"I can't," she sobbed breathlessly. He held her by the hair and rubbed the tip of his cock over her lips. The size of it, its bluntness, must have been evident to her as just the crown covered her poofy lower lip. She tried to twist her head away, but his grip was fierce and she could not. He told her to open her mouth, and she shook her head.

The man appeared amused, and he stroked her cheek. "That's fine," he told her. "But I'll have you begging to let me put my cock in your mouth."

And then he went around to the where her ass was propped up for him. Her feet were tied to two hooks in the floor, and she began to cry and tell him she was sorry when he slid his fingers between her legs.

At this point the video did a particularly delicious thing, and split into two screens, so that one side showed her face, and the other showed what he was doing to her from behind.

She moaned and whined as he fingered her pussy, slowly finger-fucking her as she squirmed and begged him not to.

Then he drew his finger up from her cunt, and tapped it on the puckered hole of her ass.

"Oh, no..." she began to sob, and she gave a real performance. She shook her head and seemed genuinely frightened. "No, not that."

But it was too late for her, and he was already guiding his enormous cock to her asshole. It looked far too large to be possible, but he pushed forward. On the right side of the screen her mouth opened stunningly wide in a silent scream, and on the left the first inches of the man's fat cock slid into her ass.

The next five minutes or so of the video were simply her crying and screaming, as he slid deep inside of her and began to fuck her, slowly at first as she wailed in agony, and then faster, pounding into her.

After abusing her for a good long time, without stopping, he asked her if she wanted him to keep fucking her in the ass. He told her he could go all night.

“No, please,” she sobbed. “Please, no more, I can't take any more.”

He fucked for a half a minute without answering.

“So what do you need to do for me, you little slut?” he said cruelly.

She sobbed, and seemed to droop with resignation. She didn't answer, so he pounded her harder until she screamed: “I want to suck your cock!”

“You need to beg me. I told you you would beg me.”

“Please,” she said, and he began to fuck her even more violently. “No more, please, please, I can't...”

“Tell me what I want to hear.”

“I want to suck your cock.”

“Beg me.”

“I want...I want to...oh god...I want to suck your cock, please, please let me suck your cock.”

“Hmm...” he thrust deep inside of her and held her by the throat. “That's not quite good enough.” He ground deep into her, and because his cock was so big he must have been all the way into her abdomen.

The girl whimpered, and he gave her another round of deep anal thrusts. “Please, I want...I want to suck your cock.”

“Say, 'I want to suck your big fat cock, that's been in my ass,' you dirty whore.”

“Oh god,” she whimpered. “I want to suck your big fat cock, that's been in my ass,”

“All covered with my own dirty whore ass,” he said.

She dropped her head, and he slid out of her ass slowly. His cock was long and thick, and it took a few seconds for it to slide from inside of her. When he finally pulled out her ass, the camera focused on the throbbing, gaping red eyelet left by his pounding.

“Say it, or I'm going to fuck you again,”

“Please, she whispered. “Let me suck your cock all covered with my dirty whore ass.”

He guided the tip of his cock back to her asshole. “I didn't hear that.”

“Please. Please let me suck it. Don't fuck my ass again. Please let me taste my own ass.”

He smiled. “That's it.”

He rounded her kneeling body, and stood in front of her again. “I told you you'd be begging me to suck my cock,” he said, stroking her hair. “Now, look at me sweetheart, that's right,” he pushed the blindfold from her eyes, and she looked up at his cruel face. He slapped his cock on her lips. “Show me how much you want to suck my cock. Show me how much you love it. Or I'm going back in your ass. And I'm going to fuck you 'till you can't walk.”

The kidnapped schoolgirl opened her mouth, and obediently keeping her eyes on his, she swallowed his cock with unbridled enthusiasm.

“Now swallow it all,” he said, as his abdomen stiffened and he groaned. The girl gagged but kept most of his cum in her mouth. A little exploded from the sides of her lips, but she licked it up when he withdrew from her mouth. He held her hair and kept his cock near her lips. “Now lick it all clean. That's it. You like the taste of your own ass?”

She nodded.

“Say it. Tell me how much you like the taste of your ass and my cum.”

“I love the taste of my ass and your cum,” she said.

He slapped his cleaned-off cock against her lips. “Good girl.”

Then he turned to the camera and smiled. “And that's,” he said. “How you get a girl to suck your cock like a dirty whore.” Then a smile. He turned back to the girl. He stroked her hair. “You're having a pretty bad day, aren't you? And we still have plans for you.”

The plans, as Adria knew, included another half hour of merciless abuse: double penetration, a scene in which she sucked both cocks at the same time, her legs spread wide open while one of the guys fucked her in the ass and the other throatfucked her, and slurping their cum from the leather sofa where they took to perform their next misdeeds.

But Adria rarely got that far. She had slid her fingers beneath her panties halfway through the first scene and she rocketed to a shattering orgasm just as the kidnapper turned to face the camera.

She turned the video off. She was out of breath, and she looked around the room. Her panties were soaked clear through to the chair, and she could feel the smear of wetness on her inner thighs.

But after she came, the shame of her fantasy began to take over.

It was, after all, the most humiliating, anti-feminist, dirty, rape-y porn she could find.

She had no idea what to make of her compulsion to watch it.

And no idea, no idea at all, what to do with the creeping desire inside of her to do more than just watch.

10 LILY'S ADVICE

Lily leaned back against the sweating walls of the sauna with a contented sigh. Droplets of water had already formed on her smooth chest and were blooming to full, sliding down her caramel skin, and disappearing in the small shadow between her round breasts, beneath the terry-cloth towel she had (barely) wrapped around her small frame. “It’s so fucking hot,” she complained.

Adria smiled and tried to relax. What was really on her mind, though, were all the things she wanted to talk to Lily about. She had never responded to her Facebook message, though the message appeared as “seen” in her inbox.

Lily hadn’t mentioned the message, and Adria was now torn between desperately wanting to talk to her and desperately hoping she would never bring it up. It had been all she could think about while they were working out.

“So what is this thing you were needing to talk to me about?”

Adria froze. It felt, sometimes, like Lily was reading her mind.

She looked at her hands, trying to think of what to say. Too much time passed for her to act like she didn’t know what Lily was talking about. “Oh,” she said. “That. Yeah.”

She realized that in the time between sending the message and now, she had chickened out of talking to Lily about the *whole* truth. Her own fantasy was the one that was occupying most of her time, nagging at her the most, but she knew she wasn’t going to really talk about it. Talking about John would be easier. Less revealing.

Lily opened her eyes and squinted at Adria when she didn’t say anything for a while. Then she sat upright. “Oooooooh,” she warbled. “This is something good. Something juicy...”

She slapped Adria suddenly on the arm. "Did you call my friend? The one I told you to?!"

Adria shook her head and looked around anxiously, double-and triple-checking that no one was in the sauna. "Shhh," she said, though she didn't know why. "I...no...it isn't that."

"Sooooo," Lily said, crossing her legs and leaning her elbows on her knees. Her towel crept up to just below her utterly bare snatch, and Adria tried not to look, though she found Lily's Brazilian waxing practices fascinating. "What is it?" Lily asked. She smiled. "It obviously has to do about sex, eh?" She was nodding and smiling in that very Latina way of hers, which only turned on if the conversation was about sex or dancing. "Spit it out."

Adria looked down at her legs again. She closed her eyes. Suddenly it all seemed so preposterous. But if she wasn't going to tell Lily about it, who was she going to tell?

"Okay," she said. "But you have to swear you won't tell anyone."

"I never say anything about nobody. I'm too busy talking about myself, *nena*. So tell me." She slid around and leaned against the wall again. Her eyes were gleaming.

Adria sighed. "So I have this...thing. You know -"

"We talked about this. You like sex handled by men, or whatever they say it is."

There was more to it than that, but Adria knew she wasn't going to tell Lily any details. It wasn't really what she wanted to talk about anyway.

"Yeah, so...I guess I've sort of let John know about...you know. That I like that. Not in detail," she added sharply. "just...like a hint."

Lily tisked and rolled her head from side to side against the wall.

Adria sighed again.

"And so?" Lily prompted her after a long pause. "It didn't work..." she waved her hand in the air, to indicate that Adria should get on with the story.

“Uh...well...yeah, no, I mean...that's one thing. But...so...the thing is, John has this thing *he* is kind of into.”

Lily sat bolt upright again and her eyes flew open. She spun back into her cross-legged position, and now her towel was really akimbo and she was almost naked. She folded her hands under her chin. “I am all ears,” she said. “I cannot wait for this. Your thing is so boring, like every woman doesn't want a man to fuck her hard. But men always have something dirty. Tell me.”

Adria laughed, out of nervousness more than anything. She covered her face. “You have to swear you won't tell.”

“Oh my god,” Lily said. “Oh, this is going to be so good. No, I won't tell, *nena*,” she slapped her twice on the leg. “Confess,” she ordered, in a deep voice.

Adria's hands remained on her face. “So we started this thing, I don't even know how it started, where I flirt with other guys -”

“Oh yeah,” Lily said, and she spun back to her disinterested, closed-eyed lean against the wet wall. She seemed to have already heard this one before, and to be disappointed that there wasn't something juicier to the story.

Adria opened and closed her mouth, unsure where to go next. “So...I sort of flirted with this waiter, like...really flirted. In front of him.”

Lily was nodding her head. “And his cock got so hard for this, right?”

“Yeah...” Adria said vaguely. “So...then we have sex...in the bathroom _,”

Lily's eyes flipped open again. “That's very risque for John.” She was animated again. “And then?”

“And so then...like, he really wanted me to talk about...”

“Fucking the waiter. I had a boyfriend like this one time,” Lily waved her hands.

Adria frowned. She was surprised to hear that John's “thing” wasn't even surprising to Lily. Maybe even a little disappointed. After all, her own

preferences, and now John's, seemed so dirty to her...and yet Lily was acting like this happened to everyone, every day.

She continued anyway. "And then later he says..." Adria covered her face again. "He said, I don't know...'I can tell you want rougher sex,' and, 'that was really hot when you flirted with the waiter,' and then..."

Lily slapped her again with the back of his hand. "Oh this is good! This is good news, *amiga*, you can use this. He wants you to do it for real, no? And so everybody wins. You should be happy. What is the problem?"

"He..yeah...he said something like, maybe we could have an arrangement -"

"That's what you need. That's perfect. Then you give my friend a call...oh, *chava*, what's the problem?" She reached out and grabbed Adria's face. "You look so sad. This is great. You get your fantasy, he watches you..." Lily spread her hands out, gave a serpentine shake of her upper torso, and thickened up her accent. "You're both happy. Problem...solution." She set her hands down. "No?"

Adria shook her head. "Okay," she said. "It sounds good. But...I don't know. It just doesn't seem like it will really work out like that. You know? I mean, I don't get it at all. His thing. What does he get out of it? That's the part that bothers me. And then it's like, okay, so if he feels like that, fine...but shouldn't he be...I dunno. Jealous or something? Instead of turned on. I mean, seriously, Lily. He was like..."

Lily made a fist to describe John's cock where Adria's words failed. "I know. I told you, my ex, he was like this. His cock got so hard just thinking about it."

Adria raised an eyebrow. "So did you ever..."

Lily shrugged. "Of course."

Adria opened her mouth in surprise. "And it was like...okay?"

Lily threw her head back and laughed. "Oh my god," she said. Then she seized Adria's arm with a talon grip. "You are like, somebody from the fifties', I swear to god."

"It wasn't weird, though?" Adria said impatiently.

“No. No, it was hot.”

“No I mean...like, after.”

Lily tiskied again and returned to her closed-eye resting position. “You are serious. I can't believe you are serious. *Mira*, men, they are not this complicated, okay? If he says, 'I want to watch you fuck some other guy,' then you do it, and he will have a hard cock, and that's all you need to know. The only thing stopping you is if you don't want to do it, but you do, so you have a perfect situation on your hands.” She shook her head again.

“It would be different, *muñeca*, if wanted you to fuck a...yeti or something. But a man?” She laughed again.

Adria stared at her.

“I don' maybe know the word in English,” Lily said, as if the issue that needed clarification was that one.

“You know what?” Lily said, gathering sudden energy. “Come with me. We'll do some dancing, you take John, we watch you getting sweaty with a hot man...there is this man, Fernando, *panameño*. He is like a rock in his head, but he is...” Lily seemed unable to find a word for Fernando and his heat, so she shook her hand and sucked in her lower lip. “And I will tell you what John is doing. You see? If he really likes it. And then...you can call my friend, order what you like, and have a good time.”

Adria was still staring at her.

“What's the problem?” Lily asked.

She seemed genuinely confused.

Adria shrugged.

She wasn't sure what the problem was, either.

11 FERNANDO

Lily made plans to go to *La Flaca*, and all the way home Adria thought about how she would lure John to the small, very Latino club. He was not a dancer, he did not like noise, and he was utterly mystified by Latino culture in any form. He even viewed sangria with mild suspicion.

Halfway through the drive, she realized that she was going to lure John to the club with promises to flirt with another man. Which left her with a bit of a...what would it be? Paradox? Because why would she need to go to the club, and have Lily “assess” John's behavior, if she already knew that she could get him there just telling him that's what she was going to do?

It all boiled down to this: she knew John was serious.

So what did *she* want?

She hadn't settled on an answer to the question by the time she got home, but she knew one thing: there was an allure to the plan, something she liked about it. Something that stirred inside of her, got her excited – and not “Christmas morning” excited.

Filthy porn excited.

John was home and tucked away in his office. Probably on Reddit. He was addicted to a set of oddball subreddits that dedicated themselves to things like good cable setups for IT and really obscure Linux operating systems. He probably had his headphones on watching the world's most boring documentary. Usually he wandered in to try and have sex, so she expected him any minute.

Adria glided to the bedroom and opened the closet. She dug through her clothes – largely conservative – and found, tucked away in a section of evening dresses for the occasional cocktail party, the dress she was looking for. She had only worn it once, and only to a party that John hadn't attended.

He had never seen it, and she had felt a little too exposed in it. But now, she felt like putting it on.

It was a black dress, with a skirt that flared and came to just above her knees, perfect for salsa dancing. That wasn't the risqué part. The tight-fitted bodice had a plunging neckline that exposed the swells of her breasts and her chest. No back. It was very sexy, but it wasn't her usual style.

When she put it on, though, and turned for the mirror, she was surprised to find that the dress *didn't* feel particularly risqué. Not like it had that night a year ago when she had worn it and covered up with a shawl most of the night in spite of the sweltering heat.

She looked at her chest. She was a fit, muscular girl at the core, and her breasts were medium-sized but well-supported by her taut frame, and they looked great, barely restrained by the scanty fabric of the dress. Her arms were toned, and her skin was flawless and creamy.

She let her hair down and smoothed it out with a straight iron.

She normally didn't put on makeup – she didn't need it, and she felt like too much of any one thing quickly transformed her cream-and-freckles, Midwestern looks to white-trash-whore. But the dress was expensive, and it showed, and her hair looked expensive and sophisticated. She dabbed a light lipstick on and assessed her appearance.

Good. But she wanted something a little more...

She dug into her makeup drawer, the single disorganized place in the house. At the back of the piles of makeup containers, used once and never again, she found what she was looking for.

After applying the eye shadow, she turned again in front of the mirror. She was amazed John hadn't wandered in by now.

Her blue eyes gleamed from the pockets of smokey gray she had applied. Her eyes looked larger than ever, and striking. She was satisfied with the look. She squinted at herself, being critical to make sure she didn't look trashy. And then she walked down the hall to shake John from the absorbing documentary like never before.

John slid his headphones from his ears, and stared at her.

She smiled, a little nervously. It was not *exactly* the reaction she had hoped for. He looked more like a deer in the headlights.

John stared at his wife. He was completely unsure what was going on. His mind raced through his near-perfect mental agenda, and found nothing – no appointments, no cocktail parties, no awards. His eyes were glued to Adria's chest, and the spectacular plunge of the neckline of the dress she was wearing.

Then up to her eyes. Her blue eyes pierced through a black haze. She looked like model in a retro ad. Her hair was down, her lips were pink, her skin was everywhere. She was right on the verge of looking a little...trashy. He felt his cock getting hard. He tried to move his mouth, but it was useless.

Luckily, Adria seemed to have a plan. She slinked into the office and sat on the edge of his desk. "I have a plan," she said.

"Uh..." he managed to say. "Tonight? Did I forget something?"

She shook her head. Her eyes were gleaming. Jesus, she looked hot.

"Now, I know you hate dancing. And I know you hate clubs. And I know you hate sangria. But tonight we're going dancing with Lily."

He couldn't take his eyes off her lovely breasts. "Uh..."

She leaned over, and he was treated to a nice view of the curve of her perfect mounds, and her swan-like neck. "I know you hate it," she whispered. "But I think I can make it entertaining for you."

His cock just about exploded right there. He looked up at her as she sat back upright.

"Get ready," she said, spinning off the desk and sauntering out of the room. "We have to meet Lily at eight."

Eight. On a Wednesday.

"What are...where are you going?" he croaked.

She was already on her way to the kitchen. "Dinner, silly. You want something?"

John looked down at his cock.

I think I can make it entertaining for you.

He may or may not have yelled, “No thanks,” as he headed for the bedroom to get ready.

If Lily had somehow been transformed into a dance club, she would have ended up as *La Flaca*. The place was small, elegantly sleazy, and filled with striking Latino and white suburban cliches, which was pretty much Lily's life in a nutshell. The interior was somehow entirely red: red lights, red walls, with only the occasional streak of green-turned-brown by the red lights or reddened yellow to break up the pulsing, throbbing blood color. The tables were crammed up against the walls to make room for the dancefloor, and when they arrived at eight pm, the place was already full.

“These are the old people,” Lily said, fluttering a dismissive hand at the dancefloor, where a couple who did not seem old at all except for a single silver streak in the man's black hair, were tearing up the dance floor in very steamy, perfected movements that made Adria's head spin.

“I can't do that,” she whispered to Lily.

Lily snickered. “It's easy if you are the girl. You just spin and spin, try not to get dizzy. Now *you*, ” she said, pointing a slender finger at John, “you have to know what you're doing.”

Adria gave John a sympathetic look. He was being an excellent sport, but this was the last location he would have chosen to be. He was only here because she had promised him something. Something very naughty.

They sat down at a tiny table against the wall and near the dancefloor. Lily chattered with a waitress in supersonic Spanish, and after she left they were informed of their drink orders. Lily had kindly ordered a beer for John.

“I know you hate sangria.”

Before the drinks arrived, Lily shot up a hand and beckoned someone to the table in more lightening-fast Spanish. “It's Fernando,” she explained, briefly.

Fernando was everything Lily had promised. His dark skin fell somewhere on the mosaic of Caribbean people: mocha-colored skin, a shock of thick, straight black hair, and brown eyes flecked with green. His face was devastatingly handsome, and his body of lean muscle moved with a quiet, masculine grace.

Adria wasn't sure if her stomach would have dropped as much as it did had it not been for their "plan," but when he took her extended hand and brought it to his lips when they were introduced, she felt as though she had a whole different body inside of her, plummeting and soaring at the same time. She could feel her face flush.

Lily winked at her as she mumbled something incoherent. "So this is your friend who wants to learn to dance," he said. His comment was for Lily but he didn't take his eyes off Adria.

Adria actually felt herself going weak at the knees. She was grateful to be sitting.. "I...think I need a drink first."

Fernando smiled, and shrugged. "Don't worry," he said. He looked at John. "Your wife is in good hands with me."

Adria looked at John. She could see the same expression gathering on his face, the one from the restaurant. Her own heart beat faster.

Lily took Fernando's hand. "Well. Let's not waste any time," and the two of them strode onto the dance floor. In no time at all, they were swirling and floating through the rest of the dancers as though they were a professional team. Their lean, dancer bodies pressed against each other and then fell apart, Lily spun in what seemed like endless circles. Her red skirt spun out and the full length of her legs was revealed to all, with her black underwear flashing its snug, lacy fabric occasionally.

John tipped his beer into his mouth and edged his chair a little further back. Lily leaned against her own chair. They were so snugly packed now that her arm ended up resting against his. Her skin was hot and damp with sweat. He took his eyes off the dance floor for a second to sweep his gaze over the round, caramel hills of her breasts, spilling from the slouching top of her dress. Her slender, firm limbs seemed to be everywhere, moving loosely. As he always did around Lily, he wondered briefly what it would

feel like to fuck a girl like her: she was petite but she seemed like a wildcat, with her untamed black hair, her mouth that seemed to always be open and laughing, and her taut, vibrant energy.

Lily gave him a look, and it was disconcerting. She always disconcerted him. She seemed to know what he was thinking. Trying to be suave, he turned back to the dance floor. After all, he was more interested in the sultry Fernando, whom Adria had promised to flirt with.

Lily fanned herself with a brochure of some kind. The warm air tickled his neck.

“I’m so hot,” she said, and he could see her teasing smile in the corner of his eye.

Fernando and Adria were standing at the corner of the dance floor. Adria brushed a strand of her hair from her face. She was smiling, looking down at her feet, and the two of them were moving slowly back and forth. A shudder went through John as he looked at where Fernando's hands were: one holding her hand, the other on her waist. Low on her waist, fingers resting on the curve of her ass.

His cock had been semi-hard since he had seen Fernando, and let his mind wander to the endless possibilities with him. When his fantasies set in on him, he reached for his throat and *gripped* him. He could feel part of his mind willing Fernando and Adria closer together, until the sweat of his body dampened her shirt.

“They look good together,” Lily commented. John felt his heart squeeze.

“Good thing he's so tall,” she continued.

John gave Lily the closet thing to a side-eye that he possessed. She seemed to be fishing for something, and since John had never trusted Lily any further than he could throw her (which was actually, probably, a terrible metaphor because most people could throw Lily a decent distance), his heckles were raised.

John narrowed his eyes in answer to her and focused on his wife and Fernando. Now they were starting to dance. He eyed his wife's body, and her supple breasts as they pressed up against Fernando's body. Their hands

were aloft, and they moved together in a series of complicated steps, which Adria seemed to have gotten the hang of rather quickly.

He let a wave of suspicion wash over him, pleasant and awful.

Maybe she came here all the time. Maybe she had danced with Fernando before...

Adria's hips were right at Fernando's. A perfect fit: his cock was right against the convex hollow of her pussy. If he was hard, and John couldn't see how he couldn't be, his big Latino cock was pressing right against her inner thigh. Or maybe her engorged cunt. Maybe she was even getting off as they swayed against each other, and his cock rubbed her clit, which protruded like the swollen innards of an exotic flower when she was aroused.

John wiped sweat from his forehead. He was suddenly aware that Lily was watching him with undo attention.

His cock was incredibly, inexplicably, almost painfully hard, just like it had been at the restaurant.

Fernando gave Adria a spin, and John watched in awe as his wife twirled with incredible grace, and her skirt flared to reveal nearly all of her legs, and a glimpse of her black panties. A few people in the restaurant cheered, and while it could have been for any of the other dancers, John was convinced that it was for his wife, and her long legs, and the near-perfect view of her underwear.

He watched, his heart sinking with every snug embrace the two made, his irritation building as Lily continued to watch him with that queer expression on her face, his heart racing, his cock filling to painful with excitement. His mind was overflowing with images of the dark-skinned Fernando and his wife, naked, their complementary skin tones against each other, dripping with sweat. Adria's voice filled his ears, as she moaned and squealed her way to a nuclear orgasm with Fernando's hot, sweaty, black cock inside of her...

"I have to go...to the..." he said, standing up at the same time. He looked down at Lily, who wore a devious smile on her face as always. Her eyes, though, seemed lit up by more mischief than usual. She moved her jaw back and forth in smug delight and waved at him.

Her eyes dropped, ever-so-briefly, to his crotch, where he knew his erection was evident. Another shift of the jaw, and then she returned her eyes to his. “Okay, John,” she said.

And she winked.

He stumbled through the crowded floor, feeling foolish and hoping his erection wasn't as obvious as it felt. He felt ill, and he was on an unparalleled high. He stopped in the doorway of the narrow hall that led to the bathrooms (grateful for having learned at least one word from high school Spanish), and looked back at his wife and Fernando.

They had stopped dancing, evidently so that Fernando could explain something to her. He was holding her hand, his big, dark fingers wrapped around her pale and slender left hand. Their wedding ring glinted through their entwined flesh. John shuddered. He needed to sit down. But he couldn't tear his eyes away.

Fernando leaned in, and spoke very close to Adria's ear. She turned her head slightly, to hear him better, and from where he was it seemed to John that his lips brushed over her neck.

Surely not, but it looked that way.

Adria smiled. She nodded.

They started to dance again.

Only this time, their bodies were pressed hard together. Fernando's chest was against hers: surely he was getting a nice feel for her full tits, and her candy-colored nipples were pressing against his, as he rocked and swayed her hips with his. Their legs seemed entangled – only more room for them to be rubbing against each other, aware of each other's lewd desires, their bodies betraying whatever “friendly” facade they were trying to put on.

And then another spin. And then:

Adria leaned back, and dropped her head backward. Her hair fell like a waterfall, stained red by the light of the club, and her long, elegant neck was exposed from the deep cut of her dress between her breasts to her sharp chin. And Fernando took it all in with such an obscene gaze, walking his eyes along the length of her body, that John was sure she could feel his

tongue along the length of her chest. They paused like this, and then Fernando lifted his gaze.

Right to John.

A smirk flickered in his mouth. He held John's gaze (and his wife), and then they spun away.

John felt as though he had been kicked in the stomach. He stumbled down the narrow hallway and into the men's room, where he was grateful to find a single, tiny stall to lock himself into and try to get under control.

He panted for a few moments, trying to take his mind off what he had seen and all of the filthy thoughts it had inspired. His cock was obnoxiously hard and didn't seem to be going anywhere, even given that the bathroom was crowded and men were pissing behind him in the urinal every few seconds.

He looked up at the ceiling and tried to rid his mind of his thoughts, but they only swarmed in on him.

Adria's legs spreading wide, her eyes growing big and dark with excitement as she stared at Fernando's naked body and the massive member between his legs, headed for her...

He couldn't go back out there like this. He had no idea how long Adria would be dancing, or Lily staring, and he would hit somebody in the face with this erection if he tried to squeeze out there again.

He could not believe what he was about to do.

He unzipped his pants.

It took no time at all, once he let down the floodgates, for him to stroke himself off, into the toilet, a few streaks of cum landing on the floor. His mind filled so quickly with thoughts of Adria, bent over and holding one of her asscheeks as Fernando slowly fucked her, in long, languid strokes, while she squealed in delight.

He stared at his hand on his cock.

It suddenly seemed insane, what he was doing. He hastily grabbed some toilet paper and wiped himself off. Then he stumbled out of the stall. He could feel the eyes of the bathroom's occupants on him, and it seemed to

him that they knew what was in his mind, what he had been doing. He washed his hands and made his way back to the table, shaking.

Adria was evidently still dancing. Lily was frowning, alone at the table. “Oh my god,” she shouted, but slowly, annoyed. She slapped her purse on the table. “I have been waiting here bored forever. Watch my purse, *Yone*, there is a very handsome man who wants to dance with me.”

And her attention was – thankfully – diverted immediately. She extended her hands to an approaching man, who looked no more than twenty, and they spun away to dance.

John looked around the room, searching for Fernando and Adria. Part of him wanted not to find them, he realized. Part of him wanted for Fernando to have pulled Adria outside with him, and for her to be sliding up and down the brick wall of the alley. The other part of him was desperate to find them, and see for himself that his worst nightmares weren't coming true.

They weren't on the dance floor. He felt a surge of panic, one that was actually silly: he felt like he couldn't leave the table and Lily's purse. He stood up, but when he did, his eyes came to rest on Adria's hair, and he saw that the two of them were rucked away at the bar.

Adria caught his eye, and winked playfully. She was poised atop a bar stool, her legs crossed, and she was tipping a bottle of water back. John watched in a mixture of admiration and seething jealousy as she – deliberately – “spilled” some water down her throat. It ran right between her breasts, and she smiled at Fernando, dabbing a napkin he offered her in the canyon between her breasts. She slid her skirt up a little with one hand as she crossed her legs.

A glass of beer arrived next to her, and someone cleared away for Fernando to have a seat. John was trapped – pleasantly trapped, if he was being fair – across the room. Dancers obscured his view and then swirled away to give him only a glimpse at a time of his wife and Fernando. Here was Adria biting her finger and smiling...Adria uncrossing her legs...Adria's skirt rising along her thigh...Adria uncrossing her legs again and giving Fernando a nice flash of her underwear.

Adria being really quite obscene, for a public setting.

An exaggerated puff of air and the sweet smell of heated, feminine flesh alerted him to the presence of Lily next to him.

She set a sweating bottle of beer next to his arm and clinked it with her own bottle. “Cheers, *Yone*. *Gracias por* watching my purse, *cariño*.” He could feel Lily looking at him, but he couldn't tear his eyes away from Adria and Fernando. Even though he could barely see them, and he could only see flashes of what Adria was doing...her ever-rising skirt, her fingers playing across her chest, her wide, inviting smile, her leg moving closer and closer to Fernando's...

“Oye, hey, hello? *Yone*?” Lily snapped her fingers in front of his face.

He looked at her.

“I brought you a beer. What are you looking at over there, hmm?” She leaned over, looking in the direction of the bar, but she was already nodding because she already knew.

“Oh my god,” she said. “Adria has her hand on Fernando's cock!”

His eyes steered themselves violently in that direction, and his pulse surged. It was too late to hide his reaction from Lily, even though he realized a second later she was only winding him up. She was already chuckling and leaning back in her chair. “I'm just joking at you, *Yone*.” But her eyes met his over the bottle of beer, and something else was in them. Almost, if he was being honest, a certain hostile complicity.

But Lily was whisked away by another, different young man, who appeared and placed his hands on her shoulders suggestively, and whispered something in her ear that made her smile and forget all about teasing *Yone*.

So he sat there, and drank his beer, while his wife flitted next to Fernando, the hot Latino dancer. It was a scene he couldn't look away from, no matter how much it made his chest hurt and his stomach churn like he was going to vomit. And that was because his cock was incredibly, almost painfully hard again.

He watched until Lily broke the two of them up. She appeared next to Fernando and placed her flirtatious hand on his shoulder. Fernando went out to the dance floor and Lily paused next to Adria, drinking a water, her pretty chest rising up and down with the exertion of her incredible dancing.

Whatever Lily said to Adria, it made Adria flash her eyes to John. And then back to Lily. Her face changed, and it was hard to say exactly what she was expressing.

Fernando came back for Lily, and pulled her away from the bar. Lily let herself be pulled away, while still talking to Adria, her hand extended. Her mouth in a big smile.

Almost certainly, making some filthy, clever comment as she left.

The way Lily tended to do.

Adria finished her drink. She met John's eyes and smiled. She crossed the dance floor, weaving through the dancers like a nymph. Every one on the dance floor was sexy and pretty, but Adria stood out. She was taller, blonder, and more beautiful than anyone there. He watched like she was a goddess, an ethereal creature he would never be able to touch. Entranced. His heart felt stopped in his chest.

But when she placed her cheek near his, he could feel the very real heat of her body, and the movement of air as her breath caressed his neck and earlobe. "Let's go," her voice purred.

Her hand darted between his legs, and made a leisurely pass over his hard cock, through the material of his pants.

He barely remembered how they exited the tightly-packed club. Adria led him by the hand, and they got into the car. Then they made out like teenagers. Groping each other, burning from the inside out with desire. John slid his hands along Adria's thighs until he found her underwear. He could feel the bump of her hard clit and the dampness of the satin material of her panties. She raked her fingernails over his shaft through his pants, and he shuddered.

But they were in a very bright, very public parking lot, and so they brought each other to a painful precipice, and then Adria pushed John back into his seat. "Not here," she laughed. "Let's go home."

She left her hand in his lap as he drove, and he could scarcely think straight as she made languid circles over his balls, barely touching them but sending ripples of pleasure over the sensitive surface of his skin.

“Fernando is a really good dancer,” she said, as though it were an offhand remark. She watched his face, and seeing the effect she was having on him, she smiled. His cock throbbed in his pants. He hoped she could feel it. He hoped she would be encouraged to go on, to go into more detail, to tell him even more about Fernando.

“I caught him looking under my skirt, did you see?”

John sucked in his breath. He had seen. He nodded.

He knew she could feel with her fingers that he liked it.

“Tell me more,” he said, when she paused too long.

Adria turned to him. “Really?”

He nodded.

“I could feel his cock against my back all night.”

“Oh god,” John said in a low voice. He could hardly focus on the road. All of his senses seemed to be draining away from his conscious mind and dedicating themselves to imagining, in detail, the feel of Fernando's cock on his wife's lower back.

“It seemed like he wasn't totally hard, but his cock was big. Like, really big. All the way down the side of one pant leg.”

The blinker was on. John heard it clicking and flicked it off. He was driving straight. Only a few more blocks. Adria's fingers were scraping tickles up and down his shaft. He felt his cock pulse again.

“Did he want to fuck you?” he asked hoarsely.

Adria tossed her head back against the headrest. She smiled widely. “Of course he did.” She smiled a little more when she felt his cock flex beneath her fingers.

“Did you want to fuck him?”

There was a pause. A delicious and awful pause, while his wife considered the question.

“Did *you* want me to fuck him?”

When he didn't answer she looked straight ahead. He could see from her features, even in the corner of his eye, that she was fairly pleased with herself, and her power over him. She kept stroking his cock with a feathery touch. "Did you want me to get down on my knees and suck the cum from his cock?"

The image produced itself in his mind. He felt a gush of precum dampen his underwear.

They were in their own neighborhood now. Only a few minutes until they were home.

John veered the car over to the curb anyway, unable to take any more of Adria's ridiculous teasing. They were maybe six blocks from home. He jerked the car into first gear and let the clutch out before he even turned off the car. It jerked forward, almost hitting the car in front of them. Adria was wowed by this and raised her eyebrows.

By then he was already leaning over to her side, unbuckling his pants, and taking his cock out, all in a fevered and hurried motion. He leaned over her body and grabbed the release for her seatback. He climbed on top of her, which was a complicated feat but he was so hungry it wasn't hard.

"John, we're -"

But he placed his hand over her mouth, and used his other hand to push her skirt up. Her legs fell open, and he pulled hastily at her panties, trying to push them down. When that didn't work he pushed them aside with the same haste, and then he was inside of her.

Her cunt was richly hot and wet. His zipper scraped against him, and her panties cut into her flesh, but his cock was so hot and hard that he didn't care. He sank into her flesh and felt her wrap her legs around him, absorbing him into her body.

He let his mind summon all of the images he could of Adria, leaning in to whisper in Fernando's ear. Adria, letting him look up the length of her skirt to her panties.

"Did you like it when he looked at your underwear?" John breathed.

Adria tightened her grip on his neck, and her pussy clenched around his cock. "Why do you think I let him do it?" she said.

John groaned, and he knew Adria could feel his cock pulsing inside of her. A smile came onto her lips – that same knowing smile, the one that cut through him, in a way, because it had a look of knowledge of her power over him in it. “I spent most of my time imagining what it would feel like if he put his big cock inside of me,” she purred. Then she moaned, because John thrust inside of her all the way to her core.

She lifted her legs and pushed them against the windshield to brace herself as John slammed inside of her sloshing cunt. “Is that why you're so wet?” he said.

He pushed himself up just in time to look at her face as she smiled wryly, and said: “Of course it is.”

He groaned as his orgasm shuddered out of him, filling her up, at that exact moment.

Adria ground her hips up against him and let herself go. They slowed to a rocking motion, and John leaned against her body.

With a jolt, he realized where they were, and quickly hopped into the driver's seat. Adria wiped the windshield clear for him with a grin.

“I hope the neighbors are in bed by now,” she said.

They laughed, but they drove off quickly. The scene suddenly seemed a little obscene for their age.

“So you would really want me to go further?” Adria asked, chewing on her thumbnail and looking out the car window. They were still in the garage. The car was turned off and they were in the middle of another strange silence.

John wasn't entirely sure what she wanted him to say.

He rubbed his palm on the steering wheel, fingers splayed, and made a sound while he did it.

“Look, Dri,” he said, using her long-abandoned nickname from college. Once it left his mouth, he felt the affection of it, as though it were a long time ago, and he was dropping her off at a dorm. He forgot what he was going to say.

Adria's head turned quickly. She ran her eyes over his face.

He sighed. "Okay. I think it's pretty obvious this turns both of us on. Can we start there?"

She put her hand to her mouth and covered it as she laughed. "Okay."

Because there certainly wasn't any dispute about that.

"The question you're asking is: do I just like pretending, or do I want you to actually do something? And we...this is like a Mexican standoff. I think we're both afraid to say yes or no to that question because we're worried that the other person has a different answer."

Adria looked at him.

There was another silence.

"I don't really know what my answer is," she said finally. Her voice was contorted by the emotion of the truth.

"Me either."

"But we both have something we're leaning toward," she said.

John nodded.

Another silence.

"Okay, let's count to three and say it. If it's different than we stop talking about it forever. How does that sound?"

This was how Adria resolved her difficult questions. It was a very pragmatic solution, John had to admit. It forced you to be honest, to choose a side, and it gave them an out if there was a disagreement. They had done the same thing about getting married, about a move, about a new job.

And just like those issues, he suspected very strongly that they each knew the other person's answer anyway.

"Okay," he said. "On three."

"On three, like, 'one, two, three, say it...?' Or on three like -"

They both laughed. This was also an old joke.

"Okay."

“Okay.”

John's stomach twisted, and he felt a surge of panic. But he dove in.

“One...two...three...”

When the same word came out of their mouths, their eyes met, and they smiled.

“That's such a good way to get to the bottom of things,” John said softly.

They looked out the windshield, as if there were something to see besides their garage.

“Now what?” John said, finally.

Adria looked at him, and they laughed again. It all seemed mildly ridiculous, on the one hand. “I guess we just wait for an opportunity to come up. Right?”

“I don't know. I..uh...haven't ever done this before.”

They laughed again and Adria dropped her eyes.

“I can't believe we just had sex in front of somebody's house,” she said, opening the door.

John followed her into the house. The same feeling from the club, of being hypnotized by his wife, happened to him again. Adria tossed her purse on the counter and walked through the house without turning on the lights. But her walk was suggestive. Inviting. He wasn't sure how he knew that at first, but there was no doubt of it when she lifted her dress up by the bottom hem and slid it over her head as she walked down the hall.

In spite of just having fucked in the car, John could feel his body getting ready to go again. He hadn't felt like this in years. Maybe ever. Adria's pale body slinked in the moonlight that came through the windows, disappearing in the shadows and then reappearing again. It felt like a long walk, following her, to the bedroom.

She turned and sat down on the edge of the bed. Her breasts were caught in the moonlight and her face was in a shadow. The form of her taut

curves was highlighted in pale silver, outlined by the dark gray of the night. Her nipples were hard. She slid her fingers under the fabric of her panties and squirmed out of them, until they dropped to the floor, still around her ankles. They were wet and made a dull plop on the carpet.

She reached out her hands, and he moved close to her. She pulled him to standing in front of her by the belt buckle, and undid his belt while she looked up at him mischievously. He shuddered.

She pulled the belt out and unzipped his pants, pulling them down along with his boxers. Their previous adventure had left his cock sticky with her own juices and smeared with his cum. His cock bounced out, erect and smelling of sex. She grasped it in her hand, and brought it to her mouth.

She tipped her head slightly, and stuck out her tongue to run the flat, full blade of it along the length of his shaft. She started at the base and drew her tongue up to the crown, lapping up the cum from sex in car. When she reached the crown, she pursed her lips and sucked at his dripping hole, wetting her lips with the precum that was, almost incredibly, gushing from his cock again.

Then she licked the other side of his cock down to the base, and ducked under his cock to get the underside. Back up to his glans, where she made a delicious swirl with her wet tongue.

She looked up at him as she opened her mouth, and slowly took him inside. Teasing. One inch at a time, her mouth closed tight around him. She sucked on his meat and massaged him with her tongue. He expected her to stop any moment, but she kept going, further, further down to the base of his cock. Her lips pressed against his pelvic bone and his balls, and he gasped. Adria never did anything like this.

She slid her mouth with the same teasing slowness back along the length of his cock, until she could open her mouth and gasp for air.

She took his hand, and placed it on her head, and he grasped her hair and shuddered as she moved forward on his cock again. She stopped about two inches into her mouth, though, and looked at him. Taunting him with her eyes and her tongue.

He pushed gently on her head, and though it was impossible to tell because her mouth was full of cock, she seemed to smile. He pushed her all

the way down to the base of his cock, and he felt her gag slightly.

He pulled back on her hair, and her mouth slid over the length of his cock. Her tongue pulsed over him. She looked up at him, almost pleading with him. She teased him, sucking at the tip of his cock, but made it clear that if he wanted her to suck him more, he would have to push her himself.

He felt an urge, one he had never really felt with her before, and he grabbed her hair fiercely and pushed her head down, forcing her to take his cock all the way to the back of her throat. And then back up. He was overcome by the lewdly delicious feel of it, grasping a woman's head in his hands and moving her mouth up and down his cock. He moved her head faster, losing himself in the moment. In a way, he forgot that she was his wife, and used her like he never had before, like a toy.

When he felt cum boiling at the base of his cock, he did another unusual thing. He was overcome by the desire to push her head deep onto his cock, and spray his cum into the back of her throat.

"I'm coming," he said, and he let the pressure off her head for a second, to give her a chance to pull away. But she didn't, so he grasped her head with both hands and thrust his cock deep into her throat. He came deep in her mouth, and he could feel a small wave of gagging in her body, but she swallowed it all and massaged every last drop of his cum out with her tongue and her throat.

He felt her head push against him, and he stared as she slid from his cock and then began to lick the last of his cum from his shaft, cleaning him off in long, languid laps of her tongue. He watched, shuddering with the too-painful pleasure of it. His cock was still hard.

It took him a moment to notice that she was using her hand to stroke herself as she licked his cum from his dick. Finally, she paused, her eyes closed, his cock still in her hand, and he watched her beautiful body shudder violently as she made herself come.

Then she fell back onto the bed, exhausted. And laughed.

John fell down next to her, and she squirmed up to the top of the bed. He punched a place for his head on the pillow, and she lay her head on his chest.

“That was incredible,” he said, finally. “It wasn't...too much, was it?” He was talking about the hand on her head, the pressure he put on her to suck his cock.

“No,” Adria said, her voice sleepy.

“Adria,” he said. “Are we actually serious about doing this?”

Her fingers were moving over his chest, and they were slowing. She was falling asleep. She'd had a lot more to drink than he had. But it was on his mind as though he had just woken with a problem in the middle of the night.

It bothered him, actually, that Adria was able to fall asleep like this, without thinking too much more about this huge step they had agreed to take in their marriage.

“John,” she said finally. “I just want you...stand next to the chair..”

He was confused for second and then he realized that she was half-asleep. He shook her slightly. “Adria. I'm serious.”

“Sorry,” she said, and she smiled. “I'm falling asleep. Something about soccer. John I just wholeheartedly was I going to say? Just want you to be happy. I just want us to be happy.”

She opened her eyes, but he could see they were heavy with sangria, sex, and sleep.

He kissed her on the forehead. There was no point trying to get more out of her now.

Anyway, that was what he really wanted to hear, wasn't it?

He tried to close his eyes and go to sleep. But it was a long time coming.

Adria woke up in the morning and rolled over to kiss John. She had the rested countenance of a person who had slept well. In spite of too much booze, too much sex, and having agreed to have an affair for her husband's pleasure. None of these things appeared to have affected her sleep. She stood up, stretched, and trotted to the shower after giving John a brief “good morning.” She didn't mention their agreement, or what had transpired.

John, on the other hand, spent nearly every second of his day thinking about it. Wondering what would be in store for him next. If Adria was really going to go through with it, or if she would drag him along with endless teasing.

He wasn't sure if it mattered: the teasing was hot as hell.

And then there was the fact that he couldn't be entirely sure if what he wanted was for her to actually do it.

He was saying he did.

He thought he did.

He had told her he did. But he had half-expected her to say “no,” that night in the car. Maybe more than half-expected it. When she had said “yes” he had felt an excitement like never before surge through him, but he had also felt – and he knew this was ridiculous – a tidal wave of betrayal wash over him.

It wasn't fair, and he knew that. He was acting like a crazy person, and he knew that, too.

He spent a lot of his time analyzing himself. Trying to get at the bottom of his erratic behavior.

But this was one problem John wasn't fully able to get to the end of.

Probably because, he suspected, it was not math. It was a complex problem, with more than one answer at the end of it.

He decided to wait and see what Adria did. Let the matter be out of his hands, and in hers: if she led them down this path, he would follow. But

if she hesitated or decided to change her mind, he would not press the issue any more.

The waiting, though, felt like he had a school of cold fish in his stomach.

Luckily, he didn't have to wait very long.

12 WEDDING

John sighed as he sat down on the bed. He held up two dress socks to double-check they were the same.

Adria ruffled his hair as she walked by him on her way to the closet. “No being grumpy,” she said, playfully.

“I hate this kind of thing.”

“I know.” Adria stepped into the walk-in closet and began fishing through her clothes. John's bad mood was temporarily assuaged by the sight of his wife, wrapped in a towel that barely came to below her ass. Her long legs seemed leaner, and he felt his cock twitch with excitement.

“I'll tell you what,” she said, pulling a red and white patterned dress from amid the hangers of clothing. “If you can keep from being grumpy maybe I can do something for you. In return.” She held the dress up so that he could see it. “What do you think?”

“About...the dress...or the...” he stammered. The dress confused him: it seemed like scraps of fabric on the hanger. His mind was still swirling around “*maybe I can do something for you. In return.*” His mouth went dry and flapped uselessly with no sound coming out.

It slowly dripped over him: this was the day.

Adria nodded, as though he had said something. “You need to see it on,” she said.

The towel dropped to the floor. Her nude body was on display for him for a moment: her long limbs, the gentle curve of her waist, her pink nipples, like tiny candies in the center of her small aureole. Her feathery yellow bush, neatly trimmed and almost white, a gossamer veil over her bright pink cunt.

Then she turned, and headed to the dresser. He watched her slide a white lace thong from her ankles to her hips, using one finger to pull the

thong out and then into place, nestled between the two spheres of her perfect ass. She raised her hands over her head with the complicated dress in her fingers, and the fabric slid and slithered over her body. She tugged at it until it was in place. She gave a twirl.

John exhaled.

The dress was a throwback to fifties-era dresses, except for the front, which plunged nearly to her sternum. The cut of the top had the effect of enlarging the appearance of her breasts, and the flare of the skirt made her hips appear slightly larger as well. She looked like a pin-up girl.

“That. Is a sexy dress,” John managed to say.

She was putting earrings in her ears. “Now,” she said. “I have a question.” Seeing that she had John's full attention, she retrieved something from the dresser. “Thigh-high pantyhose, or no?”

John swallowed. “I think I need to see them on,” he said.

Adria smiled, teasing, and placed a foot next to him on the bed. She expertly slid the hosiery from her foot to her thigh. The dress fell away from her leg and gave John an unobstructed view of the intricate white lace that barely covered her snatch, and her lean thigh. The stocking terminated mid-thigh in a band of complex, sexy white lace. Adria smiled at him and performed the same slow, sexy routine with the other leg.

She held the skirt up for him as she turned on the floor in front of him. “What do you think?”

“I like it.”

She dropped the skirt. “But do you think,” she purred. “That someone *else* might like it?”

He was dumbstruck again, so she moved toward him, smiling. “There are always a lot of new people at weddings. We hardly know anyone there at all. There's a reason people tend to 'hook up' at these things.”

John felt as though his insides had been set to sea on a boat. In the meantime, his cock was twitching uncontrollably to an all-time high level of readiness. He could feel his heart in his chest. She wasn't serious, though, was she?

She was really going to do this? Only a week after they'd discussed it?

“You're not serious,” he said.

She crawled on to his lap, spreading her dress out carefully so as not to wrinkle it. “Aren't I?” she said, and she smiled when she felt his cock twitch against her thigh. She put her forearms on his shoulders. Her dress breasts seemed to pour toward him, fuller than ever, held back only by the pretty flower fabric of the dress. “I want you to have a good time at this wedding. And it seems to me like you have a lot of fun if *I* have a lot of fun.”

A small part of John's mind was working very diligently on the pragmatics of this conversation. A very small part. But his cock was robbing his higher functions of blood, and he couldn't maintain that train of thought for more than a nanosecond.

“What will...I mean, are you sure?” His sentence ended in a whisper. His voice caught in his throat as Adria's pretty breasts moved closer to his face, and she pressed her hips against his. She gave her hair a toss and undulated in his arms. He found himself sliding his hands up along her frame. His fingers moved over patches of her silky dress and her skin. She trembled with pleasure.

Then she sat up straight to unzip her dress. “I don't want to mess it up,” she explained, grinning at him. She slid it over her head and tossed it onto the floor, but neatly.

Her breasts were now in front of him, and he took one of her small pink nipples into his mouth. Her freshly-showered skin smelled like lemon, but beneath it he could detect the scent of her skin, a little like honey. “So what would you do?” he whisper, her pebbled nipple still in his mouth. His fingers found their way beneath the fabric of her panties and began to slide down the length of the thong, along the hard ridge between her buttocks, over her puckered asshole, into the flesh of her wet gash. She squirmed in his hands, and her thigh rubbed his cock.

“If the right guy was there,” she said, and her voice vibrated in her chest and against his lips as he dragged them over her chest to her other breast, “I could do just about anything. If you want.”

John pushed her onto the bed, overtaken suddenly by a desire to fuck her senseless, with no more foreplay. *I could do just about anything*, her voice murmured in his ear. He stripped his shirt off and kicked his pants and underwear away with clumsy, fevered movements.

“Like what?” he growled, and he was surprised at his own voice. His hands reached forward and turned his wife around, propping her on all fours. She complied, all too willingly, and he yanked her panties down to her knees.

She turned back to look at him. “Tell me what you want me to do,” she said, grinning.

He slid his fingers into her wet cunt. She was positively gushing, and now that she was freed of the wrapping of her panties, he could smell her honey-salty cunt. The scent of it rose to his nostrils, damp and hot.

“Would you suck another man's cock?” he said. His own boldness shocked him a little, but his eyes were on her pink folds, glistening with excitement, and his mind was elsewhere, already imagining her posed just as she was, but with another man's fingers exploring her pretty pussy. His cock bounced in the air in front of him as the images traveled through his mind.

Adria brought her finger to her mouth, and closed her lips around it. John shuddered. “Is that a yes?”

She smiled. And then, almost to his utter disbelief, she placed two more fingers in her mouth, and began to suck on them as obscenely as he had ever seen her do anything. She let her spit glaze her three fingers, and spread her mouth open. She slurped on them, dirtily teasing him.

He couldn't take any more. Staring at her fingers in her mouth, picturing a fat slab of meat in their place, he pushed his cock inside of her.

He glided into her, barely pushing, she was so wet. He grasped her hips and slammed his cock all the way to his balls, deep inside of her. Again and again.

Adria sucked on her fingers, and then she had to drop her hand to support herself against his violent thrusts. “That's it,” she said. “I want a man who can fuck me like that.”

John hammered himself into her. “Are you going to let him fuck you hard like this?”

“Oh,” Adria moaned. “Fuck.”

John pictured another man stretching his wife apart with his enormous cock, pummeling her until his cum splashed against her cervix and gushed around his dick, dripping from the walls of her cunt. He was close to the edge, but he wanted to hear her say something dirty, something even more painfully unfaithful and slutty than she had already said. “Tell me what you’ll do,” he groaned.

She gave her hair another toss, to look back at him, It was damp now and it stuck to her neck. “I’ll let him fuck me like that,” she said, coyly, and he knew that something was coming. He slowed his thrusts to try and stop himself from losing it before he got to hear what it was. His balls ached and he could feel his blood pounding in his ears.

Adria smiled. Licked her upper lip. She had a smug grin, perhaps because she knew how much he was under her thumb. She ground her ass back against him.

And then, finally, she said: “But just before he comes, I’m going to get his cock in my mouth, so I can taste myself on his cock, and he can fill my mouth up like a dirty whore...”

John was already exploding, halfway through this sentence, and slamming his cum deep inside his wife. His eyes were on her lips, her mouth telling him this dirty story, but in his mind he could see cum – another man’s cum – dribbling from her dirty mouth.

She laughed as she threw herself onto the bed, her head on the pillow, and he felt her pussy clench around him as she came. Her own hot cum combined with his, and he felt their mingled juice gushing from her cunt and onto their thighs, hot and sticky.

Adria pulled away from him and rolled over. Her face was flushed. She reached a hand up to his chest and placed her fingertips on him, trailing them down to his abdomen. Then she reached her other hand to his neck and pulled him down to her. He lay his head on her full breasts.

His chest tightened with the realization that, for the first time in quite a while, Adria seemed fully in the room with him, not demanding or fantasizing about something more, or different.

He closed his eyes. Except that she *was*, technically, if she had been as engaged in the fantasy as he was.

Maybe it was more appropriate to think of Adria as fully engaged, for the first time in a long time, in *his* fantasy, and not her own.

And then it hit him, like a slap in the face. His chest went cold and he could have sworn his heart actually stopped for a beat: Adria was talking, very seriously, about actually doing this.

Today.

“Is this for real?” he said, pulling away from her. His voice sounded a little desperate, but he didn't care. He also didn't know from which direction the desperation came – a desire for it to *be* real, or one that it *not* be real. He propped himself up on his elbow. “Are you being serious?”

Adria's face had a strange expression on it. Her face seemed as strange as his own voice: impossible to read, conflicted. He knew the conflicts in Adria came from somewhere else, and it pained him (but deliciously) to think of what it was that pulled her in two directions inside her own mind.

“I think so,” she said finally. Almost cheerfully.

There was a silence.

“But listen,” she said. “You have to promise me that we just have fun with this. Like we have. I don't want this to turn into...I don't know, something darker. You're sure this is what you want?”

He was relieved to hear her say this. He kissed her shoulder.

“Just for fun,” she said.

“Okay,” he said. “Just for fun.”

She smiled, and sat up. “Okay,” she said. “I need another shower. Thank *god* you didn't mess up my dress.”

John sat up. "Okay," he said, hating himself for being so insecure, or indecisive, or whatever he was being. "Just to be sure, we're saying...you're going to...you know...all the way."

She kissed his nose. "For fun."

"For fun."

She made a serious face. "You *are* having fun, right?"

"Yeah. Yes. I mean...I will. Yes."

She stood up, folding her arms over her chest. "You don't sound very sure."

John scratched the back of his head violently. "I think...you know, it's..."

What was it?

"Okay," he said. "This might sound weird, but it's almost a little bit more...*fun*...if you...I don't know. I don't know how to explain this."

She nudged him with her knee. "Try."

He looked away. It was sort of an embarrassing truth.

"I don't know. If you aren't really...like, we don't talk about it, it's sort of just something you do. Like if there's less permission. You know?"

There. He had said it. As the words came out of his mouth, he realized they were actually quite an astute observation about himself, by himself. The thing that most turned him on was the idea of Adria doing all of this, right under his nose, but without his explicit permission.

"So you don't want me to do this with your permission?"

He rubbed his head again. "I don't know...I mean, yes and no. I do, and I don't." He squinted, which was his way of covering his face without covering it. "Does that make sense?"

It made no sense, not even to himself.

So he was wholly surprised when his wife tilted her chin slightly up, and half-closed her eyes. "It makes perfect sense to me," she said.

He stared at her.

“You want it, but you don't want it,” she said calmly.

“Yeah, exact...”

She was already walking to the bathroom. “I get it,” she said, and her voice had the calming tones of a hooker in Hollywood movie.

Leave it with Chastity, the voice seemed to say. *I know what you need.*

John rubbed his head with both hands, and fell backwards onto the bed.

He supposed it was out of his hands now.

The wedding dragged on, in a Catholic ceremony that befuddled most of the attendees, who had known the bride and groom as non-religious hipsters for most of their lives. John supposed it was to please somebody's parents, but it was grueling and included a full mass.

Adria nearly fell asleep in mass, and resorted to fanning herself with a program. Beads of sweat had formed on her chest and John amused himself watching them drip down her skin and in between her breasts. And by looking around the church at the male attendees, wondering if Adria would find any of these men suitable. Thinking about his wife closing her lips around another man's cock. He had an erection all through the service.

By the time people got to the reception, they were ready to party, and nearly everyone was drunk within an hour. There was – perhaps to make up for the interminable mass – an open bar. Adria came back to life, and fetched a drink for them both. Then she leaned in to him playfully. “I know what you were thinking about during the service,” she said.

Then she trounced away, without saying another word. But she looked back at him as she walked away, and her eyes it was clear: she was holding up her end of the bargain.

“I think I found our guy,” Adria said, appearing next to him on a large porch that overlooked the gardens and pool area at the high-end reception “castle” Marie and Luke Ryerson, sometime-friends from college, had rented for their thus-far extravagant wedding. Adria's arm extended with her

drink and pointed at a cluster of younger-looking men standing by a the garden. They were drinking beer and ogling women. One of the guys was Luke's younger brother, and John felt his stomach drop when he saw him – that might be too close to home.

“See the moppy-head guy? Black hair?”

Luke's brother was blonde. John exhaled with relief.

“He's been flirting with me all afternoon,” Adria murmured. She had her eyes on him lustily, and didn't even look over at John as she said this. He felt a delicious stab of pain. She was buzzing with energy, sort of writhing in her own skin. He wondered is she was already turned on, ripe and ready for her target.

“What do you think?” she said, and she took a sip of her champagne. She frowned. “This is disgusting. Champagne is disgusting. Why do people drink this stuff?”

John blinked at her. Was this really happening? Had his wife really just casually asked him what he thought about her choice of random stranger to fuck, and had she then just complained about the taste of champagne as though her previous statement had been about the weather?

He looked at the man. He had a lean athlete's build beneath his shirt and suit pants. Hints of his muscles somehow made it through the fabric. His face was handsome, and he had a slight amount of stubble on his jaw, which seemed sort of deliberately there, as though he were the kind of guy who didn't care if he was at a wedding, and maybe hadn't made it home last night to shave.

What a punk, John thought.

But he found himself nodding.

Adria finished her drink, and muttered about it again. “Here I go,” she said, and she swung herself around so that she was in front of John. She gave him a kiss. John savored the taste of her lips, and his cock twitched as he thought about how the plan, the plan between them at this moment, was to let another man have a taste of her as well.

And more than just her lips.

He felt an attack of what felt like vertigo wash over him as she walked away. The seriousness of what he had just agreed to came over him like an enormous, crushing wave. What was he doing? He gripped the railing and leaned against it, his eyes on his wife – who seemed to have no such wave of fear or regret overpowering her – as she crossed the lawn. Headed straight for the group of guys.

She caught their attention immediately, as Adria always did. She stopped about halfway to the group, and kicked off her shoes. She leaned over to pick them up, and John knew that the group of men had a nice view of her breasts in her low-cut dress. They certainly didn't bother hiding that they were taking a look.

Adria stood by the bar and ordered a beer. She feigned to not know that she was cutting the line, then put her hand on one of the men to ask him to forgive her. They began to talk to her, and in no time at all she had immersed herself in conversation with the very man she wanted. She laughed with him for a bit.

She handed him her drink to hold.

John watched as she slid her dress up, right there in front of everyone. His heart slammed against his chest and he felt like a fist was inside of him, squeezing bile into his stomach. He had no idea, as she slid her skirt higher and higher up her thigh, what she was going to do.

She stopped at the lace band at the top of her thigh, and hooked her fingers under it. Then, very slowly, putting on a show, she removed first one stocking, then the other. She tossed them on the ground and kicked them under the table. No doubt, John thought, she said something friendly and witty as she did. She was enthrallingly tomboyish and feminine at the same time, his wife was.

He could see that she had drawn her man in. He was smiling, and he couldn't take his eyes off of her.

She leaned closer to him.

They turned, and the walked away. Through a parting in some bushes, over a low brick wall, and over to an area of the yard with a fountain. They had collided as they were walking, and Adria was leaned up against his arm. Far too close for a married woman.

He felt his limbs going numb, and so he moved backwards until he fell into a chair.

Adria felt delicious as she slid her stockings down her leg. She knew John was above her, looking down and watching. Mark, her new acquaintance, was taking the bait hook, line, and sinker. She could feel his eyes on her as well.

“That's better,” she said, kicking the stockings under a catering table.

Mark smiled at her. “Those were sexy stockings,” he said.

She smiled wickedly at him. Giving him just the right amount of flirt, and mystery. She didn't say anything for a moment.

Then:

“So you want to head over to that fountain? I'm dying to stick my feet in it. Get a little wet.” She leaned closer to him to say this, hoping that John had a good clear view of how her body was within inches of Mark's.

And then they left, hand in hand. She skipped over the a small wall and Mark followed her.

“So how do you know Marie?” he asked her, a little lamely, when they were finally by the fountain.

Adria sat down on the edge of the fountain, and trailed her hand along the smooth cement. She could feel his eyes on her, watching her every movement. She also knew that John was doing the same. The effect was intoxicating. She gave her hair a toss and looked up at him adoringly. “Oh, you know. School.”

He brought his champagne to his lips. He had a wry smile on his face. “And you're married,” he said.

Adria felt her heart beat faster. She was. She was married, and her husband was watching her. Her husband wanted her to flirt with this man, or do even more. She held up her hand, and used her thumb to move her wedding ring around. She gave him a coy smile. “Does that matter?”

He laughed lightly. “Not to me.” The game was on.

Adria nodded in the direction of the pool. “I hear there are some really nice cabanas over there.”

Mark swallowed the rest of his champagne. “It's too cold to *swim*,” he said suggestively.

Adria could scarcely believe herself, as she slid her fingers over her hair, and twisted it with her fingers. “We'll have to find something else to do then,” she said.

Mark grinned, and threw his glass over his shoulder. Adria stood up. “I'll meet you over there?” she said, tracing her finger down his chest. “I just don't want to call any attention to...you know.”

Mark whistled as he stepped in the direction of the pool, comedically feigning that he was doing nothing more than taking a walk.

Adria smiled, and walked in the opposite direction.

Scratch that. She *strode* in the opposite direction.

She felt like she was high. She was high on the power she seemed to be exuding, in her pin-up dress, everywhere she walked. She liked that she could turn heads. She liked that she looked better than any woman here. She liked that she was going to do something very, very naughty.

She found her husband on the balcony above the lawn. His expression – one she was familiar with by now, of both hunger and hurt – turned her on when she met his eyes. She wondered if this was the same cold animal that crawled in his chest when she flirted with other men. The same raw feeling that spiked through her, from heart to groin.

She glided up to him and leaned on the balcony.

“What happened?” he said.

“I'm doing it.” She turned, and pressed her hand against his chest. “I'm going to a cabana by the pool.”

And then she let her hand drop, and she pushed past him, down the other side of the stairwell. She resisted the urge to look back as she crossed

the lawn, knowing it was only adding to his pleasure to see her walk away without a second thought.

John felt like he was being burned alive from the inside as he watched Adria cross the lawn. She had her shoes swinging in one hand and a her step seemed lighthearted.

Lighthearted, as she went off to sleep with another man.

True enough, he had asked her to. True enough, he *wanted* her to. He had no reason to feel the despair he felt, but why was she so casual about it?

He waited and he followed. It felt a lot like following her down the hallway of their house, only this time he was not following his wife back to their bedroom to make love. Instead, he was following his wife to a public place, to watch her make love to another man.

The thought of it punched him in the stomach and he clutched his lower abdomen in pain. Adria's dress flitted away through a passage in the trees. She was out of sight for a moment, and he went cold. He hurried to catch up, and then paused by the passage, not wanting to get caught by her lover, following his wife looking like mad dog.

There were three cabanas next to the enormous pool. The area wasn't genuinely part of the party, though it was on the grounds and it didn't seem off-limits. The pool was an Olympic-sized pool with black lane lines and a very deep end, so perhaps it didn't give off quite the same aura of “relaxing party” as the rest of the grounds did.

John's eyes darted from cabana to cabana, and his heart momentarily stopped as he thought for a second that he had lost his wife. She was nowhere to be seen.

Then he realized that he didn't have to do anything more than try each one of the cabanas. But how to do it surreptitiously?

He felt like a pervert and a fool, really, as he crept around each of the white tent cabanas. There was almost an inch of space between the frail, white material that formed the cabanas, and the ground. If either one of them looked down they would see him – or at least his toes – lurking,

walking hesitantly around the cabana, coming to spy on his own wife fucking a younger, better-looking man.

He was at the rear of one of the cabanas, sure that it was the right one because the other two, which he could not see very clearly because of the angle he was at, still had at least one of the door flaps open.

But there was no noise at all from with the first cabana, and so he crept along the side of it and over to some bushes. He moved along, feeling clumsy and foolish, approaching the other two cabanas. Alternating dread and horror and lust pulsed through him, as he considered the possibilities before him: either his wife was going to fuck a stranger in a cabana with an open door, or they had gone somewhere—

His own thoughts ground to a halt as he saw that the former was true. Adria was in the closest hut, and the door was not completely closed, and her body was meshed with the body of the young man she had been flirting with. Her back was to the door, and then man's big hand was pressed against her bare back, holding her to him as he kissed her obscenely, digging his tongue into her mouth.

They were kissing passionately, each of them moving their heads in the wild, unbridled movements of people engaging in a first-time, forbidden lust. Really swallowing each other's lips, fighting for more.

John looked around in desperation for two things: a place to hide himself, and to assure himself that no one was in the pool area. The voices from the wedding were close-by, just over the hedge, and here was his wife, cabana doors open, letting another man paw at her.

Fuck her.

He stumbled behind a bush located closer to the cabana, and pushed aside the branches to see in. It was an unsatisfactory view. He could only see their bodies pressed close together, but not the precious details he both wanted and didn't want.

He cast his eyes in desperation at the other cabana, searching for details that would help him find a way to see what he wanted to see more clearly. The cabana was just a tent on a frame, with a double bed-type piece of furniture and several reclining chairs. The curtains untied and then fell

closed to create privacy. There were no windows, no real places to hide inside the cabana.

The sounds of his wife and her lover kissing intensified. He heard a throaty murmur from Adria. Or maybe a moan. His cock was hard and ached between his legs. He was crouched in an awkward and humiliating position, trying to hide himself while getting his best, perverted view of what his wife was letting another man do to her.

Their bodies fell into the shadows of the cabana, and John felt his heart plummet with them.

Then it soared again, as his wife appeared at the foot of the bed, and he could see her sliding the zipper of her dress down slowly. He watched as the zipper parted, imagining the view from wherever the guy was – propped up, no doubt, on his elbows, and smirking with delight as John's wife's dress broke apart in the back, and threatened at every moment to come loose from her shoulders and slide down her body.

It finally did, and landed with a fluffy pile. Her breasts were bare, and only her underwear remained.

John looked around the pool area again. Anyone walking by would be able to see her undressing. He sucked in his breath as she hooked her fingers beneath her panties and slid them, too, down her long legs and into the pile of dress and undergarment.

She stepped out of the pile neatly, her lithe body perfectly framed for a moment by the single open door of the cabana.

Then she turned, and released the curtain. John – and anyone else, if they were looking over the hedge – had a brief view of her breasts and her narrow waist, the downy blonde between her legs, and then she was gone.

He waited a moment, trying to think of what to do.

He had come up with no plan when he heard the first low moan. Adria's moan. He wondered what she could be doing, what he would see if only he could see inside. He began to crawl toward the cabana, with no idea what he was going to do. He felt like such a pervert, such a demented man, crawling and trying to hide himself, so that he could spy on his wife and her

lover. But there was no stopping him; he knew that. Even if someone saw him, he would keep going.

He rounded the cabana, and from through the thin “wall” he was treated to more of Adria's moaning. Then her breathy voice, jagged with pleasure: “oh god...yes...pl-plea- plea – right...”

John's cock felt like it was made of a heavy metal, and it would break off any moment. He paused next to where he believed there was a second reclining chair, if the other cabana had the same floor plan as this one. He lifted the material.

It only gave a few inches. His plan, formed only seconds before, had been to crawl under the lounge chair and lie on the cold cement, watching his wife's tits bounce or her legs spread open, as he lay on his back, largely hidden from view.

But his hopes were dashed.

Adria moaned again. “Oh...oh my god,” she was panting.

He pressed his face against the cement and peered in: he had been right, he was right next to a reclining chair. His view was hidden by it.

John scarcely had control over his body or his mind, It was almost as if he watched his hands moving in a movie, and not in any way in this real life. He couldn't feel them as they dipped into his pockets and found his knife, a knife he always carried and never used, a knife his brother had given saying you could never be sure when you would need a knife. He didn't feel his fingers as they popped the utility knife open and sliced through the tent material, one long, jagged cut, just big enough to push the material to one side and allow him to crawl in.

And then, suddenly, there he was. Lying on the floor, his cock pressed against the cold cement through his suit pants. Every other part of his body as cold and numb as the cement. Painful twitches throbbed in his cock, as he looked up and saw what was making Adria moan.

She was pressed against the back of the bed-like furniture, where a flat metal “headboard” with one rail above it marked the end of the bed. Her arms were stretched out on either side of her, and she was gripping the rail fiercely with each hand. She was sitting upright, and looking down at the

black hair moving between her legs. Her own legs were spread wide, and so the black head could be doing only one thing where he was.

And he seemed to be doing it well. Adria's feet bobbed with the motion of his head, and she threw her head back and thrust her pink nipples up at the ceiling. "Oh god," she seethed. John saw the muscles of her abdomen ripple with her heightening excitement, winding her up so that she was nearly over the edge.

Then her body seized up as though being shocked with electricity, and she opened her mouth as she threw her head back, but no sound came out for a moment. Then she seemed almost to start sobbing. Her chest heaved up and down, and John watched her orgasm shudder through in wave after wave of pleasure, before she let out a long, tortured moan that he was sure everyone could hear, everywhere at the party.

Her lover lifted his head and rested back on his knees. His cock was hard and pointed straight up and in front of him, like a missile ready to launch. He wiped his mouth, and John saw that Adria's pussy was glistening all over with her cum. Her thighs were wet as well. From the center of her engorged pink cunt, he could see that her excitement was still flowing with each spasm of her body.

The man reached forward and grabbed her hair. He didn't need to force her much to get her to change position, onto her knees, and lean over to suck his ready cock. John listened in agony to the slurping sounds of his wife's mouth as she bobbed up and down on the meat of the stranger, sucking diligently on his ample cock as he cupped the back of her head in his palm. He held her head like a football and smugly watched as she sucked fervently on his cock.

John stared in pain at her mouth when she was at the crown, at her lips spread open by another man's cock. He couldn't see the whole scene as she dove down; her face disappeared and all he could see was her hair and the stranger's hand, pushing her down, all the way to where she must have been gagging. He heard the sticky sound of her choking a little as she bobbed back up. And then down again. Over and over. She began to hum, making a sound like she was really enjoying swallowing the man's dick all the way to the back of her throat. Enjoying being pushed to the base of his cock and held there briefly, with her throat full of meat.

Finally, he pulled her up and used his grip on her hair to turn her around. He pushed her into position so that she was gripping the railing of the bed and her ass was turned toward him.

From where he was, John had a perfect view from below, as the guy guided his fat cock to her dripping pussy, and rubbed the glans around, pressing against her fat clit until she moaned and twitched in pleasure. Then he had a perfect view as each fat inch of the guy's cock slid into his wife's flesh.

The man went slowly in, and Adria moaned. But once he pressed the base of his cock against her opening, his balls squeezed together as he tried to slide even further in, filling her even more.

He began to fuck her.

His balls swung wildly against her clit as he hammered her. Their skin slapped together and he strained the walls of her cunt to a pale white as rammed her, slamming himself in as deep as he could go. John heard Adria's voice wind up to a crescendo: a high-pitched wail left her throat and he saw her juices burst from the sides of the man's pummeling dick. The squelching sound of his fucking got wetter and sloppier as he started to pound her even harder and without mercy. Her body slid along the bed, until she was practically hanging over the headboard, but he didn't stop until he let out a groan and dumped his seed inside of her.

John could see the white cum gushing between her legs before he even slid his dick out. Adria's legs were trembling, and for a moment he had the sinking sensation that she was hurt, but she threw her head back and inhaled. "Fuck," she said. "That was good." She pushed herself up and displayed her pretty body for him, and for John (at least he hoped it was in part for him).

Then she turned around. "Mark," she said, and she put her finger under his chin. "That was lovely. I need you to go now, though, before my husband starts to look for me."

Mark leaned back on his heels, and his mouth was open in surprise. Though John could see that he also looked amused. "Your husband is actually *here*?" he said, in a disbelieving tone. "At the party?"

Adria wiped the corner of her mouth and smiled. "Of course. So get going."

John held his breath and slid under the lounge chair, as Mark gathered his things, chuckling a little. "You are one crazy bitch," he said. "Call me, if you ever...you know...?"

John couldn't see Adria, so he had no idea how she responded.

A moment passed after Mark left.

"Are you here?" Adria said.

John slid his head out from under the lounge chair.

Adria smiled. "Clever monkey," she teased.

And then she made his whole body go wild with a sensation he had never felt before or even imagined when she flopped onto her stomach and looked down at him from the edge of the bed. "Is your cock still hard?" she said. "Do you want to hop up here?"

He slid out from under the chair, almost cracking his cock open on the low clearing. Adria remained where she was, with her beautiful body ass-up on the bed, stretched out, her feet playfully kicking at the air. She followed him with her eyes as he walked around her, and dropped his pants to the floor. She parted her legs, and he saw her used cunt, protruding clit, and the trickle of white cream her lover had left behind as the scent of her body and his astringent cum assailed his nostrils.

His cock was so hard it seemed larger than ever, and it throbbed painfully, erect in front of him. He clambered onto the bed as Adria shifted her head to rest on her folded arms, like she was sunning herself at the beach. He caught her playful feet, and pushed them down to the bed, where he held them for a moment as Adria slid her ass backward and toward him. When she did, even more of the white cum dribbled from her pussy, and he stared in wonderment at his own hand and cock as they guided each other to his wife's pussy, and entered her stretched, unfaithful, cunt.

The feel of her pussy, slippery with the cum of another man and her own two orgasms, and the looseness of her walls, sent him nearly to the edge in a single thrust. After all that he had watched, he only to admit the image of Mark's big balls, dangling and swinging into her cunt, to send him

over the cliff. He screamed as his own cum tore out of him and into his wife's dirty hole.

She rose up on her knees, and pushed him backward as she did. She sat down on his lap, her back to him, his cock still inside of her, pulsing and twitching. He was still hard, and her every movement was too excruciatingly pleasurable to bear. Her firm bottom spread out, hot and sticky, on his lap. She ground herself on top of him. His aching balls screamed.

She leaned back against him, pressing her back against his chest. Her hands stoked the outside of his thighs.

“Did you like that?” she purred.

He breathed into her neck. There wasn't any point of saying anything; it would all sound trite anyway. Some questions in sex were best left rhetorical.

She began to rock back and forth on his still-hard cock. At first it was almost too much for him, and he braced himself leaning backwards and sucked the air through his teeth in pain. But before long she had him worked back up, craving her, wanting to fill her again with his cum.

Outside, the party seemed to be spilling over into the pool area. They could hear voices getting closer and closer to the cabana.

John pushed her forward, and held her by the hips as he sloshed in her overripe cunt until she seized up around him and squealed into the material of the bed. He held in the loud yell he so desperately wanted to give as he came, and the force of it almost gave him a stroke.

As the ringing, exploding buzz of his orgasm died down, and Adria seemed to as well, they became aware of the voices approaching the cabana. “Shit,” Adria laughed.

It was too late. Someone opened the curtains, saying “what's in here?”

Luckily, it was no one they knew, and the man surveyed the scene quickly, said “whoops,” and let the curtain fall.

John put his face into Adria's shoulder blade and stifled a laugh.

They dressed quickly, and then Adria peeked out of the tent to find a moment for the two of them to sneak out. They darted into the garden behind the cabana, but not before a few guys clapped and cheered for them.

John was grateful it made Adria laugh.

13 CLOSE CALL

Adria leaned across the car and gave John a kiss before stepping out. She was wearing a higher heel than usual today, and it ground, slightly slippery, on the loose sand and gravel that covered the area being used as a parking lot. “Thanks,” she said. “I’ll get a ride back to my office from Ken and take the train home.”

She took a moment to scan John's face. A flicker of jealousy, but mostly arousal. She winked at him.

He *liked* the idea of her “getting a ride” from Ken.

She closed the door with a smile, but as soon as she heard his car pulling away behind her, she felt a little drop in her happiness.

She knew she should be more happy than she was with the “arrangement” they seemed to have hammered out. After all, John was happy, and now she could find a way to pursue her own secret fantasies without feeling like she was doing something wrong.

Still, something was lurking around in her subconscious, and it wasn't a sense of relief. There was something that didn't quite fit, didn't quite satisfy in this arrangement. She couldn't say exactly what it was.

After all, they had hashed out an agreement after Mark. After she had actually had sex with another man at her friend's wedding. In a cabana, in public practically. She had gotten off on it, he had gotten off on it. Everything seemed good.

Right?

Right.

And then she had agreed that she would tell him about her affairs. Perhaps let him encourage them. But there was a tacit agreement in there, a clause they had sort of glossed over: the fact that John was aroused by

things that weren't totally agreed upon ahead of time. Things that were a little bit over the line.

And so did she.

So she was on a looser lead, and she should enjoy it, right?

Instead she was worried. Worried about what she might do. Worried that the ball, so to speak, was in her court. And she was certain that John had no idea just how dirty her ideas could get.

“You look tall,” Ken said dryly, breaking off her train of thought. He scanned her from head to toe and back again with a more paternalistic gaze than anything. “You need shoes?”

Adria felt a flush of embarrassment creep across her face. She was in the low heels today – and tight jeans, and a black, form-fitting t-shirt, as opposed to her typical Carhartts - because she wanted to look...well, *good*.

John had noticed when she got in the car. It had raised his heckles and his suspicions, and she could see that he liked it.

But if she was honest with herself, John's reaction wasn't why she was doing it.

“These are steel-toed,” she lied to Ken.

“Oh yeah?” Ken quipped. He rolled his eyes.

“It's part of a new female construction fashion line.”

More eyeroll and Ken waved her toward the office as he began his unsteady workman march in that direction. “My fuckin' head's steel-plated, doesn't mean I can walk around here without a hard hat. Get some boots or you're stuck in the office. I can't have OSHA up my ass this week.”

Someone lurking about in the shadows made a boilerplate joke about OSHA up his ass, and so the day began.

“You got a problem with the specs.”

It was a statement rather than a question, and the voice delivering it made Adria's downy neck hair rise. A wave of goosebumps rippled down her spine and over her buttocks.

She turned to see him – Billy Stone – leaning on a two-by-four with his forearm and staring at her.

She pushed her hair from her face. She felt a wave of embarrassment after that, because she was actually twittering like a schoolgirl. “I do.” She tried to deliver her statement with the same detached tone as the wiry, muscled workman, but it failed and came out sort of bitchy. “I mean, yeah, I do..but you...how'd you...?”

She was inwardly dismayed with herself. *Get it together.* Why was she finding this twit so disarming?

She could see in Billy Stone's smug fucking face that he knew exactly the effect he was having on her.

His eyes dropped to her work boots. They were an obvious size too big, and Adria was convinced she was in far more danger waddling around in these things than her other shoes, but rules were rules.

“Nice kicks,” Billy said. He took a step closer to her.

Her eyes dropped and she let them take a lingering walk on his bicep. Involuntarily, she shook a little inside. His arm was incredibly taut, thick and muscled. Her mind took a plunge, imagining his solid weight on top of her, his bicep next to her face, right where she could turn and bite into his flesh as he made her scream.

She realized that she hadn't said anything, and felt her cheeks stain red. Billy moved a little bit closer. She didn't move away.

“I can show you where the problem is,” he growled.

Adria felt her whole body go cold. This was close – uncomfortably close, excitingly close – to the fantasy she had kept stored away in her mind. She almost felt as though she had been stripped naked.

But there was no way he could know what was in her mind?

Was there?

Billy took a look around the level. There was no one on the floor with them.

“Is that what you came up here for?” he asked.

Adria wasn't sure what happened to her in the next few moments. She felt hypnotized. Billy moved closer to her, and she backed away but – as he surely knew – there was nowhere to go but into a concrete pillar. And then he was very close to her, and he leaned an arm up against the concrete.

She felt herself shake her head.

“No?” Billy said, and he gave her a smile that was as enticing as it was self-satisfied. She felt his hand at her navel, and then moving slowly up, over her shirt and up to her bare chest.

“What then?” he asked.

He pushed the shirt up and over her breasts. He didn't take his eyes off hers. She felt the roughness of his hand move over her skin and up to her neck, then up to her mouth, where his fingertips moved over her lips.

She felt her pussy throb and her excitement gush into her underwear.

He pulled at her lower lip and watched it before he moved his mouth very close to hers. “What, then? What did you want up here?”

His mouth was on hers before she could answer, and he moved his hand to cup her breast at that moment.

His touch was everything she had expected. Forceful, hard, unyielding. He pressed his body against hers and she felt his cock through his jeans against her thigh.

She moved her hand to his chest, to push him away from her, but he caught her wrist and squeezed it tightly.

Just like she wanted, if she wanted to admit it to herself. He pressed her arm against the cement and swiftly caught the other one. He pulled away from her mouth, and held her there, panting.

“This was a bad idea,” she said, but even she knew that her voice sounded false.

He moved his head very slowly from one side to another, and she gave her arms a little wiggle. They were met with unyielding force: even if she had really, really wanted to, unless he chose to let go of her, there was no way she was getting away. “I think it's a great idea,” he said.

He turned his head slightly to the left, and she felt his mouth and the sandpaper of his stubble against her throat as he sucked her skin up into his lips. The very real danger of him leaving some kind of mark on her made her panic, and she actually struggled against his grip.

But to no avail, and he looked back at her with amusement on his face.

She could feel the very real danger of Billy Stone now. She felt like a searing liquid was injected into her arteries: it was similar to fear but it lit her up like a wildfire. She squirmed in his grip, and he went in for her neck again. She faintly moved her head from side to side in dissent, but her resolve was weak, and she was excited like she had never been before, and anyway, she couldn't say no...

The high whine of the elevator made Billy pause, and then the sound of it stopping on their floor made him grin, and push his body away from hers.

"Next time," he said, picking up a bag he had set on the floor and whistling as he turned around and walked away.

Ken stepped out of the elevator, and a new kind of fear surged up inside of Adria. What the hell had she almost done?

"Whadya doin' up here? Problem's on eight, I have to get out of here, been lookin' all over." He swept his eyes over the scene, and Adria was relieved that Billy didn't seem to be anywhere in sight. "You okay?"

She nodded.

"You look pale."

Adria floundered through her mind for a response. "I almost fell."

She could feel her pussy throbbing, and her ears had a tinny ringing to them. With just a kiss, Billy Stone had brought her near to orgasm. She stood up.

"What, off the side, or what?" Ken barked.

"Huh?" she said.

"You look like you almost died. Let's go. I don't got time for this."

Adria joined him in the elevator. As it closed she searched for the smug and beautiful Billy Stone, but the place looked empty. She wondered for a moment if she had imagined it all.

She stopped on the way home after buying a pack of cigarettes from a gas station. She drove out to their old neighborhood, the place where they'd bought their first starter home. Not for any nostalgic reason, just because it was on the way and she knew where there was an undeveloped field and a road that dead-ended there. She sat on the hood of the car and lit the cigarette.

It was the first time in five years she had smoked. It tasted terrible, but she smoked it anyway, looking out over the field in the golden late afternoon light.

Shit, she thought. What was she doing?

There was this thing with John.

Was it bothering her? Was it John, and the wedding, that had her out here smoking in a field?

She blew a languid stream of smoke out of her nostrils and inspected the burning ash at the end of the cigarette. She knew that wasn't it.

She liked fucking Mark. It had been fun. But when she thought of it, she felt a slight ping in the back of her mind. A gentle reminder, a little kick of guilt. And she knew where it came from. She knew she knew. She had to confront it.

She closed her eyes.

She had told herself that she slept with Mark because John wanted her to. And there was some truth to that story: John did want her to, and that was one reason she had done it.

But there was something else. Something she didn't want to think about too much.

She sucked in her breath and opened her eyes.

Hadn't she done it, just a little, because she was looking for something else?

She had known she wasn't going to get it from Mark. He wasn't that kind of guy, and even as they snuck away to the cabana and writhed on the bed, she hadn't felt the kick she really wanted to feel.

The kick she had felt with Billy only an hour ago.

The *real* feeling that she was doing something illicit.

With someone dangerous.

That she was really close to a *real* edge.

No matter how scandalous it might have seemed, taking things all the way with Mark at a wedding in a public setting, it hadn't excited her the way Billy Stone's lips, sucking on her neck, threatening to bruise her flesh and leave her with a lie to tell, had excited her. Mark hadn't made her pulse race with the same kind of adrenaline, the same kind of fear, the same horrible twisting in her stomach.

The one of doing something bad.

Something wrong. Really wrong.

She took another drag.

Was it that?

Or was it that Billy Stone was the kind of man who was going to hold her wrists and take what he wanted?

Her own fantasy made her nervous. She made herself nervous, taking things this far.

"What's the outcome?" she said aloud.

Because that was always the thing that mattered. Where was this going? What if she hadn't been interrupted by Ken? She would have taken things all the way with Billy. She could see she hadn't really really had much of a choice.

And then what?

And then what?

She put the cigarette out, grinding it with the heel of her shoes. It was wildfire season, any little spark could set the whole town on fire.

A fitting metaphor for her life.

She plopped into the seat of the car, but left the door open and stared into space. She didn't feel like driving just yet.

She needed to make a decision. She needed to make a decision and commit. But the flow charts she was drawing for herself in her mind, the diagrams and the lists – they never really added up for her.

She knew the most important thing was her marriage.

Obviously.

But if John could have this thing he wanted, and it was outside of their marriage...then surely he couldn't deny her what she wanted.

But if she told him about it, she didn't feel like it would be the same. She wouldn't really be getting what she wanted.

She didn't really want to tell him what she actually wanted.

Minutes passed by.

She slid her phone out of her purse.

She didn't remember it ringing in her ear.

“You need to talk,” the voice on the other end said. “Pick me up at *La Flaca*.”

14 GUILT

“Did you do it?” Lily said, diving right in after their waiter left the wine at their table. Adria was wearing sunglasses, and Lily rolled her eyes when she didn't take them off. She reached across the table and took them off her face. “Tell me. You did, didn't you? And?”

Adria looked at the table. “We did it at a wedding.”

“Was this Marie and Luke's wedding? Because I am pissed at that bitch, you know she didn't even invite me. *Mamona*. Was it good?”

Adria smiled. “The wedding or the...”

Lily tisked and waved her hand in front of her face like there was a fly bothering her. “I don't care if the wedding was good. The guy. The...” she waved her hands frantically in the air. “The thing. Did he watch?”

Adria looked up at her. “Yeah,” she said, and her voice was hesitant. “And that was good. It was..cool.”

“Cool?” Lily screeched, and Adria put her hand out to stop her. “Cool? *Ay, guera*, you had better have something else to say but cool.” She looked at a passing waiter with sexual interest, then turned back squinting. “Small *pene*?” Agreeing with herself before Adria could say anything, she tisked again. “That is the worst.”

Adria shook her head. “No, no nothing like that. That's...look, that was fine, okay? It's not...it's not what I want to talk to you about.”

Lily arched an eyebrow. “*Really*.” She slid the wine glass from the table and folded her arms across her chest. “I am shutting my mouth now then, I am all ears, I promise. I must hear this thing you are going to tell me that is something more interesting than fucking some guy – did he have a good-sized one, then? - at *pinche* Marie's wedding. *La muy cabrona*.” Lily mimed zipping her lips.

Adria closed her eyes. She knew that telling Lily was probably the worst idea she'd had in a long time, but she had also made up her mind to do it.

“Okay. So. This thing with John is great. It's good, we have hot sex now, I don't feel...I don't really feel weird about it. Like, not weird about...*it*...but I have a problem. Another problem. Something else about it is bothering me.”

Lily opened her mouth and then closed it, re-zipping her own lips. Her eyes were wet with interest. She sipped her wine and waved at Adria to go on.

“It's sort of...I mean, it's the thing I sort of talked to you about. I mean, I did this thing with Mark – that's the guy at the wedding -” Adria stopped to laugh because Lily held out her fingers to make a length of eight inches between them, her eyes pleading for an answer. Adria held her own hands apart about nine inches and Lily smiled.

“Anyway,” Adria said. She leaned forward on the table. “I didn't actually feel like..I don't know, all that wildly turned on by it. Or off. Or...anything. Right? It was just like, okay, this was exciting...but it *wasn't* that exciting. It was...missing something.”

Lily pressed her lips together.

“John liked it. But...”

Lily looked like she would explode. She closed her eyes and shook her head slowly.

“And then, I almost fucked this guy at work.”

Lily sprayed her wine out and dropped her head to her napkin, trying to wipe herself up. “You what?”

“Yeah. This guy Billy.”

“Why didn't you?”

“Ken showed up. But...I would have, you know? If he hadn't? Right there at work. On the third floor of this unfinished building, anyone could come up there any time. You know? I would have gotten fired. Not to mention that...well, it isn't what me and John agreed on.”

“Billy?” Lily said, and she rubbed her lips together. “Like, dark-haired guy?” She laughed, a deep throaty laugh. “I know Billy.”

“Jesus!” Adria said.

“You should have fucked him,” Lily said, stabbing at some wine that had splattered on her chest. “*Me cago en la...* this is silk.” She looked up. “Look. What is it you're agreeing with with John?”

Adria rested her chin on her upturned palm. “It's sort of a loose agreement. It's not...it's not really an agreement at all. Just...I know John. He wants it to be, like, 'our thing,' you know?”

Lily shook her head.

“He wants us to plan it together. I think. That's what I think.”

Lily shrugged. “So tell him you want to fuck this *chaval* and then *ya*, no problem.”

Adria sighed and looked out at the restaurant.

“Oh,” Lily crowed. “That *is* the problem.”

She started blotting her dress again. “Look,” she said, and then she interrupted herself to reach out an arm and grab the waiter – a good-looking guy in his mid-twenties, who was more than happy to be grasped by the lovely Lily. “Honey. Can you get me a glass of ice water? I've spilled wine all down the front of my dress.” She fingered the plunging collar of her dress, where a single drop of wine barely showed on the bright pink, swiping her finger over her chest more than anything. The waiter smiled and stared openly at her tits, before nodding. Lily released him. “John wants this thing, he likes it, you do it. You've done something for him, and he's like, 'oh, I like it when you fuck another guy,' yes? So if he didn't say, *especifically*, 'don't have sex without telling me first,' or something, then you just do it, you have a good time, and you tell him about it later. No problem.”

Adria stared at her.

Lily shrugged. She set her napkin down to take the glass of water from the eager, returning waiter. “Or don't. Thank you *cariño*.” She winked at the waiter. “I don't tell Esteven half the things I do. It's easier, you know?”

Adria leaned her head back and groaned. "That's just the thing, Lily. I don't want to be doing something that's bad for us, just because it's easier."

"Look," she said, pointing her napkin at Adria. When Adria tipped her head back, a plate of tapas had mysteriously arrived. Lily was already munching on an olive. "He likes watching you fuck another man, right?"

Adria looked around quickly. "Shh," she said.

"Okay," Lily said, her voice at exactly the same volume. "And you never made any explicit agreement to tell him?"

Adria made a face. "No."

"Okay. So...you've done something for him, now you do something you want to do. It's no good if you tell him, is that what you're saying? You have to be naughty? In order to, you know, get off?"

"Lily!" Adria jerked her head in the direction of the restaurant. She held her hand up to her temples. "We are in a restaurant."

Lily waved a pita around and looked at the people in the tapas bar. "No worries. Nobody here speaks English, *cariño*." Then she laughed. "Except the waiter. And he is definitely listening." She waved at him.

Then she turned back to Adria. "You want that number now?"

Adria covered her eyes.

She did. She wanted it. She knew now that was why she was here all along. She wanted it, and she didn't want to admit that she did. "Oh god. I know I shouldn't do this."

"Just take it," Lily said. "And then I tell you how you do it. And you use it, or you don't." She began to wriggle her foot wildly under the table, as she looked over at her busy waiter. "*Mmmm, papacito, ven aca que yo te como la -*"

"Lily!" Adria said sharply. Adria didn't speak much Spanish, but she knew where that was going, and she could feel half the restaurant turning in their direction.

15 REAL CALL

Adria stared out the window of her car, twisting the card Lily had given her in her fingers. It was a white card, with a phone number on it: no more. It was theatrical: printed on fine paper, giving nothing away about the nature of the number. The anonymity hinted at the illegality of what she was about to do.

Strangely, until Lily handed her the card, she hadn't even considered the legal aspects of the service she was requesting. The fact that it was such an illicit service had her both hesitating and invigorated. She couldn't believe that she was taking the proposition so seriously that she was actually sitting in her car, grateful for the rain that was hiding her from the outside, grateful for the humidity that had steamed up the windows. She was parked in a rock quarry just outside of town, one that wasn't in use. The kind of place teenager went to make out, and maybe late at night the mafia came to beat people up. For all she knew.

The allure of the seedy, underground nature of things was appealing to her. She could taste it.

She flipped the card again.

Her stomach twisted.

Lily had given it to her with strict instructions. The services were referred to as driving, because under scrutiny, married clientele, who made up a good portion of "Marina's" clients, would look suspicious as clients for an escort-only service.

Adria took out the phone she had purchased to make the call. It felt so criminal, having a throwaway phone like this. She had felt guilty purchasing it. She had even gone so far as to pay cash.

The strangest thing, of course, was that she wasn't hiding anything from her spouse.

Not really.

Well, she was.

Weeks had gone by since she spoke to Lily, and in that time, Adria had waited. Day by day she went through her thoughts, deciding it was best to leave things as they were. Not to do anything rash. She reasoned that she had a good marriage, a good relationship, and she and John had done something exciting to keep their marriage fresh and new, and it had worked. There was no reason to go overboard. Not now anyway. She reasoned with herself in the car all the way to work and in the car all the way home. Maybe someday, when the thrill of having sex with strangers while John watched wore off, then she could broach this subject with John. Another thing to do, to put on a bucket list (she hated that term).

She had avoided Billy Stone, just barely, by taking on another job (and too much work); it kept her rushing through the Bridge Street site at a breakneck pace with a plausible reason to not be waiting around on the third or the eighth floor in the dark, hoping to run into Billy and his rough hands.

She and John had agreed to wait for a repeat performance of the wedding until the perfect opportunity came up again. Now that she had actually done it, John seemed less fevered, more able to enjoy watching her flirt with a man and then talk dirty to him about it. It was almost as if the fact that they had finally gone through with the idea, and their marriage was still okay, made John less obsessed than he had seemed before. Back when he was really like a man possessed. He seemed more in control of himself.

John was like that. He was crazy if he hadn't tried something and seen how it worked. After that, he could relax a little.

But Adria was burning up inside.

Burning up with guilt. She was possessed now.

Burning with the desire to get something she wanted.

Thinking about Billy Stone's hands on her neck. Imagining that Ken hadn't come out of the elevator at that moment.

And now, John was out of town for two more days. The trip had been unexpected; he was called in to assist on a presentation as a replacement for a sick colleague. Adria had sat on the bed watching him pack, her body being taken over by two forces: one, dread.

And the other? Even as she sat there trying to control herself, wishing he wasn't leaving, wondering if there was a way to go with him so she wouldn't be tempted...she could feel the excitement burning right through her.

Back in her car, alone in the city for the fourth night, she pressed the card to her lips.

She knew what the right thing to do was. That she should tell John about what she was feeling. That he would have to allow her to do what she wanted, even if it wasn't something he actually wanted her to do – because how could he not be? He would be a hypocrite, after all they had done, if he didn't allow it. It wasn't as if there was a danger of not getting him to agree.

But asking for permission would somehow ruin it. She didn't like to admit to herself that it was part of the thrill, but it was.

She was back to the same circle of thoughts again. She sighed.

The main thing she wanted to avoid was having to talk to John about what she really wanted. And how he couldn't possibly give it to her. Thinking about having a conversation like that just made her tired.

Lily was right, in a lot of ways. John was obviously fundamentally okay with her going outside of their marriage...in fact, he was using her in a way, for his own desires.

And they had no explicit rules between them.

And...

...and what he didn't know wouldn't hurt him.

She tapped the card against her lips a few more times.

Then, half -surprised at herself, but knowing she had made the decision long ago, she swept her finger over the screen of her phone, and dialed.

16 ANA'S FANTASY

“So what are you into, Ana, that made you call Marina?”

Adria found herself speaking, almost as if she were in a movie and the lines had been written for her. “What makes you think I'm 'into' anything?”

“Andy” flashed his eyes at the mirror. They were dark, uncompromising eyes. “You don't strike me as the type who has trouble getting a man. And you're married, which means you aren't looking for love. So what is it, then?”

She looked out the window. And suddenly it was if she wasn't inside of her own body.

“Let's just say my husband can't quite give me what I want.”

“Which is?”

She sighed. She shook her head. “I can't believe I'm doing this,” she muttered. “I think this is a bad idea. Maybe...”

Andy pulled the car over. He leaned back over the seat. “Let me see if I can guess,” he said. “In my experience, a woman like you is interested in a very certain kind of fantasy.” He moved his head up and down, and Adria followed him.

“The kind of fantasy your husband can't really make happen?”

Another nod.

“Like maybe you're alone, in a hotel room, and a stranger sneaks in, in the dark?”

She squirmed and looked out the window. But she nodded.

“Maybe he has a blindfold? Maybe he ties you up?”

Adria let out a puff of air.

“And then maybe he has his way with you? Am I on the right track?”

Her heart was already beating faster. One part of her imagination was already ahead of him, feeling his hands on her throat, the weight of his body on hers, his cock inside of her. Feeling the danger of the dark and not knowing what he would do. The thought of all of it: the fact that she was in a car, telling a male prostitute what she wanted, engaging in such a seedy, filthy fantasy and without her husband's knowledge, both made her a little queasy and turned her on immensely.

She gave a slightly perceptible nod.

“So why don't we do this, Ana? Let's go for a drive tonight. I have a document I need you to sign. And then we make a date. You give me the place and the time, and I show up there.”

“It has to be tonight,” Adria said, in a whisper. She looked out the window.

Andy pushed a clipboard behind him. “I don't usually do this the same night, so it's up to you. I find it kills the thrill a little.”

“It has to be tonight.”

She took the contract and swept her eyes over it. Surprisingly, it made her laugh a little. “This is...can you even write this sort of thing and have it be...I dunno...legal?” The contract contained a list of sexual acts to which she consented. Just reading them off made her face flush with embarrassment, but it also sent a thrill through her as her eyes passed over the words. *Choking. Bondage. Anal. Spanking (specify type).*

She looked up at the mirror, and saw Andy's eyes looking back at her. “It's enough to get me off a felony charge, if you know what I mean.” His voice was suddenly hard, and unnerving.

This sent a chill through Adria's body. “Right,” she said.

“Initial anything you want.” He seemed to smile, though she could only see his eyes. “Maybe start off light.”

She looked back at the contract. Was she actually doing this?

She felt like she could feel his eyes on her, maybe getting wound up as the pen made a noise for each thing she initialed, each devious act she

was consenting to let another man do to her. He could almost feel his hands groping her with each scratch of the pen.

“It says we need a safe word,” she said, and she squirmed in her seat.

“It's too bad, isn't it?” he said, and sent a shiver through her. She wasn't sure if this was part of his act, or if he was really disappointed by the rule. “Rules are rules, though. Your choice.”

He added, when she stared at the paper blankly. “Write it down. It needs to be in your own writing. And don't forget it.”

He pulled the car over next to a downtown hotel. Adria stared at the back of the headrest. Was she actually doing this?

She moved her eyes over the paper, over her initialed approvals, over her signature. Sweat was forming on her temples. Andy's eyes were unrelenting in the mirror.

“So what do I do now?” she said.

“Get a room. Text me the number. I'll be there in...a while.” The corner of his mouth turned up as he turned his head slightly toward her.

He was good, she could see. Very good. Already he was giving her exactly whatever it was that she craved. Being in control. Dominating. Teasing her with his power over the situation.

She squeezed the clipboard in her fingers. It was done, once she handed him the clipboard.

She thrust it at him suddenly. She caught a glimpse of his smile as she scooted out of the car and into the rainy night, where the revolving doors of the Chevere Hotel swung in front of her.

It was done. She pushed through the doors and strode up to the reception area.

The next half-hour seemed like a dream. Adria felt as though she were a passive passenger inside of her own body. She watched as she booked the hotel, felt herself moving her legs to walk to the elevator, down the corridor, and into the hotel room.

She didn't stop herself as her hand took out her phone and sent the text message with the room number and nothing more. She didn't feel as though her thoughts were her own, as she stood in front of the mirror, contemplating her dress and whether or not she should take it off. Deciding, in the end, that because she had so inexpertly failed to bring a change of clothes, it would be prudent to take it off.

She wouldn't want it to get ripped.

The thought occurred to her to leave the door open, and she walked to the door and propped it with the chain-lock component – a dangerous and stupid thing to do, in a hotel downtown. She did not feel like she was herself as she did this. More like a puppeteer, moving her own body around but far, far away from it.

She felt the panic as though in a dream, when for a full minute she could not recall her choice of safe word.

And then she remembered it, and sat down in her underwear on the edge of the bed.

She felt as though she were not in her own mind, as she lay down on the bed and turned out the light, and wondered if she should pretend to be sleeping, and how long it would take for Andy to arrive.

She felt her hand move down to her underwear, and slide beneath the fabric, and find that she was wet.

She closed her eyes. But her sense were on high, set on fire by what she was about to do. The boxes she had ticked off on the contract swam before her eyes.

Start lightly.

She heard the door open, but she pretended like she was asleep. She heard it click shut, and the sound of the metal as he locked it with the chain. The scrape of the metal on the door made her pussy throb, and she felt the liquid heat of her juices on her inner thigh.

He moved like a big cat on the plush carpet. The tension almost tore her apart as he moved around the room, around the bed. Waiting. Waiting for him to pounce on her.

She let herself give over to her imagination, in that moment. Forgot the contract, the things she had signed. And at that precise moment, she felt the bed dip as he crawled onto it, and before she could do much of anything but open her eyes and turn, he was on top of her.

Heavy.

Strong.

His eyes looked different, narrowed and peering at her through a black mask. His hand was on her mouth and he pressed against her, hard, into the pillow. “Shhhhshhhhh,” he whispered hoarsely. “I’m just here to have a little fun. And if you’re a good girl, then I won’t have to hurt you. Too much.”

She could feel his cock against her thigh. He was already pushing her legs open, and his free hand went to her wrists and caught them both in one tight, huge grip. He pressed them against the headboard, and she squirmed, testing her ability to actually get free of him.

But there was no way. Nothing she could actually do.

And what if she wanted to scream the safe word? His hand was on her mouth and had her clamped down. Barely able to breathe as much as she needed for her racing blood, only through her nose. She let out a small cry.

He held her like this for a moment, smiling as she squirmed, and then panic finally overtook her, and she attempted to thrash against him. But he weighed too much, and his grip was too firm, and she finally settled down. “Now. I’m going to take my hand off your mouth. But it’s going right to your neck. And so if you scream, I’m not going to have much of a choice but to choke you. You understand?”

She nodded the best that she could.

“You’re going to be good?”

She nodded again.

“Good. Because you don’t have a choice, do you?”

She did nothing, and he tapped her cheek firmly with his fingertips and squeezed her jaw. “Do you?”

She shook her head, and the fearful pleasure of submitting to him in that small way dripped over her.

He released her mouth, and paused with his fingertips over her lips. She gasped for air, and he stared at her – maybe waiting to see if she had anything to say, before he placed his hand around her neck. His thumb, large and forceful, rested right over the dip in her throat. He applied a light pressure, reminding her of his promise. And then he let go of one of her hands.

He tucked the one he still held under his knee, and then took the other one to do the same thing. His legs were heavy and he was sitting on top of her now, one hand free to slide his belt from his pants. He stared at her while he did this, his eyes hungry and dominating.

He slid the belt underneath her neck, slowly, and then back over and into the buckle. She felt the leather close around her neck, and he released his hand then. Then he pulled, lightly, and the leather gripped her tightly, tighter, tighter, until her eyes watered and she opened her mouth with a gasp.

He loosened the belt slightly.

Then he rose up on his knees, and this pressed her arms down into the soft mattress, so it only hurt slightly, but still enough to make her gasp. He freed his cock from his black leather pants.

He was erect, and his cock was enormous. It was not extremely long, but it was the thickest cock she had ever seen – in real life, in porn, anywhere. It resembled a blunt instrument, and almost didn't look real.

He smiled at her reaction, and took his heavy dick in one hand. He leaned toward the wall, propping himself up with the hand holding the end of the belt. He guided himself to her mouth, and gave a gentle tug on the belt. She felt the leather squeeze her neck and was surprised by how exquisite the sensation was. He needed to say nothing; she opened her mouth obediently.

He paused, the thick crown of his cock inches from her lips. She could feel the heat, the stickiness of his dick on her lower lip.

“You're going to be good and suck my cock now. And you're going to be very gentle. A very good girl,” he snarled. “Aren't you?”

He tightened the belt just a little more, to emphasize his thinly veiled threat, and she closed her eyes as she tipped her head, the only assent she could really make. Her mouth was still open, and the submissiveness required of her in that moment made her pussy throb.

His cock tasted bitter and salty, and as he pushed the head into her mouth, it scraped along her teeth and pushed her jaw open even wider. “Open up!” he hissed, and gave a light jerk on the belt. “I just want your mouth. That's it, nice and soft and wet. No teeth.”

As he said this, she stretched her mouth open and he pushed inside of her. His cock was so fat she had to strain her mouth to the limits of her jaw, and she was mildly surprised by the way it made her squirm. He kept going, and she gagged as he pressed himself against the back of her throat. He released the belt and used his free hand to reach behind her head and pull her up to him, at the same time thrusting forward, until her whole mouth and throat were filled with cock and she could feel his balls, soft and smooth, against her chin.

He held her there for several seconds, but they began to drag out to an eternity...first strangely pleasant, pressed into the bed, her arms immobile and her mouth impaled and full of cock. Then her lungs began to tickle with a need for air, and then they began to burn. As the burn mixed with a sudden fear that spiked through her, she felt herself attempt to struggle against him, but there was nothing she could do but wait for him to release her.

Just when a slight panic began to build inside of her, he withdrew his cock. She gasped for air. Her saliva dripped from his cock onto her mouth and her cheeks. He hovered above her, and gave her the chance to protest, but she knew she wanted to go there again, to that very dangerous place where she was nearly suffocating with his cock in her throat. She opened her mouth again.

This time his cock went in quickly and easily, down to the back of her throat, filling her and choking off her air. He pushed hard against her face, and she let herself go loose and let go of all struggle against the

impossible restraints of his weight on her arms and against her face. Her lungs began to ache and then to scream at her, and the painful, sinful pleasure of it went through her body in waves.

He performed this act a few more times, and each time it seemed that he took it further, letting her suffer longer. She wondered how long this would go on, and then she had a delicious surge of pleasure as she realized that she had no idea. It was his choice, and all she could do was give in to completely.

On what was perhaps the fourth or fifth iteration of this treatment, he leaned back slightly after he reached the back of her throat, and he lifted her head with him as he did. For a moment she was seized by fear – of what he might do next – and then she felt his fingers on her mound. Expertly, he slipped between the folds of her cunt, and smiled when he found her as wet as she was. He squeezed her clit between his fingers and a violent shudder went through her. He held her immobile, the pain of his weight on her arms and the lack of air in her lungs torturing her even as he squeezed her clit again and another, different, exquisite pain made her shudder in almost unbearable pleasure.

He let her breathe, and then he stuffed himself inside of her again, and began a series of quick-pulsing squeezes on her clit. She began to writhe against him, and tried to make a sound but could not, as her lungs screamed past the painful points he had taken her to so far and she began to feel light-headed, while at the same time she was rising to the top of an orgasmic crest in jerking shudders that racked her whole body violently.

She began to go over the edge. Her orgasm surged inside of her, and she felt an ecstasy she had never felt before. He released her in that moment, and she withdrew his cock from her mouth so she could gasp for air. But she was so gripped by the shrieking high of her orgasm that she could not make a sound or move as it throbbed through her body.

She felt him turning her over, but she was too weakened by what she was experiencing to really resist, or give the appearance of resistance. He pushed her legs apart, and grabbed her hair, pushing her face to the bed and winding her hair in his fingers until it pulled tightly against her scalp. The pain barely made it through the haze of her heated pleasure. Even when she felt as though she were being torn apart when his thick cock rammed inside

of her, she could barely feel the pain over the high she was winding down from.

He thrust into her violently, holding her still against the bed with one hand while he fucked her mercilessly and relentlessly with his blunt dick. Slowly her orgasm subsided and the fullness of his cock, and the raw pain in her pussy, came into sharp focus. He lay down on top of her, and his sweaty chest was against her back. Their skin glided against each other's, they were both so slippery with sweat. He pushed her face to the side and pushed her hair out of the way. "I'm going to fuck you till you can't walk, and then I'm going to fuck you full of cum. And you're just going to lie there and take it. You understand me?"

She nodded.

He placed her arms on the bed and then pulled her up, so that her ass was slightly elevated and he could grip her hips. He then grasped her and began to pound himself inside of her even more rapidly, more violently than before. She balled the sheets up in her hands and tried to remain still, but as he went on pounding her, she started to rise up to another orgasm. Desperate to reach the edge before he came, she squirmed and pushed against him.

He thrust deep inside of her and pressed on her lower back. Then she felt a hard slap on her ass. The sound of it echoes through the room before the pain of it reached her senses. It was as delicious as the gag in the back of her stuffed throat. She felt her pussy pulse around his cock.

He slapped her again. "What did I say?" he seethed. Again, his hand came down on her asscheek and she winced.

"I'm sorry," she panted, as he laid another hard smack on her ass. Her skin was burning now and the shape of his hand throbbed through her skin. She closed her eyes, half of her praying that he would stop, and the other hoping for another searing slap.

He treated her to a final slap, and she convulsed around his cock. He left her like this for a moment, perhaps as a test of her dedication to remaining still – no small feat considering how much she ached for release. She had never come so hard as she just had in her life, and now she was a

desperate as she had ever felt to come again. She felt a warbled moan building in her throat as she fought to remain still.

“Don't do it,” he warned, and gave her another deliciously hard smack on the ass.

And then he slowly began to fuck her again, and she could feel her whole body seizing up with the desire to push against him, to get his cock even deeper inside of her. Whatever the punishment was.

As he slid slowly from inside of her, and only the tip of his cock was holding her pussy open, she had a sudden regret that she had not checked one of the boxes on her contract. She felt his thumb on her anus, making a light pass over the puckered skin of her hole, and she felt herself quiver uncontrollably. She wished he would slip from her pussy and then plunge inside of her and fill her ass. Even as thick as he was. Maybe because he was as thick as he was. She moaned again, imagining the submission, the filling, the pleasure and the pain of his fat cock stretching her open and filling her ass.

A hard slap cracked across her ass. “Don't move!” he said sharply.

Slowly back in he went. She felt real tears building up in her eyes as he slowly slid in and out of her, building her up to an awful precipice and moving just too slowly to set her off. She wanted desperately to move, desperately to feel his cock against her asshole.

But she also wanted desperately to obey. To get the relief she so craved.

“This is a nice little pussy,” he purred behind her. “And I'm going to fill it up you dirty little slut. I can tell that's what you want.” He placed his hands on her buttocks and played with ass some more.

Then, finally, he thrust inside of her deep and began to piston in and out of her, and she felt herself finally, finally, winding up and going over the edge.

This second orgasm was as good as the first, if not entirely the same. She felt her feet flail around on the bed and she turned her face to the sheets and bit down into them. For a moment she was unaware of how loudly she was screaming.

He kept going, and she came so hard that her pussy became oversensitive. His every thrust was then an act of beautiful torture – so pleasurable it was painful, every slap of his balls against her clit sending a jerking shudder through her from head to toe.

She collapsed entirely, and he used for a few more minutes as her sopping pussy gushed and the sloshing, sticky sound of their fucking filled the room. Finally, he grasped her hair and pulled on it hard, lifted her body almost off the bed by the hair and thrusting so deeply inside of her she could feel the head of his cock press against her cervix. And then he burst.

But he wasn't yet done. He slammed his cock into her again and again, wringing every last drop of his cum from his cock. He pressed against her back, holding her still for a few more moments, panting.

She felt his cock slide from inside of her. Just as she let her arms relax, convinced this was the end, she felt his fingers inside of her cunt again. Perhaps three of them – her pussy was so sore and almost numbed after his treatment that she couldn't be sure.

He pulled them out and then she felt his leg on her back again. His hand on her head, wrapping her hair up in his fist again. He shoved his fingers into her mouth, and violently finger fucked her. A big, wet glob of his cum, mingled with her own, slid into her mouth. His lips pressed up against her ear. “You've been a very good girl.” He held her jaw for a second. Then he pushed her head, almost as though he were tossing a ball, onto the sheets. The weight of his body lifted, and she heard his feet on the carpet.

The door clicked shut, locked.

She lay there, throbbing inside and out, unable to move or to process what she had just done.

The pleasure of it still lingered on her body.

The guilt was rising inside of her like a tide.

17 HOMECOMING

“How was it?”

Adria had practiced this question a thousand times in the car on the way to the airport, trying to make her question sound...well, like it was supposed to sound. Neutral. Curious.

And then she had practiced answering John's questions. Clearing away the hesitation, double-checking her story and making sure that she had covered all of her bases. If she told him she had stayed home on Saturday and had a glass of wine, then the half-empty bottle in the fridge would confirm her story.

As the rat's nest of airport overpasses cast a shadow on her car, she still didn't know if she would lie to John or tell the truth. Since the moment she had exited the Chevere Hotel, she had oscillated between confession and lying forever about three times a minute.

Her main reason for not telling him would be, of course, that what he didn't know wouldn't hurt him.

But as she practiced her intended lies in the car, they felt slimier than what she had actually done.

How was it?

As soon as the words left her mouth, and she saw John's face, she knew that she had rehearsed the line too much. His smile seemed to wilt, and his eyebrows turned inward at each other in ever-so-slight confusion.

“You know,” he said, blandly. “Tiring.”

Adria's heart sank as he climbed into the car.

But then he leaned over and placed a hand on her neck, sending a ripple of goosebumps down her spine. He inhaled the scent of her skin near her neck and then placed his lips on her skin, just below her earlobe. “I missed you,” he said. His eyes were closed, and he nuzzled her a little. His

hair tickled her face, smelled of his familiar shampoo and the scent of his head, and Adria's heart flipped again.

"I missed you, too," she said.

And it was true. She had.

"Let's get home," John said, and he placed his lips on her ear. Another shiver of excitement went through her. "I've *really* missed you."

She looked at him. At his smile, at his kind and intelligent face. At his brown eyes, profound and caring, and gazing at her with total devotion.

Her heart flipped again, and she felt the heat of tears building up in her eyes. She smiled bravely, and turned to the road to hide her wet eyes.

There was no way she was telling John, she decided. She had made a terrible mistake, and she needed to never repeat it.

She slid her hand over to his thigh, and squeezed it.

"John?" she said.

"Yes ma'am."

"I really love you."

She could tell the words were important to him, and the knife of guilt inside of her twisted again. But she meant what she said, and that much was, at least, the truth.

When they got home, Adria led him to the bedroom. He slid his hand around her neck and pulled her to him: since their adventures at the wedding, he couldn't get her out of his mind. That had always been true, to an extent, but now he couldn't get her out of his mind in a certain way. A possessive, carnal way. He covered her mouth with his, and dove in for the very center of her, which was where he had been thinking about being, nonstop, since she had dropped him off at the airport a week ago.

But she slipped out of his grip, and down to the bed, where she began to unbuckle his belt, and he felt her fingers tug the zipper, the metal clasp moving over his very hard cock.

He moved his fingers into her hair, and he wanted very much to say that he wanted something else, something more “lovemaking.” But Adria's breath was already warm against the skin of his cock, and her lips were so close...he opened his mouth but could say nothing, and before he knew it she had his dick in her mouth.

The hot wetness of her throat enclosed the flesh of his cock, and he watched as her lips stretched over his shaft and slid down, down, until she was pressed against the base of him. He shuddered with the sweetness of the sensation, and vaguely thought that perhaps he could hold out, get a little bit of her delicious mouth, and then push her on to the bed for what he really wanted.

But an almost electrical force shocked him into a completely new state, when his balls spiked to life as something wet and warm slid over his balls. It took him a moment to put the scene before him and the sensation together, but once he realized that his wife was stroking his balls with her tongue, he lost control of himself and his mind completely.

The filthy images of Adria with her legs spread for her first extramarital lover, Mark, and the sound of her moans as another man fucked her flooded his mind. At the same time Adria's tongue was working quickly, teasing and tickling the skin of his balls, bulging out from the pressure of her lips against the base of his cock. As she did this, her tongue rubbed the underside of his dick, and a gurgle rose from her mouth.

“Oh fuck,” he whispered. “I'm coming...Adria...”

But she never gave him the chance to pull himself from her mouth. She seemed to massage the cum from inside of him.

It was only after the orgasm had shaken him from head to toe, and his wife slowly released his cock from her mouth; only when his dick flopped against his thigh with a wet slap and Adria looked up very briefly at him as she wiped the corner of her mouth, that he realized something was wrong.

She smiled, but the smile seemed off. “Welcome home,” she said.

He was panting. “Let me..I could...return the favor,” he said, giving her a smile.

She smiled again, but the shape of her mouth was wrong. Or didn't match her eyes. She barely looked at him, before she stood up and went to the bathroom. "It's okay sweetie," she said, and she ruffled his hair as she walked by. "I'm pretty tired."

She never ruffled his hair.

The bathroom door closed, and John sat down on the bed.

He had worried about this, in between the times he had re-imagined the naughty things his wife had done, and the naughty things he'd like her to do. He'd worried that Adria had gone too far, and that she regretted what they had done.

It was odd though. Everything had seemed okay until he had gone out of town.

A cool shiver went through him, as he let himself hold the thought he dreaded most for only a moment. He dropped it quickly, as though it were burning him, which it very nearly was.

There was no way Adria was cheating on him.

Was there?

He rubbed his eyes.

No, it was probably the first thing he had thought of. And he would have to deal with it.

He felt a twinge of disappointment.

He went to the sink to brush his teeth.

"You okay?" he called, when Adria didn't emerge for what seemed like an eternity.

Her voice was sweet, and made him think he was imagining everything, when she responded.

"I think maybe I'm coming down with something," she said. "I just feel out-of-sorts."

Sick.

Simple enough.

He went into the shower and pulled the door open to kiss her. She offered him her cheek. There was nothing unusual about that: Adria was a stickler for germ theory and not transmitting colds.

“I’ll make you some hot tea,” he said.

He thought he saw a look a devastation cross her face, but hen she smiled. “Thank you,” she said.

“You sound froggy,” he told her. She did. “I’ll add lemon.”

But by the time he got back, she was in bed with a pillow over head, and appeared to be sound asleep.

18 MORE ADVICE

Adria almost didn't go to work out with Lily on Wednesday.

Like her feelings about whether she should tell John, she went back and forth on whether she needed desperately to talk to Lily, or would bury the whole thing deep in soul for all of eternity.

After all: no one need ever know it had happened, except for her.

She was headed home, in fact, when she turned around and went to the gym.

Lily was furiously punching a bag, nearly knocking over the woman who was holding it with each violent thrust, but she stopped immediately when she saw Adria.

“Whoa hoa,” she called, wiping sweat from her brow with the back of her mitt. “I thought you'd ditched me.”

Adria kept walking, and she jerked her head in the direction of the locker rooms. “I need to talk to you,” she said. “I'll be in the sauna.”

Lily already had her teeth on the tape around her mitt.

She took talking very seriously.

“Okay,” Lily said, leaning back against the dripping wall. Almost like an omen, the sauna was extra-hot today.

Or maybe that's just how Adria felt, she mused, because she was so riddled with guilt.

Adria opened her mouth to speak, and realized she wasn't really sure how to tell this story. She hesitated, and Lily blinked at her. Then she plunged in.

“I called the number,” she began. She looked to Lily for help, but her friend was looking at her almost expressionlessly.

“I called the number and I met someone,” Adria elaborated.

Lily became suddenly animated. “Oh!” She poked an elbow toward Adria. “O-kay. And was it good?”

“No,” Adria said quickly, wanting to steer Lily from the wrong conversation, and then corrected herself when she realized Lily would think she was answering her question. “Yes. I mean...look, that isn't what I want to talk about.” Adria waved her hands around, almost as if she wanted to erase the conversation.

Picking up on this Lily waved at her. “Oh you have to tell me now. This conversation is already started.”

But at that moment, a much older woman came into the sauna and sat down directly in front of them. She smiled warmly and leaned back against the wall, adjusting her towel and closing her eyes.

Adria looked at Lily helplessly.

Lily rolled her eyes and leaned back against the wall, appearing for a moment like she was going to go to sleep. Adria's stomach was in knots: she was so close to confessing what she had done, and now she would have to wait for this woman to leave.

Lily had other plans, though. She stood up, unwrapping the towel as she did. She stretched her arms out and took the towel with them, and rubbed it on her back. Then she tossed the towel on the bench and sat down on it, fully naked. Adria stared at her. She leaned back against the wall and closed her eyes again.

Adria could sense that the woman was getting a little uncomfortable, but she couldn't see her expression from the corner of her eye and didn't want to turn her head to see what she was doing.

“Did I ever show you my clit ring?” Lily said suddenly, in a very loud voice.

Adria's mouth hung open and she stared at Lily. Her friend opened her eyes and winked at her as she slid her finger down her stomach, and her legs fell open slightly.

The woman coughed, stood up, and left, waving awkwardly as she did. "It's too hot in here," she mumbled.

Adria was staring at Lily's fingers. Lily laughed and pulled her towel around herself. "Okay. Now spill the dirt."

Adria wanted to know if Lily really had a clit ring, and a variety of other questions plagued her as well. She closed and opened her eyes very slowly. "That was rude," she said, finally.

Lily slapped her on the knee. "Come on," she whined. "I want to know what is going on. You called. You had someone come over. And then what?"

Adria looked down at her feet. Her voice was a low whisper when she spoke. "I went through with it."

There was a long pause.

"And? Was it good?" Lily's voice was lighthearted. Adria suddenly felt annoyed. How could she be like this? How was everything a game to her?

"Okay, okay, I think I get it," Lily said, when Adria didn't answer. "What's wrong? You didn't tell John? You did? I thought you had an arrangement."

Adria paused. She could feel her stomach twisting again. "It's not..we don't have *this* arrangement."

Lily rubbed one eye. "So you feel what? Guilty? Did you tell him?"

"No."

Lily opened her eyes again. "Do you think he's gonna find out?"

Adria sucked in her breath. "Not unless..."

"Oh no. Oh no. Don't you even think about it. Listen, *chiquita*, let me tell you something. If he's not gon' find out, then you leave it and you don't tell him. No. If you feel guilty, that's..." she waved her hand frantically in the air. "That will go away. That's means you shouldn't tell him. Oh no."

Adria frowned. "But I -"

“No. Nope.” Lily spun on to face her, her legs crossed. She waved her slender, manicured finger violently in Adria's face. “Look. You did something, you did it for you, you feel bad. You make him feel bad, then you feel worse, then you sit around for like six months talking about your marriage, it's always hanging over your head...no, no, no, *cabrona*, *fijate lo que* I am telling you. Uh-uh.” Lily spun back to lean against the wall and folded her arms.

“But what if he finds out later?” Adria said weakly. “Isn't that-”

“The biggest lies are the most believable. Didn't someone say that?”

“Hitler.”

Lily frowned. And then she laughed. “Well. It's still good advice. Look, if he finds out you have the same mess on your hands, and that will be a big mess. But how's he gon' find out? You cover this up with a lot of what he wants, you know...do that other thing...what's your other thing you do?”

Adria stared at her blankly.

“Oh,” Lily said, grinning. “Yeah, the other men. Do that. You cover it up with a lot of good stuff. Like social media mistakes.” She laughed.

There was a silence. Adria realized she had come to Lily for advice because she would say what she really wanted to hear: that it was okay to cover up what she had done. Deep down inside, she knew that she wasn't actually confused about what to do: she knew the right thing would be to tell John. She just didn't want to face it.

“What else?” Lily said. Her eyes were closed again but she had an expression on her face as though she were looking right at, and through, Adria. “Something else is bothering you.”

Adria bit her lower lip.

“Come on,” Lily said.

“The thing is...oh God, never mind.” Adria pushed beads of sweat and a stray hair from her forehead. Then she felt a sudden urge to confess. “The thing is...I liked it. The...you know, the guy. The...”

Lily had a knowing smile on her face now. “The *aventura*. Yeah, I know.” There was another pause. “So what, you want to do it again?”

Adria could feel something twist inside of her at the thought. A rising lust made her pussy well up, just imagining “Andy's” fingers losing around her throat just before she came...the potential for so much more. So much more the way she liked it.

“So do it again,” Lily said, without waiting for her answer. She shrugged. “What's the problem?”

Adria sniffed. “John.”

Lily scraped her forehead with her thumb and shook her hair. Droplets of hot water flecked Adria's skin. She squirmed in her towel, unable to believe how turned on she was by just the thought of another “*aventura*” with Andy, one in which she might go even further, check even more boxes...

“I don't see why you can't just combine your fantasies,” Lily said suddenly. “You like it rough, he likes to watch, why you can't just kill two birds with one shot? Hmm? You call your guy, you hide *Yone* in the curtains or something, and then ev-ery-body happy.” She sang the last part and opened her eyes.

Adria widened her eyes.

Lily smiled again and waved a finger at her, standing up. “You know it's the right idea. *Ay, carajo* it's hot in here, I have to get out.” She glided toward the exit. “See you out there.”

A small puff of air announced her exit. Adria was alone in the steam room.

And rather than contemplating her marriage, and what she should do about it, she found her mind wandering back to the night with Andy...and then to other things she wanted, other things she craved, other things she knew John wouldn't be able to do for her. Not the same way...

She pulled up her towel and slid her pointer finger along her thigh and into the soaked folds of her pussy. She was incredibly wet, and inside of her there was an aching throb. She rubbed her fingertip over the smooth face of her clit, while she imagined Andy's cock making slow circles around her

anus. She imagined his fingers working their intricate magic while he filled her ass, and she submitted entirely to him.

She shuddered to a climax just as she imagined opening her eyes, her face pressed to the sheets, and seeing in front of her: John. Watching.

John: feeling...

what?

19 BOOZE CRUISE

It was a beautiful night on the harbor. The city sparkled against a cloudless sky, the wind off the lake was light and just enough to choke out the unusually hot late summer day. The water was like glass, and the city reflected almost perfectly in it. Traces of bright yellow were sinking into the western sky.

But John Querte had his eyes on none of this. He was leaning against the balcony as though he wanted to be alone and contemplate the water, but what he was in fact watching was his wife.

Adria had purchased a new dress for this cruise, and it was so stunning it was almost obscene. She had approached him while he was in the shower and asked if he wanted to see her new dress. She was naked at the time, and he had run his eyes over her body while he answered. The dress was small enough that she had it folded up in her hand, and so she shook it out and held it up for him to see that almost all of the dress was completely see-through. He had laughed, almost as though it were a joke. And then she had slipped it over her head. "I can't wear any underwear, or a bra," she had explained, sliding the material into place. By then he had let the showerhead fall to his side with a clatter, and given a soft laugh, thinking she couldn't possibly be serious.

That was two nights before. He had assumed it was part of an act, and that there was something more to the dress – a slip, something she hadn't shown him. But when she had stepped onto the boat – she had met him there, because they were each coming from work on opposite sides of the city – all heads had turned.

The dress was held up by two thin straps, and in shape it was not exceedingly unusual: it was even long, almost to the floor. A simple dress, a simple, figure-hugging shape.

But the material was semi-transparent, all the way through, with nothing more than a delicate embroidered flower pattern, very precisely

placed, to cover her snatch, the crack of her ass, and her nipples. It was an elegant dress, an expensive dress, and the flimsy flowers never failed to be in the right place, covering what they were supposed to. But as she walked along and they shifted with her gait, every man on the boat was hoping they would fail. The curve of her ass, and the swell of her breasts were visible in the right light, as though she were naked. Her hair was down and she had straightened it. She looked stunning.

And, as she had promised two days ago, she was in fact not wearing any underwear.

He had never seen her in anything quite so risque, and obviously no one else had either. No one could disguise the fact that they were watching her every move.

The party was a mingler by BantaCorp, trying to butter up the engineering firms and encourage interpersonal communication, or whatever corporate jargon they had come up with for the invite. There were a lot of men like himself: not bad-looking, trim, mid-thirties, engineers. A lot of trim, pretty wives. And then a lot of guys from the upper rings of the construction ladder. Fitter. Better-looking. Not always with wives.

And then, floating above all of them, was his own wife in her see-through dress.

What John couldn't figure out is if she was on the prowl for another man, for another way to make his fantasy come true. The mere thought of it seized him by the balls. He had no idea if he wanted her to do it or not, especially here, where their colleagues abounded. The thought of his hot, lewdly-dressed wife getting a reputation as a woman who fucked construction workers on a cruise made him feel like he was going to throw up, but the thought of watching her do it had his cock ratcheted up to its most ready.

Adria seemed to know that he was thinking of her, and she tossed her hair and winked in his direction. She was talking to Mike Sternum, and she was making no effort to hide her flirtatiousness. She laughed and placed her hand on his arm.

John felt his cock throb, and he wished there were a way to watch his wife with Mike and hide his erection.

Adria approached him. Even her walk seemed changed. Now it went with the dress: slinky, oversexed, unusually provocative.

“You're having quite the time with Mike,” he said.

She brought a glass of wine to her lips. “I am,” she purred. But her eyes seemed...dull. Or distracted. Or both.

John couldn't quite put his finger on Adria and what she was doing or thinking. Everything she was *doing* seemed to be part of a seduction, and she *seemed* to be doing it with her sights set on another man. She *seemed* to be following through on his fantasy again.

But something was off, and it had been for days. Ever since he had come home. He couldn't quite put his finger on it. John by nature was an analytical man, and he didn't like confrontation unless he had things thoroughly analyzed. But even as Adria slinked around in a transparent dress, reeling in men like fish from a barrel, he sensed that her heart was either not in it.

Or maybe in it too much?

His own heart felt like it was being squeezed in a vice.

“So...”

“So...”

“Nice dress, by the way. I didn't think you were serious,” he said.

She smiled. “I was.”

He sipped his own wine. “And are you serious now?”

Adria gave him a weak grin, and there it was again: something wrong, something changed from the way she had been at the wedding. “About?”

“What you're doing,” he said.

“And what am I doing?” She was coy again, and she batted her eyes.

Maybe he was misreading things. Maybe what he was seeing in Adria was his own paranoia. Maybe there was nothing “off” about Adria at all.

“I think you know what you're doing,” he said.

She turned and waved at Mike. Then she turned back to John. She raised her eyebrows.

It was a question. Did he want her to fuck Mike?

But she really didn't wait for his answer, however he might have conveyed it. She knew what it was anyway. That however much he might be torn between the two choices, his cock was overpowering his rational mind. Sure, it was a bad idea. Especially since they all worked together. Sure, he could think of the consequences, of the humiliating future with Mike grinning in his presence, knowing that he had banged John's wife full of cum. But his near-bursting cock couldn't tell a lie. It was overriding his common sense.

So when Adria slinked away, he didn't try to stop her. He just stood there watching the moving lines and shadows of the curve of her ass through the transparent dress. It was a spectacular sight.

She made her move quickly. John felt a knife of humiliation and anger through him when Adria leaned to whisper to Mike and made the man look over in John's direction and smile wickedly. He watched Mike's big lips whisper in Adria's ear, and then she smiled, and slinked away. Toward the bow, the indoor part of the ship.

Mike looked around, a self-satisfied grin on his face, and John made sure to appear to be looking out at the water when his eyes came to him. Then Mike, too, headed off in the same direction as Adria.

John realized he had had more to drink than he thought, as he stumbled through the narrow hallways in the cabin of the ship. They seemed to break off into labyrinthine forks and hidden passages, though he knew it was probably his fervor and the booze that made him think that way.

He couldn't see Mike or his wife in the passages. He heard a throaty laugh from a room, but when he peeked through the crack, he was mortified to see another woman, whose face became instantly annoyed. She shut the door in his face.

But then he heard Mike's voice. A murmur that could only have been Adria.

There was a room labeled as a conference room, and the door was open. John could see the silhouette of Adria's body, but Mike was in the shadows. He looked quickly around. There was no place to really hide, or even stand inconspicuously.

"Ain't your husband here?" he heard Mike say. His voice was low, like the purr of a Harley. "He ain't gonna miss you?" John pressed himself against the wall. A voice in an adjoining corridor sent his heart crashing to his feet. What would he do if he got caught?

"This is some dress," Mike's voice continued. "What's this made out of? Tissue paper?" There was a silence, and John leaned toward the door and strained to look in, but he couldn't see anything. His heart was pounding, his cock was throbbing. He searched his mind wildly for an idea, a way to get in. Maybe he could crawl under the table?

But what if Mike caught him?

John's stomach suddenly felt wretched. This was a bad idea. She shouldn't go after someone they worked with.

How could he put the brakes on this?

"No panties, girl?" Mike's voice said.

John strained to peer into the darkness. As much as he wanted to put a stop to this madness, he also desperately wanted to see Mike Sternum's big black hand probing his wife beneath her sheer dress, feeling how she wasn't wearing any underwear.

He slid down the wall. His cock was leading him around now, and he didn't like it. He had never been that kind of guy. Yet here he was, about to crawl into a dark room to get a better view of another man fucking his wife. Even though he knew it was a terrible idea.

"Oh...no, you know what?"

Adria's voice.

"I can't. I just..."

“Oh come on girl, I'll make it quick and dirty.”

“I'm sorry,” Adria said.

John popped to his feet and paused. Was this part of her game?

“You can't take a brother all the way to the water and not let him have a drink..”

John heard some rustling, some movement, and his heart sank and rose again. Sank because he was sure this was a bad idea, sank because his wife was going to fuck another man. And rose for...well, the same reasons.

Then Adria, after a wet slurp. “No. No, I'm sorry. I know it's shitty...”

“*Damn,*” Mike protested.

More quiet kissing. John knew now that Adria was clearing out, giving up, letting Mike down. But he didn't want to miss a single second of it until she actually walked away.

“I won't tell your husband,” Mike was purring. John knew he was still pawing at her, rubbing her nipples into pebbles through the fabric of the dress, or maybe still crawling up her thigh beneath the fabric.

Then he heard Adria moving toward the door. He backed away and then scurried down an adjacent corridor when her voice grew louder. “I'm sorry,” she said. “I just can't do this.”

John was up on the deck when she emerged.

She shook her head, and went to the bar, where she got a glass of wine. She looked pale. She came to stand by John.

“Let's go home,” she said.

20 CONFESSIONS

“You want to talk about it?” John said, finally. Twenty minutes of silence had prevailed in the car after they had stepped inside.

He thought he saw, in his peripheral vision, a quick heave of Adria's chest, like a sob. She turned her head to the window by the time he snapped his head over to look at her. She had her hand to her mouth.

He pulled the car over, parking in a Walgreen's. There was a late-night scene at a fast-food restaurant through the bushes and it was spilling over into the pharmacy parking lot. He immediately regretted his choice, but he forged ahead anyway. He put his hand on Adria's knee. “Honey, listen...I don't want you to feel pressured by...any of this. I...look, you're obviously upset. I want to talk about it. If you don't want to do this anymore, you know that's okay, right? I was just going along with what I thought you wanted, too...Adria?”

When she turned to him her face was streaked with tears. “I have something to tell you,” she sniffed, and he felt his heart drop through his stomach and his groin, and through the seat. Involuntarily, he released her knee.

But just in case he had not already discovered, from her tears and her tone, that it was something bad, she lowered her eyes. “I did something. I wasn't going to tell you, but tonight I couldn't go through with things, not without...I don't know. I have to clear the slate. I have to tell you.”

A bottle splintered near the car, and John, stunned, turned the engine on and put the car in reverse. His face was stunned as he turned to Adria. “We have to get out of here,” he said calmly.

Adria burst into tears, and he knew it was because he had his “calm voice” on, the one he used to, in her words, “handle her.”

Which meant that whatever she did was very bad indeed.

“I don't know what to say.”

Adria had her arms folded over her chest, and she was staring at a mug she had filled with red wine when they got home. She had finished telling her story minutes ago, the whole sordid story.

John *didn't* know what to say.

He felt, obviously, a deep fury swelling up inside of him. An urge to stand up, throw something across the room, and leave the house. He had never wanted to slap anyone before; it wasn't his nature. But for a brief moment, he had felt the urge and had to fight it. To reach across the table and slap Adria right across the cheek.

There was that. There was also the calm, rational John. Analytical John, who was making a monotones argument in the back of his mind that he really had no right to be *furious*, since he was the one who had introduced the idea of extramarital affairs into the relationship, given her the go-ahead, so enthusiastically approved of it in rope after rope of white cum.

There was the sting of hurt under there as well. The fact that he couldn't give his wife something she seemed to crave so much sexually.

But then, there was the side of him that surprised him the most. The side of him that had a hard cock. The side of him that wanted to throw Adria over his knee and spank her for being so naughty, right after he extracted every last sordid detail from her about what she had done, and how it had felt.

He could feel that John, almost incredibly, winning, in the great four-way tug-of-war in his mind.

Adria looked up at him. “I know it doesn't really cut it to say I'm sorry, I know. But I am. I'm sorry because I risked too much for something so...trivial. It's not a thing about...I don't know. Anything except this fantasy I've been having. I can't get it out of my head. And I guess I thought that...we did this other thing...”

“Now I feel like you're lying,” John said sharply. “I mean, what do you want me to say, Adria? You risked our marriage for something like this _”

“Hold on there,” Adria said, and her eyes were suddenly angry. “You did the same thing, didn't you?”

“It's different. We talked about it.”

Her eyes seemed to get black. “Or it's different because you're in control of it. Because *you* get what you want.”

“Don't turn it back on me like these two things are the same. One, we agreed to, and the other, we did not. Not like this. And you know it, that's why you tried to hide it.” His voice was icy.

They stared at each other, two smart people having an argument that was about to turn to semantics. They had been here before. Nothing had ever been this serious before, but they had been here before.

He was surprised, then, when Adria, who was as stubborn as they come in an argument, let her arms fall away from their tight, defensive stance around her chest. “You're right,” she said. “There isn't any point arguing about it. All there is to do now is decide if you forgive me or not.”

John's mouth was hanging open slightly.

Adria cocked her head.

She was smart, and she had sniffed out something about his reaction.

Something not-so-angry.

“Unless...”

She leaned forward, and he was stupidly too late to move or block her hand from diving between his legs, where she found his hard cock. Her eyes narrowed. “So what's that, then?” she said. Her tone was one he had never heard before, her expression unfathomable. He didn't know whether to put money on her being indignant, furious, turned on, or amused.

Maybe, like him, she was all of those things.

“So is it making me feel guilty that has you so turned on?” she said, and her voice was like a razor. She squeezed his balls. She smiled. It was all very dangerous, like holding a venomous snake. “Or what I did? Or maybe something else, like how you're going to make me make it up to you? Hmm? What is it, John?”

He exhaled sharply.

She raised her eyebrows and her fingers worked on his zipper at the same time.

She slipped her hand into his boxers and took his cock into it. “All three?” she asked.

His cock pulsed wildly in her hand, and he saw that she had felt it and registered its meaning, its obvious and primal affirmative answer to her question. Yes, all three. Yes he forgave her. Yes, he wanted to fuck her, as a punishment, as a reclaiming, as a way to get her to tell him what she had let another man do to her, and he wanted her to feel guilty enough to let him, John, do something truly wicked to her.

She squeezed his cock back. “I think I have a perfect resolution, if that's the case.”

He exhaled again. He had no idea what this woman, his wife but not his wife, was going to have in store for him.

She pushed her chair away, and moved around to the other side of the table. As she approached him he pushed away from the table, and his chair ground on the floor. His cock was bobbing in the air, freed from his boxers. She climbed onto his lap, and he felt her juices drip from her pussy as she hovered just above his cock, swaying slightly. “Do you want to hear it?”

He must have looked confused.

“My plan?” she said. “How I'm going to make it up to you, and everyone will be happy?”

But then she let her body fall, and his cock was suddenly immersed in all of her hot, wet flesh.

She leaned close to his ear. His cock was pulsing wildly and he was close to coming, he squeezed his eyes closed and tried to concentrate and holding back until she finished her “plan.”

She rocked slowly, stroking his cock with her soft cunt, her juices pouring down his balls, as she whispered in his ear:

“I bet you think I've been a very bad girl. Maybe I need a little bit of a spanking. Maybe a little bit of punishment.”

John shuddered, and he could feel himself going over the edge.

“And you never got to watch, which is your favorite thing,”

Another shudder. He sucked in his breath.

“So what if we give my friend Andy a call, and tell him to show you exactly. What. He. Did? Hmm? And then maybe he can give me the kind of punishment I deserve?”

He felt her pussy well up with his hot cum, and his head felt light as his face went red with rage and lust and the rocketing, intense orgasm that made him rigid as stone from head to foot, while his cock pumped his very naughty wife full of cum.

21 MAKE UP SEX

John felt like he had to tell himself to breathe. If he forgot to remind himself, his lungs forgot, and began to ache as much as his cock, and then his breath was loud and ragged. He willed himself to breathe calmly as he waited in the darkened room, only the light of the bathroom casting a faint glow on the bed where he would watch his wife with another man.

He knew he should be less excited, more angry, more horrified by what Adria had done, and by what they were about to do. The implications of it, in the delicate dance of power that was sex and love and marriage. He knew he should be thinking more rationally about consequences and trust. Instead, he had found a well of reptilian desires inside of himself, all of them bottled up. Now that the lid had been unscrewed, they were overflowing, like street covers blown off in a flood.

Did it disturb him that his wife had arranged to meet the same man she had technically cheated on him with, and bring him here, so that he, John, could watch them together? It should. He knew it should. Maybe it did. But his desire to see them together, to feed his own animal, to see what Adria craved so much that he couldn't give her, to see her get it, in the flesh – all of this overpowered the disturbance.

He was sitting in a chair, as though waiting for a meeting, and the arrangement was that he would do so. This “Andy” character didn't care, in fact, he had seen it before. So much for feeling alone in the world, or truly perverted. The man hadn't batted an eye, apparently, when Adria told him the plan.

The door clicked and he watched his wife walk in. She was dressed in a short black dress, nothing particular special about it except that it was stunning on her. A little slutty, with a low-sweeping collar in the back and the front, and sleeves that sort of hung off her shoulders as though she had already had a roll in the hay. Her hair, tantalizingly, was in a tight ponytail,

and he hoped she had done it for the same reasons that he immediately imagined: so that her rough lover could hold her ponytail while he rammed himself inside of her. John's cock throbbed.

“He's coming,” was all that Adria said, and she walked sexily toward the bed. John had a moment to wonder if she would sit on the edge of the bed, and if they would have some kind of awkward conversation as they waited. But only a moment. Because before the door even swung shut, his wife's paid lover pushed the door open. He moved stealthily, stopped just behind her, and seized her. His hands slid over her body from behind, drawing her skirt up to just below her waist, fondling her breasts, and then one hand wrapping around her throat. He lifted her off the ground for a second, and placed his mouth against her face. “How's my naughty little girl?” he sneered, and licked the side of her face.

John sucked in his breath.

Andy spun her around and pushed her to the bed. She fell onto it violently, and started to kick off her shoes. He grabbed her hair and pulled on it, turning her face up to him. “Don't take those off. Not yet. I have plans for them. Right now I want you to suck my cock.”

He jerked her head back more, and used his free hand to liberate his cock. His jeans fell down to his ankles, and his cock sprang from inside of them. He was already hard, and his cock seemed to be growing with each second. It was fat, almost as though it was overstuffed; veins bulged on the sides of it, pushed out by the thickness of the meat. He placed the blunt tip of his cock on Adria's lips and rubbed it over them. “I hear you've been a very, very bad girl,” he said. He used his hand to slap his cock on Adria's mouth, and then across her cheeks. “You have some apologizing to do.”

It was obscene. Utterly obscene. And all John could do was stare, his cock throbbing to every more painful hardness with each slap of Andy's cock on his wife's face.

“Maybe you can show me how sorry you are right now.”

Adria opened her mouth, and John watched as each fat inch of Andy's cock slid slowly between her lips. Her jaw was forced to stretch to a painful-looking width to accommodate the big cock, and her nostrils flared

as she struggled to breathe with it in her mouth as he slowly pushed in, until her throat was filled and she could breathe no more.

Andy's huge balls pushed out to bulbous globes as he pressed his pelvis against John's wife's face, and they crushed against her chin. Andy's hand stretched down to Adria's neck and rubbed the outside of her throat. "Look at me, Ana," he said, using Adria's (John supposed) whore name. "Look at me while you eat my cock. Give it a little massage."

At least twenty seconds had passed and John was beginning to fear for Adria's ability to breathe. Her eyes were watering, and a fat tear slid from the corner of her eye and down her cheek. He had an urge to stand up, call the whole thing off, but a perverted desire to see how long Andy would leave his cock in her throat. Adria began to ball her fists up on the bed cover, and another tear snaked down her cheek.

John was tensing the muscles in his thighs to rise from the chair, when Andy slid his cock out from Adria's mouth and let her gasp for air. But he gave her very little time, and held her chin so that she had to look at him while she gasped for air. Then he went back in again.

John watched, transfixed, a mixture of jealousy, repulsion, and, strangely, satisfaction, coursing through him, as Andy held his wife immobile again with his cock, his hand around her throat, coaxing her to massage his dick while she squirmed with the pain of being unable to breath.

Her skirt had been pushed up to above her waist now, and on the third "massaging" she was giving to Andy's cock, John noticed that she had spread her legs and that the material of her panties was soaked through. However perverted what Andy was doing might be, it had both of them aroused to near-climax.

John fumbled for a drink he had placed next to himself, not knowing what else to do but stare at his wife's stuffed mouth, at the big hand wrapped around her throat, at her watery, submissive gaze for another man. He was grateful for something to do to keep his own hands from his cock; he felt like the lightest graze against his throbbing dick would send him sporting cum all over himself, with what seemed to be a long time still to go.

His hand shook as brought the drink to his lips. Andy released Adria again, and saliva dribbled from the tip of his cock to her chin. Her mascara left black streaks from the corner of her eye to her cheekbone, and her lips seemed almost distended by the stretching of her mouth. Her face was a streaked, spit-covered disaster, and John felt his cock thump painfully against the confines of his pants.

Andy went in again and again, forcing Adria to wait for nearly half a minute, until her lungs must have begun screaming for air, and she was pleading with her eyes and presumably the motion of her throat, for him to let her breathe. Each time, she gasped more desperately for air, and it seemed that he gave her less time to recover before stuffing her full again. Adria's panties soaked through, and her innermost thighs became sticky and shiny with her excitement.

John could never do anything like this to his wife. Even imagining himself in this position was too much for him: but he loved watching it. There was no denying that.

Andy pushed Adria back onto the bed suddenly, and dropped down to pick up his jeans. For a second, John felt a drop of disappointment: it looked like he was leaving. He hoisted them up to his hips. But it was only to unthread a belt from the loops of his pants. John shivered as the leather snapped loose and Andy tossed it on the bed. He shimmied out of the jeans again, and stood over Adria, who was panting, while he removed his shirt over his head.

He was now naked, and the fullness of his abs and his arms was on display: he was a big man, a muscled man. A man who could throw a woman around if he wanted.

He got onto the bed on his knees and almost in the same motion reached out to Adria and flipped her over. He pushed her dress up to her chest, so her back and ass were exposed. Her black lace thong underwear were still on her hips and snug between her asscheeks.

Andy used his knees to push her legs apart, and then he drew her feet up. Her shoes were still on: a pair of slick, simple high heels with a long, slender spike of a heel. He propped her feet up so that the pretty figure of the shoes on her shapely feet hovered, bouncing a little, over her obscenely

displayed ass. Then he took her hands and placed them on the heels. "Don't let go of those heels unless I tell you to," he ordered.

Adria obeyed. He grabbed several pillows and stuffed them roughly under her pelvis, so her ass was tilted up and on display. Then he slowly peeled the thong away, and Adria's neatly trimmed pussy, which was engorged and blown open like a burst flower, was visible to them both. Red, glistening, ripe for Andy to fuck. He slid his fingers over her her clit and her legs bobbed, but she held on to the heels as he had commanded. Andy made a sound, a little like a tisk. "Such a bad girl, aren't we, Ana? And your husband watching."

John felt himself go cold for a moment. But Andy continued to massage his wife's pussy, and Adria continued to shudder with the pleasure of his touch.

Andy slipped a finger inside of her, and John saw that Adria's body arched slightly. Then another finger, and a third. Then, to his disbelief, he watched as Andy slipped his entire hand inside of Adria's pussy. His wife squirmed and moaned, and one of her feet slipped from her hand. Andy caught her wrist, and it looked frail and almost snappable in his large paw. He moved a knee on top of her flailing leg. "Hold still, Ana. You're being very bad and you're going to get punished for it. You just relax and take it. You've been a naughty little girl and your husband wants to see you punished for it."

John went cold again at the mention of himself. But a heat burned through him as well: he did want to see her punished. In a way. In a way like this, that made her so wet that she dripped down the sides of her thighs. In a way that satisfied them both.

Andy did another temporarily inexplicable thing, and pulled his fist from inside of her. He jerked her underwear back up and over her hips. The soaked thong slipped between her folds and she whimpered as he pulled it hard to twist one side of it around her wrist.

The bondage was flimsy, of course, but the intent was clear. He splayed her captive fingers over her left buttock. Then he pushed the now cord-like strip away from her swollen hole, and pushed his hand inside of

her. Her pussy squelched as he entered, and she saw her raise her ass and twist in discomfort as his whole hand disappeared inside of her.

And then he reached for the belt.

John stared at his wife, waiting for her to utter her safe word, but she did not. She dug her fingernails into the flesh of her ass, and twisted against the pain of Andy's fist stretching her pussy open, but she did not call it off. It was obvious that she liked this level of dominance, of roughness, of her own submission.

Andy slapped her – very lightly, with precise control, with the folded belt. A red mark appeared on her ass, and the sound of her slapped flesh cracked through the sloshing, wet sound of her pussy. Andy lifted his arm, and his muscles bulged. Adria's hips came up from the pillow about an inch, and she screamed, but it was a half-pleasured scream. Andy cracked his belt again, and then again.

“Now be good,” he hissed, and let her hips drop back to the pillow.

He pulled his hand from inside of her pussy, and then re-inserted it, with his thumb out to stroke her slit. John watched as he brought his wife easily to orgasm, with only a few quick rubs over the swollen nerves of her clit. Adria screamed into the pillows, and tossed her head back and forth. Her cunt was filled by his hand but he could still see dribbles of her cum bursting from the sides.

“Good girl. You're going to be glad for that,” he said. He slid his hand from inside of her, and it was soaked with her slick cum. Globes of white were on his fingers, slippery like oysters,. John could smell her now from where he was. It was utterly lewd, the image in front of him. His mouth felt dry, and he realized he had been staring with his jaw hanging open for the past few minutes.

He brought the drink to his lips, and while he did, trembling, Andy readjusted Adria as though she were a doll, pushing her chest to the bed, jerking her underwear until it ripped away from her. He slid her dress up until it was over her head and arms. Adria, who seemed to know what was coming, brought her hands next to her, and she placed her fingers in her mouth. She looked at John, a strange expression on her face, but he could only stare back. He took a sip of his drink.

Andy propped Adria up so that her ass was high in the air, her legs spread, and her ass and pussy exposed and waiting for him to with as he pleased. John's cock pulsed.

Andy used his slippery, cum-coated hand to draw some of the moisture that was gushing from Adria's cunt to the eyelet of her anus. John watched, but as the realization of what was about to happen reached his conscious mind, his hand shook and the whiskey splattered onto his lap. It was cold, but it only stimulated him. He stopped breathing as he watched Andy slip his thumb into Adria's ass.

She moaned, and it was a pained moan. Her eyes closed, and then they opened. Andy's finger was in to the knuckle. Adria balled her hand up and bit on her own thumb knuckle. Her eyes grew wet.

Andy plunged in and out of her, and she convulsed. Then she said, "No, no I can't."

But he gave her a slap on the ass for this. "I'll tell you what you can and can't do."

He used his pointer finger to spread her ass even more, and she gave a cry. Her eyes squinted shut.

"Just relax, Ana," he said, gruffly. "The more you relax, the less it hurts. You better get ready, because I'm going to stuff you all the way full of cock."

John dropped his drink.

Adria opened her mouth. No sound came from her as the third finger went inside of her. Andy spread his fingers and stretched her ass. She whimpered and mumbled, "I can't. Oh god. No, I can't do it."

"You will do it," he said.

He finger-fucked her for a moment or two, and Adria whimpered, but then he smiled. "There we go. That's it. Just take it. It's better that way."

He pulled his fingers out, and gave her ass a final spread – it had stretched remarkably. It was lewd and obscene, and John felt ill, but his cock was gushing precum and so much of it his pants were stained by the precum. He wanted to see more. He licked his lips.

Andy reached down and grasped Adria's ponytail, and the rush that went through John as incredible. He realized he had been hoping for that, and now he could see it. Andy pulled on her hair and brought her to all fours, her back arched so that her ass and head were tilted upward. He pulled so hard the her hair tugged at the each follicle of her scalp, and she closed her eyes tightly. "Oh god!" she screamed.

He dipped his cock in her pussy, getting it wet, and then he made a slow circle over her anus with the crown. The head of his cock was so fat that the circle was only implied: he block the view of her hole with his sheer size.

John heard that Andy was entering his wife before he saw it. Adria squeezed her eyes and gasped, and then she let out a sob. "I can't," she panted, and Andy only responded by pulling her hair tighter, so that her throat was exposed to the ceiling and her black, mascara-streaked tears rolled down to her ears. Her open mouth made no sound except for heavy breathing as Andy's cock stretched her open and slid into her ass.

He released her hair, and Adria fell to the bed again, bringing her fingers to her mouth. She looked at John, with the same almost vacant expression as before, only now with wet eyes. Her mouth open when Andy thrust inside of her, all the way to his balls.

And then she lay there, staring at John, while Andy fucked her in the ass. He began slowly, moving at a gentle pace, probably to break her in. Adria's feet twisted in discomfort, and one of her heels fell off with a thunk on the floor.

Andy began to pump into her faster, and she winced and let out a moan. Then faster, and Adria closed her eyes and put her fingertips into her mouth to bite. "Oh god!" she said. The thick, veined cock was pistoning in and out of her now, and John could only imagine the ache of her ass as she took his unrelenting punishment. As she submitted to another man's will, in the most vulgar way. His own cock pained him now. He was breathless as he waited for Andy's climax.

Finally, the man groaned, and his muscles tensed all over his body as he threw his head up at the ceiling and slammed deep into Adria. She screamed, and Andy kept battering her with his cock for another ten or

fifteen thrusts as he yelled and sprayed his cum deep inside of John's naughty and deserving wife.

Adria settled down, softly whimpering, as he thrust the final loads of his cum inside of her. He panted, looking down at her submissive form, her hand curled up to her mouth, her ass in the air. He left his cock inside of her, and John knew that it was still aching, because Adria turned her feet still with the pain of it.

And then he very slowly slid out of her, until his heavy cock, still semi-hard, flopped out. A river of his cum gushed from her ass. The hole pulsed, trying to close up, failing miserably, gaping and gushing white cream.

Andy gave her ass another slap, and then he hopped off the bed. "I'll let hubby here finish you off," he said. He pulled his jeans up, buttoned them, swept up his shirt, and with the air of a professional, departed.

John stared at his wife.

His cock was so hard he could barely stand. The glass rolled onto the floor when he stood up, and he fumbled with his pants, moving at the same time around to Adria.

She moved her fingers up to her pussy, and began to stroke her clit. John stared, unsure of what she wanted, watching cum drain from inside of her.

She slid her finger up, to her ass, and dipped it inside. She made a lewd circle around the rim, and her desires were evident.

The sensation of her ass, where he had never been before, was admittedly exquisite. Taut, superheated, surprisingly soft. It felt sensationally perverted to have his cock slide inside of her, lubricated by the slickness of another man's cum, but it was worth it.

He fucked her gently, needing very little to get himself over the edge at this point. He felt her fingers working at her clit, and her body seizing up around him, growing tighter around his cock, until her orgasm shuddered through her. Her ass went even tighter around his dick, in waves, as he thrust for the last time and added his cum to Andy's.

22 ON THREE

They lay in silence for a while. They had rolled to face the ceiling, and John didn't know about Adria, but he had dozed off for a bit. He sensed Adria get up, go into the bathroom, take a shower. But he didn't fully rouse until she was back beside him. Still naked, smelling like lime and mint.

“Did we do the right thing?” she said.

John put his hand to his forehead. “I don't know.”

Adria turned to look at him. She was stunning, her face fresh and her blue eyes cool in the dim light. Her eyes were wet. “Was this whole thing a mistake?”

John took her hand. “It got pretty fucked up,” he said.

She turned back to the ceiling.

A long silence hung in the air.

“Is it so fucked up we can't fix it?” she finally said, quietly.

John knew what the answer was for himself. The same unknowable forces twisted inside of him again: lust and jealousy, pain and pleasure, addiction and reason. The mix was terrifying, intoxicating.

But under all of that, more like bedrock, he knew about his feelings for his wife.

“Want to count to three?” she said.

Her voice was shaking, and the wobble in it was strangely romantic to John. After all, it meant that she cared. That the possibility of his answer being different than hers cut into her deeply.

They turned their heads to each other.

“On three?” he said.

“On three, like, 'one, two, three, say it...?' Or on three like...” Her voice was small as she repeated the joke.

“Like we always do,” he said. Then he laughed. “Wait, to make sure: what's the question?”

“Can we fix it,” she said softly.

“I'm glad I clarified that. I thought it was, 'is it so fucked up we can't fix it?'”

She gave a weak smile. “That would be a different answer,” she said.

A pause, and both of them felt like the world was plummeting to the bottom of the universe. John stared into her eyes.

One...

Two...

END

MORE FROM ARNICA BUTLER

*If you enjoyed **Well-Constructed Affairs**,
give my other novels a try!*

See [My Author Page](#) for a complete list of books, or...

Nikita Gets In Too Deep

When Cole and his wife Nik arrive at their usual vacation spot in dull Cape Breton, they're taken by surprise by the most unlikely of next-door neighbors: ultra-sexy Paige and wealthy, commanding Mitch. And these new neighbors are full of surprises. Cole and Nik embark on new adventures in their marriage, trying new things and pushing boundaries they'd never even discussed. It's invigorating, but Cole can't help but wonder if his transformed wife hasn't gotten herself in too deep...

A Well-Laid Trap (2-Part Series)

It all begins when Patrick is convinced he saw his wife with another man at a downtown bar.

He begins to investigate. But the more Patrick uncovers about Jordan's activities, the less he understands.

The biggest problem is, Patrick can't decide how he really feels. On the one hand, his wife seems to be betraying him, and on the other, his sex life has reached a scorching pinnacle he never thought possible.

But he had better hold on to his hat, because when he finds out the truth, things will get much, much hotter than he might have ever imagined...

Ela's Performance

Peter's sweet-faced and fiery wife is headed back to school for a degree in violin performance. Unexpectedly, Peter finds himself becoming very paranoid about who Ela is spending so much time with, and what she is doing at school so very late. It isn't as if he doesn't have his reasons for suspicion. There's the way his own relationship with Ela started, and their own past experiment with an open relationship before they were married. A few other strange things to fuel his jealous fantasies...

And when he discovers someone from Ela's past has resurfaced, he'll take a chance and confront his own desires and obsessions...but will he get what he really wants?

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The Hobby Job

Former career professional Laura is going crazy living her stay-at-home-mom life in a small country town. Her husband Conrad has the perfect

solution: get a “hobby job.” Laura gets turned on to the idea, and to Conrad's surprise, chooses to wait tables at a run-down restaurant down the street. But she gets a lot more than a hobby job when she meets Nate, a young, hot waiter who has his eyes on her from the start.

Conrad and Laura start on separate journeys, exploring new possibilities in their marriage, and opening up to their hidden desires, fantasies, and needs. Will their journeys merge, or will Laura's “hobby job” make a hobby of their marriage?

The Hotwife Tattoo

When Greg's brother marries his wild, tattooed, ex-girlfriend Renee, he knows things will be a little complicated. But when Renee befriends his wife Sara, she starts to change in almost unbelievable ways. Greg sees that there is something more to Renee's plans than just friendly sister-in-law bonding. Is Renee's influence all bad, or can Greg get something he has always wanted and never admitted to his wife – maybe even himself?

The Tenant: A Very Naughty Hotwife Novel

Once upon a time, his exotic and incredibly sexy wife Anna loved to indulge Brian's fantasies...to a point. She teased strangers, and took them to cruel, tantalizing places. But she never went all the way. The game ended when Brian and Anna got married, and that was that.

Or was it?

When the gorgeous, charming, and very black John moves into their basement rental, Brian finds that his sleeping desires have been building up all these years. He doesn't just want Anna to tease. He isn't just toying with the idea. He is obsessed with driving his wife to do things with another man. Lewd things. Obscene things.

When he confesses his desires, is Anna just a little bit too willing to make things just like old times? Is she too easy to push over each new line? Brian can't help but wonder if his own obsessions have gone too far...or if Anna's have.

A Gamble: The Making of A Hotwife

Ryan is just an average guy, coaxing his sweet, beautiful wife Victoria into playing into his hotwife fantasy – even if they're just pretending. But a trip to Vegas with his co-worker Brad and his sexy wife Irena turns Ryan's life upside-down. To help Ryan, Brad makes a proposal that could change everything...but it all centers on Victoria's innocence. How far will Victoria go to save what she holds most dear, now that her virtues, her love for Ryan, their marriage, Ryan's desires, and even their finances all hang in the balance? This is a 52,000-word novel about risk and romance, filled to the brim with the hard, steamy scenes you love. Please enjoy!

The Hotwife Summer

When Ben and Summer have the chance to spend the summer in Italy, their stale marriage starts to heat up in ways Ben could only have dreamed about. Summer is ready to take his hotwife fantasy all the way, and her choice is a sexy, Italian, Michelin star-studded chef. It's too late to put the brakes on what he's set in motion when Ben discovers the humiliating truth about Summer's choice of man. Summer has a taste for being naughty, and a filthy little plan of her own. Will it be everything he could wish for, or will Ben's cuckold fantasy turn into a nightmare he can't escape?

A Dark Place: Cuckolded In Lagos

Three people are carving out their fortunes in Africa's largest city, but each of them holds a deeper, darker desire. What is the secret desire of the

angelic Charlotte, who finds all men's eyes on her after dark in Lagos? What about Andrew, who keeps a secret hunger so buried perhaps he doesn't admit it even to himself? And what could be darker than Clement Ambode's already shadowy “*reliability*” as an all-purpose contractor in the underbelly of Lagos?

Charlotte, Andrew, and Clement will find themselves in a very dark place when their worlds collide in this ultra-sexy, novella-length cuckold story.

Not Black And White

When a photographer turns Rick on to the idea of watching his wife with another man, Rick feels an obsessive desire inside of himself catch fire. He can't help arrange for his shy, girl-next-door wife Danielle and the rugged, black photographer to cross paths. He knows that Drake Reyes' erotic photographs are not as abstract as they appear, and that Reyes sleeps with his married models. He knows his wife is not immune to Reyes' charms – no one is. He just can't help but imagine what it would be like to stand in his gallery, looking at Reyes' lurid photos, knowing his own wife is the model, knowing how the photos were taken.

But was it really his idea, or have Drake and Danielle been as manipulative as he has?

Please note, this is the novelized version of the short story Black and White, with significant changes to all scenes depicted in the short story, as well as the point of view. There is, however, some repetition: scenarios which occurred in the short occur in the novel. There are plenty of fresh new adult scenes, however. Please enjoy.

NOVELLAS BY ARNICA

Try To Have Some Fun

Poor Keith. He's been condemned to a campy cruise with his family and friends. Worse yet, he suspects something is going on between his wife and bad-boy Hank, the husband of a family friend his wife has invited along. Keith's in for a very big surprise – and much more naughty, adult fun than he expected on this cruise – when he finds out what's really going on.

Claire's Cowboy

When he gives his wife Claire the gift of a vacation of her choice, Chris is perplexed when she wants to go on a horseback-riding adventure in Montana. Nothing about that kind of trip has ever appealed to Claire. Next, she mentions a mysterious ex-lover, and she turns out to be nearly a professional at riding horses. Chris can't help but wonder if her choice of vacation, and the rugged man who will lead the tour, are just an uncanny coincidence...or if there is something more to Claire's cowboy?

Nothing Better To Do

Rob is finding out from the locals in his wife's small mountain hometown that his soccer-mom wife Kirsten may have been quite a different person once upon a time. He'll find out the truth first-hand when a late summer blizzard traps everyone at a party, and his wife comes up with some very indecent ideas for passing the time.

After all, there's nothing better to do...

If you're a new fan of Arnica Butler, why don't you try [Wives Gone Wild?](#)

I've put together ten of my short stories about wives on vacation, who get taken every way you can think of while their husbands watch. **Ten stories for \$4.99!** For fans of my longer hotwife novels, these stories may not be for you (but then again...they might). These are quick or medium-length, dirty stories about men taking willing wives right out from under their husbands' noses. Most include very graphic scenes of humiliation, menage, cleanup and...well, that's all I can write about here!

Stories included in this bundle are: *Double-Cucked; Cuckolded in Texas by The Oil Tycoon; Watching My Wife Get Trucked; St. Paddy's Day Cucktale; A Long Hard Winter; Watching My Wife Get Lumberjacked; My Wife Goes Back To Black; Cuckolded On A Plane!; Cuckolded In Vegas!; and Cuckolded on My Dominican Vacation.*

All stories are available for purchase individually for \$2.99 and some are in Kindle Unlimited for free, with the exception of Cuckolded In Texas, which is only available here. I want to give readers a chance to read some of my earlier works and quickies at a discounted price.

Because sometimes, you just want to get down and dirty, right?
Enjoy!